

EaseMyTrip promoter

is the sixth in the case. The Mahadev betting app case relates to an alleged illegal online betting network operated through a network of websites and apps, with the ED investigating the generation and laundering of betting proceeds. The agency has alleged that the proceeds were routed through a complex network of shell entities, benami accounts and other channels before being invested or used to acquire assets. While submitting its latest chargesheet, the ED said it had provisionally attached Pitti's DEMAT shares worth Rs 59.6 crore under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA). The attachment order was issued when the ED filed its chargesheet, officials said. The ED also sought the court's permission to "confiscate" the shares, describing them as "proceeds of crime" under the anti-money laundering law, officials said.

IIT-B

died by suicide later that day. Monday's decision on Doolla was communicated to the students in an email by IIT-Bombay Director Prof Shireesh Kedare around noon. "The Deanship of Prof. Suryanarayana Doolla is suspended with immediate effect. Any further action will be taken after investigation," Kedare said in the email. Soon after the decision became public, the IIT-Bombay Faculty Forum released a statement in support of the professor. The Forum also held a march inside the campus in solidarity with the professor and entered the convocation hall where Director Kedare and other members of the administration were holding an open house meeting with the students to discuss their issues. Doolla, who was earlier Dean of Student Affairs, has been named in the FIR registered by Mumbai Police on the basis of a complaint by Wakode's parents, who alleged that their son was subjected to caste-based discrimination by the professor. The action against Doolla was among the 18 demands submitted by students to the institute administration late Sunday night, following three days of protests on campus. At the time, Kedare had assured students that the institute would work towards fulfilling their demands. IIT-Bombay's Board of Governors discussed the demands Monday but has not issued any statement on whether all of these would be accepted. In the evening, Director Kedare and other senior faculty members from the administration held an open house, which was also among the 18 demands. The session lasted three hours. IIT-Bombay also issued an apology for statements made in its earlier communication regarding Wakode's death, meeting another key demand of students. In its initial communication, the institute

Pitti told *The Indian Express* he had "nothing to say on the matter". "I have always cooperated with and shall continue to cooperate with all law enforcement bodies. I shall submit detailed evidence to establish my bona fide conduct, in accordance with the procedure prescribed by law," he said. So far, the ED has arrested 14 people and attached assets worth Rs 1,885 crore. Police sources claim the racket is still operational, "although under different names". The Raipur Zonal Office of the ED issued a Provisional Attachment Order (PAO) on March 24 this year, attaching 20 immovable properties—including 18 in Dubai and two in New Delhi. "The foreign assets are located in prime areas of Dubai. Some of the attached properties are also located in Burj Khalifa," the ED said in a statement in March this year.

had referred to Wakode's alleged use of an AI tool during the examination. In a subsequent post on X, the institute said: "We apologise for the statements contained in our earlier communication concerning the circumstances surrounding the unfortunate demise of Sahil. The details and circumstances leading up to the incident remain subject to investigation by the appropriate authorities. In view of the ongoing investigation, it was inappropriate to have set out or characterised details relating to the events preceding his demise before they had been duly established through the appropriate investigative process". The students had also demanded an independent investigation into the circumstances leading to Wakode's death and an apology for what they described as "defamation". They contended that proceedings before the disciplinary action committee should have remained confidential until a conclusion was reached. In its statement, meanwhile, the Faculty Forum expressed distress over what they said was "vilification" of their colleague's reputation. The statement highlighted Doolla's record, stating that he "continues to be a faculty member in good standing", who "has won several accolades and awards, including two awards for excellence in teaching, which are decided purely on student feedback". "... as Dean (Student Affairs), he was instrumental in setting up several initiatives for the welfare of the student community of our campus," it said in the statement signed by its president Prof Rajkumar Pant. However, one faculty member, Sociology professor Suryakant Waghmore, took to social media against the forum. "I do not identify with the statement of the Faculty Forum and there are several others who may not come on record. The Faculty Forum should allow the institutional and legal measures to prevail and not interfere in these matters," Prof Waghmore said.

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

Re-arrests

legal representation. "Any breach or non-compliance would entail immediate release of the arrested person because such arrest is unconstitutional. We cannot tinker with the most important safeguards provided under Article 22," the court said. The bench also directed high courts across the country to grant "suitable mandatory compensation" when arrests violate procedural safeguards. Detailing the procedure for seeking re-arrests in such cases, the bench said the accused should first be provided written grounds of arrest, and an application should be filed before a magistrate explaining why a re-arrest was necessary and why the grounds were not given the first time. It also said that the investigation should be assigned to another officer, and a departmental inquiry should be ordered into the previous arrest. The court said the power to re-arrest must not be "left to the discretion of the very same authority who had violated the said provision of the Constitution... It must have the judicial imprimatur". It said the magistrate can allow re-arrest only when satis-

fied "that for bona fide reasons, the grounds of arrest could not be furnished to the arrestee at the first instance but furnished subsequent to his release", and that the accused needs to be re-arrested. "To rule out any foul play or collusion, such an application must have the endorsement of the immediate superior authority. This is because the immediate superior authority should know that the concerned officer has committed an unbecoming act of violating a constitutional provision for which necessary remedial steps will have to be taken," the bench said in its 69-page ruling, adding that the magistrate must decide such an application within a week. The superior officer giving endorsement "shall hand over the investigation of the case to another officer, further directing departmental enquiry for such a serious lapse." An adverse finding "would entail departmental action with entry in the service book of such officer(s)," it said. "Article 22(1) applies across the spectrum including offences under the BNS or under special enactments. It is not statute specific. It is not a mere formality or a matter of procedure. It is a mandatory binding constitutional safeguard. When there is violation of the Constitution,

question of prejudice or demonstrable prejudice does not arise. The safeguards adumbrated in Article 22(1) are not mere procedural safeguards; these are fundamental principles which are required to be followed in the event liberty of a person is sought to be curtailed," it said. Article 22(1) provides for the accused to be informed about the grounds of arrest. The bench was hearing an appeal filed by an accused in a POC SO case in Punjab in May. The accused was released by the local magistrate on the ground that he was not provided the reasons for his arrest, but the magistrate allowed the police to arrest him again, complying with procedural safeguards. The accused moved the Punjab and Haryana HC, challenging the magistrate's decision to allow his re-arrest. After the HC, on May 29, allowed the police to arrest him again, the accused moved the Supreme Court. The Punjab government had argued that given the serious nature of the allegations, police "should not face fetters" while arresting an accused. To this, the SC said that the violation of the Constitution "cannot be countenanced". "It has to be dealt strictly. It is not dependent on the nature or gravity of the offence, en-

compassing within its sweep all offences," the bench said. Over the past three years, the SC has raised the bar for the state, reiterating that communicating the grounds of arrest is mandatory. In *Pankaj Bansal v Union of India*, the SC, in October 2023, held that all arrests under the stringent PMLA require that a written copy of the grounds of arrest be furnished to the arrested person "as a matter of course and without exception." A later order in *Ram Kishor Arora v Directorate of Enforcement* (December 2023) diluted the rule, holding that such grounds need not always be supplied in writing, and treated the Pankaj Bansal ruling as prospective in nature. However, in May 2024, in *Prabir Purkayastha v State* (NCT of Delhi), the SC reaffirmed that an arrested person must be provided the grounds of arrest in writing. The position was finally settled in *Mihir Rajesh Shah v State of Maharashtra* (November 2025), where the court held that written grounds of arrest must be furnished across all offences and statutes, in a language the arrestee understands, and directed that failure to do so would render both the arrest and subsequent remand illegal. Monday's judgment builds on that line of reasoning.

UCC panel

hours after the committee held an online meeting. The state government accepted it on Monday. Phone calls and messages to Justice Desai seeking her comment did not elicit any response. Justice Desai also headed the UCC panels in Uttarakhand, Madhya Pradesh and Gujarat. In his email, Justice Chavan has written that one of the agendas of the meeting was to finalise the questionnaire for public feedback on the UCC. However, he wrote, a questionnaire which was finalised by Justice Desai was circulated, and the committee was told that it would be uploaded once the website was ready. "Three members tried to ar-

ticulate their views, such as respondents being required to answer only in yes or no, or the need to have the questionnaire quickly examined professionally by professors under the supervision of member Dr Suvarna Rawal. Honourable chairperson had already circulated the questionnaire finalised by her and stated that it would be uploaded once the website was ready. Thus, the third and the last item on agenda of today's meeting was over. Therefore, to save time and internet, I logged out," he wrote. "My attempt to put forth my views, even though the questionnaire finalised by the honourable chairperson had already been mailed, was due to my misunderstanding that our exercise was aimed at gathering the views of the people of Maharashtra, and to generate a consensus

to remedy the issues of late marriages, perversions, infertility, unstable marriage, time-consuming dispute resolution mechanism, etc. Now that it is removed, I realise that the aim is to just provide an opportunity to people who may care, to share their responses in a yes or no to the questions posed so that analysis of data becomes easy," he wrote. The email also alleged that a person who was not a member of the committee attended the meeting. The non-member said the website prepared by the state officials needed further modifications, and the committee chairperson directed the authorities to make the necessary changes within a week. Justice Chavan wrote. He wrote that he did not know where the person fit in, and added that the non-member's suggestion made him

speculate that the state's officials may feel they are not competent. "To solve this problem, I am vacating my seat on the committee by resigning now, so that the government can fill in the blank promptly," he said, adding that as a free citizen, he would be free to air his views. "It was a great learning experience on a subject close to my heart," he wrote. The meeting's three-point agenda included confirming the minutes of the previous meeting held last month, and discussion on the website for feedback and opinion on the UCC. The other members of the committee are: retired Bombay HC Judge Justice S G Mehare, former Maharashtra Chief Secretary D K Jain, former Advocate General Birendra Saraf, social activist and Padma Shri awardee Ramesh Patange, and education expert Suvarna Rawal.

Japan

venue technology, LED screens and sporting equipment. The most prominent is the China Media Group-International Media Port (CMG-IMP), the host broadcaster appointed by the Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games Organising Committee (AINAGOC) and approved by the Olympic Council of Asia (OCA). CMG-IMP is producing the international television footage and providing facilities and services to rights-holding broadcasters, including the beauty shots of Nagoya and Aichi prefecture. According to the OCA, 3,858 personnel are working for the host broadcaster, which is providing live coverage of 28

sports while leaving out 15. This is the first time that the Shanghai-based operation has been named the host broadcaster for an event held outside China. Hong Kong-based outlet Bastille Post reported that the CMG is also taking some of the production away from Japan, and doing it remotely from China. The broadcasting contract itself has an unusual history. AINAGOC's first host-broadcast contract went to ISBHAA, a consortium involving Spain's International Sports Broadcasting and China's Yahao Sports Culture Media. This contract was later terminated, and AINAGOC conducted a new selection process. CMG-IMP eventually won the new contract for a reported sum of 5.156 billion yen (approx Rs 314 crore).

Chinese companies at Asian Games	
LCMG-IMP: Host broadcaster	
ZHEJIANG DAFENG: Opening and closing ceremonies, cauldron design, digital content	
STARTING FUTURE BEIJING: Venue technology	
SHANGHAI YUDE: Temporary power	
TAISHAN: Equipment for 9 sports, including wrestling and boxing	
SHENZHEN TRANSTECH: LED screens	
TENCENT ESPORTS: Esports technology	
361°: Prestige partner	

AINAGOC and OCA did not respond to a questionnaire sent by *The Indian Express* on the host broadcaster's contract as well as the broader Chinese involvement in the Games' delivery. OCA president Sheikh Joaan bin Hamad Al-Thani of Qatar told Chinese state media CGTN on Saturday: "What we have seen is impressive. The assessment would be at the end of the

Games, we will see how things go in the next 17 days but what I have seen is really, really impressive." Then there is Zhejiang Dafeng Industry, based in China's Zhejiang province, which is an AINAGOC Tier 2 official partner and "responsible for the planning, production and operation of the opening and closing ceremonies of the 20th Asian

KPSC

investigated by the State CID and involves the suspended KPSC chairman Shrivashankarappa S Sahukar as one of the accused. The court has directed a "denovo" (from the beginning) investigation into the allegations. The SIT probe is to be completed within 100 days and progress reports placed before the court once every 30 days, it said. The CID and the local police have been told to hand over all the probe material to the SIT. The bench said: "In the peculiar facts obtained in these cases, I do not deem it appropriate to permit investigations at the hands of the CID or the local police. I am equally not persuaded that entrustment of investigation to the Central Bureau of Investigation is the only available course. In exercise of the jurisdiction of this court under Article 226, I deem it appropriate to constitute a special investigation team." The High Court's order came as it pronounced its verdict in two separate petitions seeking a CBI probe into KPSC recruitments—one by a veterinarian, Dr S Manjunath, in the recruitment of 400 Veterinary Officers; and another by BJP MLA Basanagouda Patil Yatnal seeking a CBI probe of the recruitment of Sahukar's daughter allegedly with a forged income certificate to the post of industrial extension officer. On Saturday, *The Indian Express* had published the findings of its investigation into the KPSC scam: these scandals were part of a larger pattern of irregularities during the tenure of Sahukar, who was handpicked by the BJP for the KPSC in 2019 and shielded by the Congress that came to power in Karnataka in 2023. This newspaper also reported that the alleged irregularities flagged by job aspirants included marks withheld and top scorers targeted for bribes; interview panels manipulated; tabulation records altered; answer sheets tampered with; and, question papers leaked to select candidates. In Monday's order, the High Court noted that a Public Service Commission is not merely a re-

cruiting agency of the state but also a "Constitutional sentinel at the gateway to public employment". The Commission represents a Constitutional promise that neither money nor muscle, neither proximity to power nor pedigree, will steal a march over merit, it said. The court observed: "Recruitment malpractice, therefore, is not a mere procedural aberration capable of being brushed aside as an irregularity in an examination. When marks are manipulated, answerscripts or OMR sheets are tampered with, selections are purchased, or nepotism and favouritism creep into the process, the fraud is not merely upon an unsuccessful candidate; it is a fraud upon the Constitution itself." The bench has also directed the SIT to extend cooperation to the Enforcement Directorate, which has registered an ECIR (complaint) in the case. The bench underscored that a Constitutional institution entrusted with selecting the servants of the State must remain "like Caesar's wife—above suspicion". Justice Nagaprasanna said, "Once the purity of the fountain of recruitment is polluted, what flows from it cannot inspire public confidence." The bench said: "Recruitment to public service must be fiercely protected from tentacles of corruption, manipulation, nepotism and favouritism, lest the Constitutional guarantee of equality of opportunity under Articles 14 and 16 will be reduced from a living assurance, into an empty parchment promise." Apart from DGP Kumar, the SIT includes IPS officers Dr Divya Gopinath, Anup A Shetty, Kushal Chouksey and Kshama Mishra. The court passed the directions in a batch of writ petitions that included those filed by Yatnal, All-Karnataka State Students Association and several candidates alleging large-scale irregularities in the recruitment of Veterinary Officers. Based on a complaint filed by KPSC, the Vidhana Soudha police registered a case, which was then transferred to the CID. The counsel for the petitioners had contended that registration of the crime by CID was an "eye-wash" and urged that the investigation be handed over to the CBI.

Games as well as digital content creation, the design and production of the cauldron, performances and cultural programmes," according to the OCA statement earlier this year. Dafeng, the OCA said, was listed on the Shanghai Stock Exchange in 2017. The company was also involved in the Hangzhou Asian Games in 2023. The same pattern—of companies involved in the Hangzhou Asian Games also being a part of the Aichi-Nagoya operations—appears elsewhere. Beijing-based Starting Future Technology is an official supplier for venue technology operations. Its previous event experience includes the Hangzhou Asian Games and the Harbin Asian Winter Games. Shanghai Yude Energy is a partner for temporary power supply at the Games. The organisers said the deal with Shanghai Yude, that also supplied temporary power at the previous edition of the Games, does not include Japan's regular public electricity supply and is restricted only to Games operations. There are Chinese suppliers inside the competition venues, too. Shandong Taishan Sports Equipment is supplying equipment across nine sports—boxing, wrestling, gymnastics, taekwondo, karate, wushu, kurash, jujitsu and archery. Shenzhen Transtech Display Technology is an official supplier of LED screens across venues. The Chinese presence also extends into newer parts of the Games. Tencent Technology (Shenzhen) Company Limited is an official supplier for esports solutions, with esports returning as a medal sport after its debut at Hangzhou. Sportswear company 361° is a "prestige partner" of the Games, making Aichi-Nagoya its fifth consecutive Asian Games partnership after Guangzhou, Incheon, Jakarta-Palembang and Hangzhou. Meanwhile, the host—Japan—also has its share of companies on the ground. The major areas that Japanese companies are involved in include transport, communication and other Games operations.

CORRECTION & CLARIFICATION

PAGE 12, 21.09.2026

Under the headline 'Indian-German climber, Nepali Sherpa guide die in avalanche', an unrelated report was carried wrongly. The error is regretted.

संत श्री दुर्बलनाथ जी महाराज की जयंती पर शत-शत नमन

वंचितों, दलितों, पिछड़ों और खटीक समाज के हृदय में आत्मसम्मान, शिक्षा और सेवा का दीप जलाने वाले, संत शिरोमणि दुर्बलनाथ जी आज भी नई पीढ़ियों के पथप्रदर्शक हैं।

नरेन्द्र मोदी प्रधानमंत्री

रेखा गुप्ता मुख्यमंत्री, दिल्ली

DIP/SHABDARTH/DISPLAY/093/26-27

PLUTUS IAS

UPSC / PCS

Economics Optional

NEW BATCH STARTS 25th September

GS FOUNDATION COURSE FOR UPSC CSE, STATE PCS

(BPSC), (UPPSC), (RAS), (HPSC) ETC..

844-844-0231 info@plutusias.com

Prateek Tripathi Sir

2ND FLOOR, APSARA ARCADE, NEAR GATE NO. 6, KARGIL BAGH METRO STATION, NEW DELHI, DELHI 110005

courses Offered For IES & RBI-DEPR EPFO also

Japan vs India for one match. Japan + India forever.

Nippon India Mutual Fund celebrates the first-ever bilateral T20 international cricket match between India and Japan, being played today.



mf.nipponindiaim.com

You can follow us on



Scan the QR code to download our Investor App

Install Now



Nippon India Mutual Fund, MF/022/95/1

Mutual Fund investments are subject to market risks, read all scheme related documents carefully.

GOVT SURVEY CARRIED OUT, ACTION INITIATED

In 5 Gurugram colonies, plots for EWS now have highrises & shops

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurugram, September 21

BUILDINGS RISING up to seven floors, paying guest accommodations, clinics and gyms. Across Gurugram's five DLF colonies, several residential plots originally meant for Economically Weaker Section (EWS) housing now sport multi-storey residential structures and commercial establishments.

According to Department of Town and Country Planning (DTCP) survey data, nearly 43% or 2,179 of the 5,099 properties flagged for unauthorised construction or commercial misuse are on EWS plots in the DLF areas. Yet, physical enforcement has reached just 102 properties — barely 2%.

The figures are based on survey reports by the DTCP released as of December 15, 2025, and enforcement data in the department's September 10 affidavit to the Supreme Court, updated to September 7, 2026.

U-Block has maximum violations

Private builder colonies have been seeing enforcement action since April over illegal constructions on stilt floors and making residential plots commercial, among other violations. The concentration of EWS violations is particularly stark in DLF Phase III.

Of the 3,203 properties flagged for violations in the phase, 1,874 — 58.51% — are EWS plots. U-Block accounts for 1,362 of them, followed by S-Block with 395 and V-Block with 117.

The survey data shows residential plots in these blocks being expanded from single- or double-storey structures into buildings of G+4, G+5, G+6 and, in some cases, G+7 floors.

Violations in numbers

4,330 properties issued show-cause notices across DLF Phases I to V, restoration orders issued against 4,019

1,326 properties are involved in Civil Miscellaneous applications before Punjab and Haryana High Court

Overall, across the entire city

6,465 show-cause notices, 4,810 restoration orders issued



Demolition drive at EWS colony, DLF Phase 5 in January 2025

receiving orders.

Addressing the pace of action, the DTCP stated in its affidavit that enforcement was being carried out "in a phased and systematic manner", citing the size of the area (10,000 acres for which licence for development of residential plotted colony has been granted); the number of properties involved; and the statutory procedure required to be followed in each case.

The affidavit further submitted that "identification of a property during survey is not treated as a conclusive determination of violation", noting that issuing notices, considering owners' representations, and passing speaking orders are statutory requirements prior to initiating sealing or demolition.

Courts restrain demolitions

The affidavit also pointed to widespread judicial intervention as a key hurdle to ground-level enforcement.

Interim relief orders or directives to maintain status quo are currently active in 664 civil

suits pending before the District Courts, per the DTCP affidavit.

In addition, 1,326 properties are involved in Civil Miscellaneous applications before the Punjab and Haryana High Court.

8,248 violations detected in 35 colonies

The DLF figures form part of a larger survey of Gurugram's licenced colonies. As per the affidavit, between August and September 2026, nine dedicated survey teams mapped 35 licenced colonies across the Gurgaon-Manesar Urban Complex, covering 8,839.8 acres and 65,127 approved layout plots.

As of September 7, 2026, a total of 8,248 properties across Gurugram were found with prima facie building plan violations or unauthorised commercial misuse.

Across the entire city, 6,465 show-cause notices and 4,810 restoration orders have been issued. However, on-ground sealing or demolition has been executed on just 128 properties (1.55% city-wide), while 120 properties were self-restored.

Outside the DLF colonies, the highest concentration of violations was detected in Sushant Lok I (854 flagged properties; 616 restoration orders); Sushant Lok-II (404 flagged properties); Palam Vihar (287 flagged properties); Vipul World (259 flagged properties); and Malibu Town (167 flagged properties).

Additionally, the department stated that dedicated anti-encroachment teams cleared approximately 266 km of internal road stretches across licenced colonies — removing illegal gates, guardrooms, boundary extensions, and ramps erected on public right of way.

Rs 130-crore infra project to decongest arterial route gets govt nod

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurugram, September 21

IN WHAT is said to be a one-of-its-kind development project, the Haryana government has cleared a proposal for the construction of a three-lane flyover and a three-lane underpass to decongest the Delhi-bound stretch of NH 48 near Ambience Mall in Gurugram, one of the busiest roads in Gurugram, officials said.

The infrastructure project, estimated to cost around Rs 130 crore, will be entirely financed by real estate developer DLF, as per senior Gurugram Metropolitan Development Authority (GMDA) officials. This is a first-of-its-kind project in north India where a private builder will independently fund and oversee the execution of public road infrastructure of this scale. The developer previously partnered with the Haryana government to develop the Golf Course Road.

The clearance comes on the back of a 15-day traffic study carried out in August 2025 by a private consultant for DLF, which was submitted to the GMDA and the state government. The study recorded 24,429 passenger car units (PCUs) on the arterial route during the evening peak hour. The traffic density along the corridor sits 70% above the road's design threshold, while total Delhi-bound volume along the section clocks in at 52,700 PCUs per hour, the report pointed out.

EXPRESS special

Hotel office, chopper, 'diplomat': How a firm pitched 'Indo-US' scam

Company created impression project had govt sanction, says FIR; 3 held

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, September 21

LAST SEPTEMBER, Sanjiv Rao made an investment of Rs 1.08 lakh in a Delhi-based company that he had been introduced to through a friend who had already invested in it.

The company, VPVV Techno Construction Pvt. Ltd., had told them it was recognised as 'Principal Developer' by the Federal Government of the USA and the United States Department of Defence (DOD) to implement a massive infrastructure and development initiative under an 'Indo-US Pacific Peace Treaty' project. Rao said its office, operating out of an upscale hotel in Delhi, had all the trappings of what it claimed to be.

"The office displayed large Indian and American flags, and photographs of the Prime Minister of India and the President of the US. An employee also presented a detailed 3D video of the proposed project, and the graphics were very convincing," he said. Rao said he had even been presented with an "MoU" to seal the deal.

"The MoU stated that VPVV had received a US government work order approved by the Government of India. It had seals of the national emblems of both countries to convince us that it was a government-backed project," he said.

A few months in, Rao, who runs an electrical items dealership, began to reconsider what he had gotten himself into — he heard from "reliable sources" that the project was fake. He then began pressuring the company to return his earnest money deposit (EMD).

While he got the money back in January, the matter did not end there. "After recovering my investment, I posted a message on X in good faith, advising prospective investors to conduct proper due diligence. Several people, mainly from Kerala, subsequently contacted me and alleged that they had suffered significant financial and personal losses after investing (in the project) on the promise of unusually high returns," he said.

Claim unravels

Rao decided to file an Right to Information (RTI) request with the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) to answer a question that nagged him.

"Whether the Government of India, or any of its ministries/departments/embassies, has entered into, recognised, or acknowledged any such agreement, MoU, treaty, or arrangement with VPVV or any related entity," the RTI asked.

The reply from the MEA arrived on May 18: "No such proposal, communication or representation has been received



(from left) VPVV's promoters Venkita Venkat, Hitesh Kumar & Rahul Rajeev Nair were arrested by the police on August 28. EXPRESS

from VPVV Techno Construction Pvt. Ltd. or its representatives by the Ministry of External Affairs."

This formed the basis of a July FIR registered against VPVV's promoters Venkita Venkat, Hitesh Kumar, and Rahul Rajeev Nair, who were arrested by the Delhi Police on August 28.

The complaint, on the basis of which the FIR was registered, had been filed by another investor, Madhu Nambiar, director of Bengaluru-based technology firm SRIT India Ltd, who had made a much larger financial commitment than Rao.

In 2023, SRIT had entered an agreement to pay Rs 1.75 crore to VPVV after being promised annual work orders worth Rs 500 crore at a 20% profit margin.

The RTI reply confirmed suspicions that had grown after the promises were not kept.

The FIR was lodged at Vasant Vihar police station for cheating and dishonestly inducing the delivery of property; forgery of a document or electronic record for the purpose of cheating; and use of forged documents or electronic records as genuine, despite knowing or having reason to believe they are forged.

Bhoomi puja, video calls

According to the FIR, at meetings conducted in the VPVV office, investors were introduced to a man the promoters claimed was a diplomat and who they referred to as "Dr Saab". He was presented as the "Chief Patron" of the company.

It claimed that investors were told the investments into VPVV ran into billions of dollars. They were also informed that "all necessary governmental approvals, sanctions and clearances had either been obtained or were in advanced stages in the process of being released", and that substantial project funding had already been sanctioned or was in the works.

The FIR reiterated Rao's allegation the documents they were shown bore "what appeared to be official seals, insignia and emblems of the Government of the United States of America, the United States Department of Defence and other governmental authorities, along with Indian National Emblems and official markings..." It said that investors were even invited to a "Bhoomi Poojan" at Tuticorin, Tamil Nadu on December 8, 2023.

"The National Flag of India and the National Flag of the United States of America had been prominently displayed at the venue, apparently with the intention of creating an impres-

sion that the project was officially connected with and sanctioned by governmental authorities..." stated the FIR.

It said that two of the accused, Venkita Venkat and Dr Saab, even arrived in a private helicopter, "further reinforcing the impression that the project was genuine".

As per investors, the accused allegedly also shared a promotional newsletter and brochure with investors on a WhatsApp group in May 2024, claiming they were gifted a "rare collection golden pen" from the US Congress.

In a purported video call in September 2024, investors claimed Venkat was allegedly heard giving instructions for an upcoming visit to a "vault".

He asked women to remove their mangalsutras and other ornaments, claiming that they will be exposed to "radioactive materials" that can record them.

In another purported video call on August 15 last year, Venkat was heard praising PM Narendra Modi's speech, claiming the PM had referenced their project and officially named it the "Sudarshan Chakra Mission".

Rao, meanwhile, claimed he was shocked to see a purported full-page advertisement by VPVV in a Malayalam language newspaper on July 15 this year displaying the name and photograph of the PM. He said he sent a complaint to the PM Office.

"Given VPVV's earlier claims... on the purported 'Indo-US Pacific Peace Treaty', I felt this could create an impression of official association or approval... I approached the PMO seeking clarification..." Rao told *The Indian Express*.

7 FIRs in Kerala

Apart from this FIR, there are currently seven more related cases against the accused being probed in Kerala.

The three promoters, meanwhile, were granted bail on September 2 by a magistrate court in Patiala House Court after they agreed to repay a total of Rs 2 crore as a mutual settlement to the complainant (Nambiar).

"Present dispute arises from accused persons entering into an agreement with the complainant company on the basis of a bogus claim that their company is being funded by the US government. Thus, the grievance of the company is the financial loss he suffered due to accused persons failing to honour the agreement," stated the order, noting that the Investigating Officer in the case "never objected to the bail on grounds of pending investigation".

Delhi set to hike stipend for Anganwadi workers

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 21

THE DELHI government is set to increase the stipend of Anganwadi workers, while also providing them with essential kits, officials said on Monday.

Felicitation kits worth Rs 2,500 will also be handed out to the workers at special programmes to be held in all 70 Assembly constituencies from September 23, officials added.

The initiative comes as part of a month-long birthday celebrations of Prime Minister Narendra Modi being organised by the government, they added. "Anganwadi workers play a crucial role in taking government services to children and women, honouring their contribution is our responsibility," Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said. The essential kit includes a bag, uniform, insulated water bottle, cap, first-aid pouch and umbrella, she said.

Govt aims to provide free rooftop panels to 2.3 lakh families to boost solar power use

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, September 21

IN A move to encourage electricity consumers in the Capital to switch to solar power, the Delhi government has set a target to provide free rooftop solar panels to more than 2.30 lakh families in the city in the first phase of 'Pradhan Mantri Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana'. Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday launched a portal to register such power consumers. The portal was launched for applications on a "first-come, first-served" basis, as part of 'Seva Sankalp Abhiyan' being undertaken to mark Prime Minister Narendra Modi's 76th birthday, said officials.

Under the scheme, the Centre provides a subsidy of up to Rs 78,000 for rooftop solar systems of up to 3 kW. The Delhi government has also decided to provide a state subsidy of Rs. 78,000 along the same lines. This means a total subsidy of up to Rs 1.56 lakh will be available



CM Rekha Gupta, at the launch of PM Surya Ghar Registration Portal Monday. AMIT MEHRA

for such consumers.

"Domestic consumers in Delhi with an average monthly electricity consumption of up to 400 units will be provided rooftop solar systems of up to 3 kW without any payment," Gupta said, adding that if there is any additional gap in the cost of the solar system, arrangements will also be made to cover it through the assistance provided by the government.

"In the first phase, the target is to provide free rooftop solar panels to more than 2.30 lakh families," Power Minister

Ashish Sood said.

Why Delhi lags

Solar rooftop installation has traditionally lagged in the national capital. Delhi only has 29,718 solar connections installed by both BSES and Tata Power, data shows, with a total solar capacity of 472 MWp.

Officials have attributed this to three reasons. Firstly, free electricity up to 200 units means that consumers don't have an incentive to install solar panels. Secondly, a large number of consumers don't live in their individual houses, residing in group housing, where arriving at a consensus for installation of solar panels gets difficult. Thirdly, solar rooftop installation also has a high upfront cost, going up to Rs. 2 lakh for bigger systems. The government has now sought to cover this cost through its incentives.

A look at benefits

■ **0-200 units a month:** Consumers in this category get

a system of up to 3 kW without any upfront cost. Officials said that one important benefit for this category is that they also get an additional 50% energy-saving incentive on reduced consumption.

For instance, cutting use from 200 to 50 units would fetch an incentive equal to 75 units.

They can earn from surplus power sold to the discom.

■ **201-400 units:** The existing subsidy of up to Rs. 800 a month continues, based on eligible consumption after solar.

Officials, however, said the bill for these households could fall potentially to zero.

For example, 400 units of consumption dropping to 100 net units after solar would result in a zero bill after subsidy.

■ **400+ units:** These are the households which would be able to utilise the maximum subsidy amount of Rs 1.56 lakh. These households, however, would not be eligible for the electricity subsidy, as eligibility is based on gross consumption.

POLICE CLAIMED THREE WOMEN CAME FROM MADHYA PRADESH AND RENTED A ROOM IN CAPITAL, TELLING THE LANDLORDS THAT THEY HAVE COME TO SELL CLOTHES OR TAKE UP ODD JOBS

Lutyens' Delhi shoppers were their targets. Their cover? Selling clothes

Alok Singh
New Delhi, September 21

ON AUGUST 31, around 6 pm, an NRI woman was browsing clothes with a group of foreigners at the busy Kashmiri Shawl Emporium on Janpath Road in Delhi. While speaking to shopkeepers, she took out a small purse from her bag before putting it back.

She left the bag open on a table. A woman in an orangesalwar suit, posing as a customer, quietly stepped towards her. She swiftly reached into the open bag, took out the purse, and slipped it under her dupatta.

The woman was Bindiya Sisodiya, 34.

Neelam, 40, her associate, was waiting on the other side of the shop. The two exchanged glances and walked out, while their third associate, Kaali, 40,

waited outside. The three then fled. The NRI woman realised what had happened only after selecting a shawl and reaching into her bag for the purse, which contained her cards and cash. She raised an alarm, and the shopkeepers alerted police.

When police checked the CCTV footage, it showed how the theft played out.

DCP (New Delhi) Sachin Sharma formed a team under the supervision of Station House Officer Inspector Sukhbir Singh to probe the case.

The team, also comprising Sub-Inspector Divya Dagar, Head Constables Hari Singh, Naurang and Lalit, examined footage from more than 100 CCTV cameras at the shop and along adjoining routes before conducting multiple raids in Chilla Village near Mayur Vihar, around 11 km from Connaught

Place. Field enquiries and house-to-house verification eventually led them to a one-room house where Bindiya, Neelam and Kali were staying with another woman.

Late at night on September 3, police briefed the house owner about them and lay in wait until morning. When the women came out of the house, they arrested them.

From a corner of the room, police recovered the NRI's stolen purse.

The cover story

The room, located on the first floor of a residential building, offered little clue to what police claimed the women were doing in Delhi.

There were mattresses, blankets, a stove, a small LPG cylinder and a few cooking utensils



— all brought from Rajgarh in Madhya Pradesh, where the

CCTV grab from a shop on Janpath Road showing Bindiya Sisodiya in the act of the alleged theft; (left) the accused in police custody. EXPRESS

women lived with their families. They had been living there for the past seven days, paying Rs 3,500 a month for the room.

Police said they told the landlord they had come to Delhi to sell clothes. They planned to stay for three to four months

and return home after earning enough money. The landlord said three women would leave during the day while one stayed back to manage the household.

Police, however, alleged that the three women moved through Central and Lutyens' Delhi's upscale markets, looking for women tourists and others they could target. Their alleged source of income was theft.

An officer said the three women were "sharp and daring" as, despite knowing that they had skipped bail and that the police might track them down, they rented a house and stayed there under the guise of selling clothes. "They operate in a syndicate," the officer said.

Pattern starts in Rajgarh

As per police, the three women are part of a larger group

from Rajgarh allegedly involved in similar thefts in Delhi.

An officer said, "Women from the group travel to Delhi carrying little more than kitchen utensils, a small LPG cylinder and their handbags. They rent rooms in areas such as Chilla Village and Sarai Kale Khan, telling landlords they have come to sell clothes or take up odd jobs."

"They typically tell the landlord they plan to stay for three or four months before returning to Rajgarh, once they have earned around Rs 4-5 lakh," the officer added. The women do not carry smartphones, as per police, and instead use basic keypad phones to avoid being tracked.

During the day, they move around the city looking for potential targets. Police said they also travel by metro, where they target women passengers.

"They would mostly target

rich women carrying cash or jewellery. They work in a group with collaboration and coordination," another officer said.

Trio on police radar

As per Delhi Police records, Bindiya, Neelam and Kaali are facing more than half a dozen criminal cases and have been declared proclaimed offenders in theft cases registered in Sadar Bazaar, Chanakypuri and Kotwali, respectively.

Head Constable Rampal, who was part of the team, had been tracking the women since 2024 after they allegedly committed a similar theft outside a shop and escaped. Apart from the stolen purse and its cash and cards, police also recovered Rs 17,000 from the women. Police suspect they may have targeted another location before entering the Kashmiri Shawl Emporium.

‘Window bar turned into weapon’: Inmate killed inside prison

Alok Singh
New Delhi, September 21

IN YET another reminder of gang wars inside the prisons in the Capital, a 31-year-old inmate lodged in robbery and Arms Act cases at Rohini Central Jail in Northwest Delhi was stabbed to death allegedly by two other inmates on Monday afternoon, said police. The incident happened when he was returning to his barrack after meeting his family members, officers added.

Identified as Pradeep alias Mohinder, a resident of West Delhi’s Naraina, the inmate was allegedly facing 14 cases, including murder, attempt to murder and robbery. He had been lodged in the jail since 2024. The accused have been identified as Harish and Karan.

The Rohini jail is an extension of Tihar Jail and is designated as Jail Number 10. A similar incident happened in 2023 when jailed gangster Tillyu Tajpuri was stabbed in Tihar Jail.

Even as the sanctioned capacity of the Rohini prison is around 600; it has more than 1,500 inmates currently lodged there, sources said. The jail is primarily meant for repeat offenders involved in heinous cases, they added.

The incident took place around noon when Pradeep was returning to his barrack after meeting his family members in the jail’s “mulakat ghar” or meeting house. While he was walking towards Barrack Number 203, two other inmates, identified as Harish Koyal and Karan alias Manish, both in their late 20s, allegedly attacked him with a sharp-edged weapon.

According to sources, the accused were carrying an alu-

● AT A GLANCE

ROHINI CENTRAL Jail is an extension of Tihar Jail and is designated as Jail Number 10

EVEN AS the sanctioned capacity of the Rohini prison is around 600, it has more than 1,500 inmates currently lodged there, sources said.

THE JAIL is primarily meant for repeat offenders involved in heinous cases, the sources said.

minium bar — removed from a jail window — that they had sharpened and turned into an improvised weapon.

The accused allegedly stabbed Pradeep and slit his neck, leaving him critically injured, according to officers.

Jail warders and other security personnel, including personnel from the Tamil Nadu Special Police (TSP), immediately reached the spot and overpowered both the accused. The weapon was also recovered from them. Officers said the injured inmate was given first aid and rushed to BR Ambedkar Hospital, where doctors declared him dead.

According to sources, Harish and Karan had an argument with Pradeep inside a jail van while they were returning from a court hearing about a week ago. The two sides allegedly abused each other, following which tensions escalated. But the officers deployed in the van and other inmates pacified them.

Officers believe that the argument could have led to this violent attack on Pradeep.

Police said Harish was facing a murder case, while Karan was facing around 13

cases of robbery and snatching. Harish had been lodged in the jail for more than a year, while Karan had been there for the past few months.

Police said the medico-legal case (MLC) report has been collected and CCTV footage from the jail is being examined.

A murder case has been registered at the Samaypur Badli police station, and further investigation is underway to ascertain the exact sequence of events and the motive behind the killing.

Police also suspect that the attack could have been linked to a fight over dominance. Investigators are also examining whether there was a dispute over the supply of banned substances inside the prison, sources said.

Red flags raised earlier

Fights over dominance among inmates are not new. In 2015, jailed gangster Neeraj Bawana and his associates allegedly killed two members of a rival gang, led by Neetu Dabodia, inside a jail van while they were being taken to court.

Following the incident, the jail administration began conducting stricter checks to ensure that members of rival gangs were not placed in the same barrack or transported in the same van while being taken to court.

According to officials in the Rohini jail, the administration keeps a close watch on the movement of inmates in and out of the prison. Items such as utensils and iron buckets are not provided to inmates as they could potentially be used to make improvised weapons. Such items were restricted almost a decade ago following a series of murders and attacks involving improvised weapons.

Advocates will no longer be promoted by points-based system as HC brings in new rules

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, September 21

IN A move that does away with the points-based evaluation system, the Delhi High Court on September 3 notified the amended High Court of Delhi Designation of Senior Advocate Rules. The fresh rules will involve the full court in taking a decision for assigning a senior designation to an advocate either through consensus, or by at least a two-thirds majority through voting.

Under the previous rules, the qualifying names were put before the full court following a 100 points-based evaluation undertaken by a permanent committee headed by the three senior most judges of the High Court. A provision of ‘voting by secret ballot’ was available under the old rules, but only as “an exception”.

The new rules come after a three-judge bench of the Supreme Court in May last year read down the evaluation process, noting: “the system of 100 point-based assessment has not achieved the desired objectives”. The SC in February notified the guidelines for the new process to be followed in line with the SC’s May 2025 judgement, and Delhi HC now follows.

Under the previous evaluation system, the points were allocated based on various aspects, including publications authored, years of practice, an interview with the permanent committee which included the Bar president, the Additional

Solicitor General and another advocate nominated by the government apart from three senior-most judges. The full court would then consider consensus based on the points.

However, this process ran into controversy in 2024 when 302 applications for promotion were received. Of the total, 70 were designated as seniors while decision was deferred for 67 of them and 165 applications were rejected.

The process was challenged before the SC after one member of the permanent committee, senior advocate Sudhir Nandraj, resigned, writing to then Delhi HC Chief Justice Manmohan and the Delhi government that the final list had been drawn up without his assent. The designations were made on the eve of Justice Manmohan’s elevation to the SC. The challenge to the process led to the SC’s May 2025 verdict. In July this year, carrying over from the 2024 applicants, 85 others were designated seniors, taking the total to 155 designated seniors of the 302 who had applied.

Under the new rules, the permanent committee has been done away with. The process now involves compiling information and data on a candidate by the ‘permanent secretariat’, headed by an officer of the rank of a registrar.

The permanent secretariat shall initiate the process at least once every year by inviting applications. Once the data is compiled, the names will be placed before the full court.

NDMC nod for 50-bed AYUSH hospital, 50% parking charge concession for EVs, removal of dark spots

Mishal Mussaddique
New Delhi, September 21

THE NEW Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) Monday approved a wide array of initiatives, including a 50% parking fee concession for electric vehicles (EVs), a 50-bed AYUSH hospital and a project focussed on road lighting to remove dark

spots in areas under the council’s jurisdiction.

NDMC Vice-Chairperson Kuljeet Singh Chahal said, “EVs will be provided a 50% concession in parking charges at NDMC parking facilities. The initiative aims to reduce air pollution, promote clean transportation and reduce dependence on petrol and diesel.”

The AYUSH hospital and Research Centre in Sarojini Nagar will be built at an estimated cost of Rs 55 crore. Under a Rs 18.26-crore project, new octagonal street light poles will be installed.

NDMC Chairman Manoj Kumar Dwivedi said the aim is also to make Connaught Place a “no-vehicle zone”.

EXPRESS Careers

**MUMBAI PORT AUTHORITY**

RECRUITMENT OF ADVISORS, MANAGERS, PLANNERS AND OTHER STAFF ON CONTRACT BASIS

Applications are invited from eligible Indian Nationals for engagement as

Advisor (Planning)	Chief Manager (P) - I	Chief Manager (P) - II
Manager (P)	Associate Planner	Urban Designer
Dy. Planner	Jr. Planner	Document Controller
Clerk		

purely on contract basis.

Last date of receiving applications is **12.10.2026**.

For details regarding educational qualifications, age, experience, application format etc., please visit our website **www.mumbaiport.gov.in** (People & Career/Jobs/).

CHIEF ENGINEER

**Rizvi Education Society's RIZVI INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT STUDIES & RESEARCH**

New Rizvi Educational Complex, Off. Carter Road, Bandra (West), Mumbai - 400 050.

MINORITY

APPLICATIONS ARE INVITED FOR THE FOLLOWING POSTS FROM THE ACADEMIC YEAR 2026-2027.

UNAIDED

Sr. No.	Cadre	Subject	Total No. of Posts	Category
1	DIRECTOR	—	01	01-OPEN
2	PROFESSOR	Management	02	02-OPEN
3	ASSOCIATE PROFESSOR	Management	02	02-OPEN
4	ASSISTANT PROFESSOR	Management	07	07-OPEN

The above posts are open to all however candidates from any category can apply for the posts. Candidates having knowledge of Marathi will be preferred.

The Educational Qualification, Experience & pay-scale for the post of Director, Professor, Associate Professor & Assistant Professor are as prescribed by the University of Mumbai, AICTE & DTE from time to time.

Please refer University Circular No. मसिमाक/विशिमार्क/पंजीसिमाप/११/२०२०-२०२१ दिनांक ११ जनवारी, २०१९ for qualifications and experience at the time of interview.

Applicants who are already employed must send their application through proper channel. Applicants are required to account for breaks, if any in their academic career.

Applications with full details should reach to the **PRESIDENT, Rizvi Education Society's Rizvi Institute of Management Studies & Research, New Rizvi Educational Complex, Off. Carter Road, Bandra (West), Mumbai - 400 050** within 15 days from the date of publication of this advertisement. This is University approved advertisement.

Sd/-
PRESIDENT

**State Bank of India**
Central Recruitment & Promotion Department
Corporate Centre, Mumbai
Phone: 022-22820427

Scan QR to Apply



Engagement of Specialist Cadre Officers on Contract Basis

Applications are invited from eligible Indian citizens for the following posts on Contract basis:

Advertisement No.:	CRPD/SCO/2026-27/20 (Contractual position)		
Sl. No.	Name of Post	Vacancy	Maximum Age (in years) (As on 31.08.2026)
1	Dean, SBIL Kolkata	01	55
2	Faculty, SBIL Kolkata	01	55
3	Marketing Executive, SBIL Kolkata	01	40
Advertisement No.:	CRPD/SCO/2026-27/22 (Contractual Position)		
1	Deputy Vice President (IT Risk)	02	45
2	Asst. Vice President (IT Risk)	02	42

For eligibility criteria (age, experience, job profile etc.), vacancy details, requisite fee and other details, log on to Bank's website **https://sbi.bank.in/web/careers/current-openings** for online submission of application as well as online payment of application fee. Refer detailed advertisement to ensure eligibility and other details before applying and remitting fees. For any query, please write to us through link “CONTACT US” → “Post Your Query” which is available on Bank's official website (**https://sbi.bank.in/web/careers/post-your-query**)

• DATE FOR FILING ONLINE APPLICATION & PAYMENT OF FEES: FROM 16.09.2026 To 06.10.2026.

Place: Mumbai
Date: 16.09.2026
General Manager (RP & PM)

Couple accused of killing Delhi man targeted him as he was well-off, investigators suspect

Pragynesh
New Delhi, September 21

AN INVESTIGATION into the death of Delhi-based Yuvraj Singh Manchanda (31), who was killed earlier this month, has revealed that the accused in the case — his former colleague Anya Vats and her partner — might have targeted him after one of his social media posts made them believe that he was well-off, a police source said on Monday. Police are trying to ascertain if Anya, involved in at least two cases of cheating, was trying to dupe Yuvraj.

Yuvraj and Anya worked together in the same company till 2022. He was killed by Anya and her partner Sanyam Sachdeva on the evening of September 6, said police.

According to the police, three cases against Anya came up during a background check. A complaint by Punjab National Bank led to a case being registered at Parliament Street police station. Another cheating case was registered against her in Greater Noida, police said. The third one was filed based on a complaint by Sanyam’s first wife at Shahdara police station for alleged domestic violence.

According to the source, Yuvraj and Anya had lost touch,



Yuvraj Singh Manchanda

but started talking again in December last year, after Vats came across one of his posts.

On September 6 this year, she had allegedly called Yuvraj to meet in the name of closing some “deal with a prospective client”, the source added. Police, however, are yet to verify the purpose of the said meeting.

Yuvraj’s family, on the other hand, earlier alleged that Anya had taken some money from him while they worked together.

According to the police, Yuvraj met Anya and Sanyam in Gurugram and he was shot inside their car. They allegedly kept his body in the vehicle for two days before dumping it in a drain in Badshahpur on September 8. The body was recovered on September 10.

To mislead Manchanda’s family and investigators, text messages were allegedly sent from his mobile phone for two days after the murder, assuring them that he was fine and that he might have to travel to Bengaluru. Police suspect that Anya might have sent the messages.

After dumping the body in the drain, police said, Anya and Sanyam first travelled to Vrindavan and then to multiple locations before eventually reaching Kianchi Dham in Uttarakhand, where they stayed in a paying guest accommodation. They were arrested after police traced their vehicle to Kainchi Dham.

**SIMON INDIA LIMITED**

VENDOR REGISTRATION NOTICE
PHOSPHORIC AND SULPHURIC ACID PLANT — PROJECTS & PACKAGES

Simon India Limited (SIL), an EPC / EPCM contractor serving the fertilizer, chemical and process industries, invites **OEMs, manufacturers, authorised dealers / distributors, contractors, suppliers, fabricators, service providers and specialised agencies** to register in SIL’s vendor database. For further details, please refer **https://simonindia.com/**



**संस्कृति मंत्रालय MINISTRY OF CULTURE**

**गांधी स्मृति - गांधी दर्शन प्रस्तुत करती है**

**श्री गुरु तेग बहादुर जी के 350वाँ शहादत वर्ष पर संगीतमय नाट्य प्रस्तुति**

अमर बलिदान

**मंगलवार, 22 सितंबर 2026** | **सायं 6:00 बजे**

**श्री राम सेंटर, मंडी हाउस, नई दिल्ली**

विजय गोयल
उपाध्यक्ष, गांधी स्मृति एवं दर्शन समिति
पूर्व केन्द्रीय मंत्री

**डॉ. संजीत कुमार, निदेशक**
संपर्क: 9821016404, 8810215557

**DELHI TRANSPORT CORPORATION**
(GOVT of NCT of DELHI)
I.P Estate New Delhi-110002

PUBLIC NOTICE
DTC EMPLOYEES SUPERANNUATION PENSION TRUST

It is hereby notified that Life Certificates of 226 Pensioners/Family Pensioners have not been received for more than three years. The concerned Pensioners/Family Pensioners/ Legal Heirs/Nominees are hereby given a final opportunity to submit Life Certificate or relevant claim/death documents within 30 days from the date of publication of this notice to the Pension Cell, DTC.

In case of non-receipt of any response within the stipulated period, further action regarding the pension liability shall be taken as per applicable rules.

SNO.	NAME	DESIG	TNO
1	I.A. Khan	CSO	156
2	Swatantra Chopra	PRM	195
3	Smt Jawala Devi	Forman	460
4	Desh Raj	Forman	689
5	Smt Shail Sharker Mathur	Forman	875
6	Smt Ram Payari	SWEEPER	936
7	Baldev Raj	Forman	1081
8	Smt. Santra Devi	A.FITTER	1392
9	Smt Daya Gulati	AE(M)	1432
10	Bishan Singh Vats	MGR(M)	1457
11	Smt Bimla Satija	AAO	1581
12	Smt Swaran Kanta	SR.PO	1681
13	Smt Krishna Kumari	AAO	2023
14	Smt Manika Chopra	SR.CLERK	2033
15	Smt. Radha Devi	A.I	2148
16	Smt.Chameli Devi	TR.SUP	2430
17	Balbir Chand Sharma	PHAR	2515
18	Balwant Singh	AE	2548
19	Smt Santosh	S/CLERK	2573
20	Smt Chanderwati	SWEEPER	2667
21	Jagdish Raj	Foreman	2710
22	Smt Vidya Wati	TR.SUP	2819
23	Smt. Yashoda Rani	TR.SUP	2905
24	Smt Daropati Devi	TR.SUP	2930
25	Braham Singh	TI	3323
26	Om Parkash	ATS	3428
27	Smt Krishna Devi	TR.SUP	3440
28	Smt. Sheela Rani	TR.SUP	3507
29	Smt Sukh Devi	TR.SUP	3633
30	Kunti Nandan Sharma	AE	4047
31	Smt Kela Devi	SK	4054
32	Smt Gaiinda Devi	AE	4161
33	Krishan Lal	A.Forman	4222
34	Smt Razia Begam	ELECT	4228
35	Smt Surjeet Kaur	MECH	4238
36	Smt Roop Wati	FITTER	4330
37	Rajinder Singh	ELECT	4413
38	Smt Jyoti Sen	A/B/FITT	4641
39	Smt Khilya Devi	FITT	4720
40	Sahib Singh	A.Forman	4754
41	Suresh Kumar	ELECT-II	5356
42	Smt Sharda Devi	S/CLEANER	5366
43	Smt Onkar Rani	A/Forman	5626
44	Smt Shanti Devi	MECH	5801
45	Rattan Singh	A/Forman	5822
46	Smt. Veera Wati	FIT	5835
47	Smt Sheetal Kaur	B/FITTER	5908
48	Jagdish Chander	S.CLEANER	5947
49	Smt Laxmi Devi	B/SMITH	6015
50	Smt Kalisho Devi	FITT	6417
51	Vasdev Tripathi	MECH	6678
52	Smt Prem Pyari	A/Forman	7028
53	Hari Dutt	B/FITTER	7064
54	Balbir Singh	VUL	7073
55	Smt Barfi Devi	A/Forman	7221
56	Smt Gulab Rani	MECH	7270
57	Smt Madhu Bali	A.FITT	7319
58	Smt Maya	VUL	7991
59	Surjit Singh	A.Forman	8482
60	Smt Asha Devi	MECH	8774
61	Ram Parkash	S/CLEANER	8884
62	Smt Mariyam	B/SMITH	9230
63	Smt Jaldhari Devi	HELPER	9243
64	Atraj	MECH	9303
65	Smt. Kaushalaya Devi	S.FITT	9476
66	Smt Lachham Kanwar	Driver	9617
67	Het Singh	Driver	9638
68	Smt Amarjeet Kaur	Driver.	9665
69	Smt Usha Sharma	Driver	10025
70	Smt Maheshwari	Driver	10046
71	Hari Chand	Driver	10264
72	Smt Mohender Kaur	Driver	10380
73	Janardhan Singh	Driver	10432
74	Gidowari	Driver	10847
75	Balbir Singh	Driver	10849
76	Duli Chand	Driver	10874
77	Kartar Singh	Driver	10887
78	Dalel Singh	Driver	10907
79	Smt Surjeet Kaur	Driver	11186
80	Dharam Singh	V/EXAM	11194
81	Iqbal Singh	Driver	11211
82	Bhagwan Singh	Driver	11297
83	Ram Nath	A.T.I	11337
84	Smt Santra Devi	Driver	11510
85	Smt.Chandro Devi	Driver	11702
86	Charanjali Lal	Driver	11703
87	Ramji Lal	Driver	11846
88	Smt Shanti Devi	Driver	12246
89	Smt Saroj	Driver	12301
90	Smt Krishna Devi	Driver	12323
91	Baldev Singh	Driver	12427
92	Smt Yashoda Bai	V/EXAMNER	12481
93	Ram Kishan	Driver	12529
94	Smt Puspaa	V/EXAM	12531
95	Smt Prem Devi	Driver	12726
96	Smt Munni Devi	Driver	12788
97	Daya Chand	Driver	12800
98	Smt Birma Devi	ATI	13020
99	Smt Bimla Devi	Driver	13100
100	Smt Reshma Devi	V/EXAM	13113
101	Smt Sahbow	ATI	13323
102	Suraj Parkash	Driver	13384
103	Saroop Singh	Driver	13462
104	Smt Parwati	Driver	13566
105	Smt Shakuntala	Driver	13844
106	Jai Bhagwan	Driver	13854
107	Dharamvir	Driver	13960
108	Sujan Singh	Driver	13975
109	Smt Munni Devi	Driver	14035
110	Tej Ram	Driver	14044
111	Rattan Singh	Driver	14084
112	Mahender Singh	Driver	14169
113	Miss Babita	Driver	14360
114	Smt Ram Wati	Driver	14409
115	Smt Shakuntala Devi	Driver	14664
116	Darshan Singh	Driver	14758
117	Smt Jasmel Kaur	Driver	14997
118	Smt Krishna Devi	Driver	15030
119	Gian Chand	Driver	15038
120	Smt Savitri Sharma	Driver	15069
121	Smt Parmali Devi	Driver	15088
122	Randhir Singh	Driver	15239
123	Chhuttan Lal	COND.	16078
124	Ajay Pal Singh	ATI	16151
125	Surinder Singh	ATI	16239
126	Smt. Sudesh	COND.	16561
127	Smt Murti Devi	COND.	17016
128	Smt Prem Wati	COND.	17023
129	Umed Singh	TR.SUP	17401
130	Ram Chander	ATI	17493
131	Satya Narain	COND.	17816
132	Smt Shanti Devi	COND.	17825
133	Smt Sudesh	ATI	18017
134	Smt Kamlesh	COND.	18121
135	Joginder Singh	ATI	18275
136	Ishwar Singh	ATI	18666
137	Smt Harbhajan Kaur	COND.	19093
138	Smt Krishna Devi	TI	19190
139	Ram Kishan	COND.	19776
140	Smt Savitri	ATI	20102
141	Smt Basanti Devi	COND.	20195
142	Smt Phul Wati	COND.	20386
143	Jagminder Singh	ATI	20467
144	Smt Premo Devi	COND.	20700
145	Kumari Kirti	COND.	20735
146	Shiv Raj Singh	COND.	20980
147	Jai Bhagwan	ATI	21325
148	Sh Daya Nand Sharma	ATI	



Spiritual Connect

AFTER FINDING favour with a slew of political leaders, including Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav and several state chief ministers, the cast and crew of Hindi film Hanuman Ansh, based on the life of spiritual guru Neem Karoli baba, got an audience with Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Monday, who congratulated them on the film's success. The makers, who also met BJP president Nitin Nabin a day earlier, are said to have spoken about their plans to make a film on the life of poet-saint Tulsidas.

Fresh Start

POLITICAL PARTIES and their leaders may still be speculating about the possibility of the government bringing the delimitation Bills — the Monsoon session of Parliament is yet to be prorogued despite being adjourned on August 13 — but it's business as usual for the Central Public Works Department (CPWD), which has begun sprucing up the premises of the Parliament House. The CPWD usually undertakes any renovation or repair works in the Parliament complex in between sessions. It started work on putting up signage inside the corridors, repairing internal roads and other small improvements this month, it is learnt.

PM, Jaishankar condole death of the brother of Dubai ruler

New Delhi: PM Narendra Modi on Monday condoled the death of Sheikh Ahmed bin Rashid Al Maktoum, the brother of the Dubai ruler, and said his efforts to serve society will be cherished by generations to come. Sheikh Ahmed bin Rashid Al Maktoum was the younger brother of Sheikh Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice President and PM of the UAE and ruler of Dubai. "Deeply saddened by the passing of His Highness Sheikh Ahmed bin Rashid Al Maktoum. His efforts to serve society will be cherished by generations to come. I convey heartfelt condolences to the Royal Family and the people of Dubai," Modi said on X. External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar said on X, "Deeply grieved at the passing of His Highness Sheikh Ahmed bin Rashid Al Maktoum." PTI

'THEFT' AT RAM TEMPLE: CHARGESHEET ON OR BEFORE SEPT 25, SOLICITOR GENERAL INFORMS TOP COURT

No discrepancies in silver bricks donation handling: SIT report in SC

105 instances of unauthorised currency removal caught on CCTV cameras: Report

Ananthkrishnan G
New Delhi, September 21

THE SIT, probing into alleged donation theft at the Ram temple in Ayodhya, found "no discrepancies" in the handling of the "200 kg of silver bricks, 38,288 kg of silver bricks, a silver necklace, Charan Paduka, and a donation related to the Ram-charitmanas" received as donation by the temple administration, according to the Supreme Court order on Monday.

In a status report, dated September 16, 2026, the SIT, headed by UP IGP Kiran S, said it had "duly verified" the "particular allegations regarding valuable donations reported in the media and on social media" about these donations, it said. "The involved individuals have been interviewed, and the pertinent materials have been examined by them. No discrepancies were

identified during this verification process," it said, according to the order.

The contents of the report were perused by a three-judge SC bench, presided by CJI Surya Kant, and comprising Justice Joymalya Bagchi and Justice V Mohana. According to the order, "the report discloses that the receipts generated by the TCS software for 803 valuable articles have been verified, and their relevant records have been found to be with the Trust. These articles are stored in a State Bank of India locker, which was physically checked. In so far as these 803 articles are concerned, no discrepancies were found during the verification."

It added that "there are 86 valuable articles in respect of which receipts have not been issued. These articles have been separately identified and physically verified."



Air Marshal (retd) Jeetendra Mishra (left) takes charge as the CEO of Shri Ram Janmbhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust in Ayodhya, Monday. ANI

The report also said that "records relating to approximately 944,411 kg of white metal (supposed to be silver) have been sent by the (Shri Ram Janmbhoomi Teerth Kshetra) Trust to Security Printing and Minting Corporation of India Limited for melting. The report pertaining to the said white metal has also been examined, and the relevant records scrutinised".

Solicitor General Tushar

Mehta, appearing for Uttar Pradesh, submitted before the bench that the "SIT is inclined to file the chargesheet on or before 25.09.2026, i.e., before completion of 90 days from the date of the first arrest." "Ninety days are going to be over on September 25. So we will have to file a chargesheet. Otherwise they will get bail," Mehta informed the bench.

The SIT report pointed out that CCTV footage from the counting room situated in the

Pilgrim Facility Centre (PFC) building at the temple and other digital data "has revealed 105 instances of unauthorised currency removal or concealment from the counting room, involving assistance from other individuals participating in the counting process".

Eight accused have been identified, it said. "The status report further emphasises the estimated amount misappropriated by each accused individual, also noting that existing evidence suggests the suspected misappropriation of currency took place within the counting room during the process of counting and handling the currency," the SC order said.

The report said that a forensic auditor was included following SC's direction. The status report pointed out that "the statements of 173 witnesses have been recorded as of 14.09.2026", including trust functionaries, accounting personnel, banking officials, security personnel and Chartered Accountants.

Nandigram bypoll: Cong candidate moves HC, seeks protection from coercive action

Tanusree Bose
Kolkata, September 21

THE CALCUTTA HC will on Tuesday hear a plea by Congress' Nandigram bypoll candidate Milan Pradhan seeking protection from coercive action in five cases filed against him.

On Monday, the legal counsel of Pradhan mentioned the matter before the single bench of Justice Saugata Bhattacharya for an urgent hearing. Pradhan, who is already in jail after his arrest in connection with three other old cases, has sought protection from coercive action in the five new cases and the disclosure of further arrest warrants against him.

According to Pradhan's counsel, the Congress candidate was arrested on September 18, and later remanded in judicial custody until October 3 by a Haldia court in three cases dating back to the Nandigram land agitation of 2007. The Khejuri police on Saturday submitted another arrest warrant against him in a fourth case, and Nandigram police on Sunday filed another warrant in a fifth case.

His counsel contended that for the October 6 Nandigram bypoll, the last date for campaigning is October 4. This will effectively end Congress candidate's opportunity to campaign. The court allowed the matter to be filed, and posted the matter for hearing Tuesday. On Monday, a court in Purba Medinipur remanded Pradhan in 14-day judicial custody until October 5 in a 2007 case. His counsel Ayan Bhattacharjee told PTI he will move HC against the order.

Minister: UP to be divided into four parts, Purvanchal to get Rajbhar CM

Nishad, Akhilesh dismiss Rajbhar's claim

Maulshree Seth
Lucknow, September 21

UTTAR PRADESH Minister and Suheldev Bhartiya Samaj Party chief Om Prakash Rajbhar has claimed that the state will be divided into four parts soon, and that the Purvanchal region will get a "Rajbhar chief minister".

Addressing a public meeting in Ambedkarnagar district on Sunday, Rajbhar referred to his "conversation" with Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

"Aane wale dinon mein Pradesh ka chaar bhagon mein batwara hoga. Jis din Purvanchal raj alag hoga, sabse pehle Mukhyamantri koi hoga to Rajbhar ka beta Mukhyamantri Purvanchal ka hoga (In the coming days, the state is going to be divided into four parts. The day a separate Purvanchal state is created, the first Chief Minister will be a son of the Rajbhar community)," he said.

He also named the four proposed regions: "Jab Pradesh ka batwara hoga to Purvanchal, Madhyanchal, Bundelkhand, Harit Pradesh. Purvanchal mein sabse jyada vote Rajbhar jati hai. Is nate, Purvanchal ka pehla CM Rajbhar hoga (When the state is divided, there will be Purvanchal, Madhyanchal, Bundelkhand and Harit Pradesh. The Rajbhar community has the largest vote base in Purvanchal. Therefore, Purvanchal's first Chief Minister will be a Rajbhar)." Rajbhar's claims, before the



NDA ally and SBSP chief Om Prakash Rajbhar

2027 Assembly elections, has revived demands for the division of the state that's been raised several times in the past.

Regional outfits have campaigned for separate states of Bundelkhand and Purvanchal, citing factors including the distance from the state headquarters and issues specific to the regions.

A formal step in this direction was taken in 2011, during the BSP government led by Mayawati. The state Assembly passed a proposal to divide Uttar Pradesh into four parts, but it did not receive approval from the Central Government.

In his address, Rajbhar had also claimed that he discussed reservation within the 27 per cent quota with the Prime Minister and was assured it would be done after the caste census.

"Once the caste census is completed, there will be no problem in carrying out the division. We will divide the state after the caste census. This is what the Prime Minister of the country said," Rajbhar claimed.

'Both sides will have something to say': SC to hear TMC symbol case

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 21

THE SUPREME COURT on Monday agreed to hear from West Bengal CM Mamata Banerjee's petition challenging the EC's interim decision to freeze the name and "Flowers & Grass" election symbol of the All India Trinamool Congress amid factional feud within the party.

Senior Advocate Kapil Sibal, appearing for the petitioner, sought urgent listing of the matter. Sibal took exception to the EC's decision and said it was taken after the bypolls in Nandigram and Rejinagar were announced.

"Extraordinary things have happened. While the notification is on, despite the fact that the proceedings started in June, (and) we filed our reply in July, they don't do anything, and then they issue a notification, and in the middle of the notification, they freeze the symbol. What's going on? We just don't understand how," Sibal submitted before the bench presided by CJI Surya Kant and also comprising

Justice Joymalya Bagchi and Justice V Mohana.

The CJI pointed out that the other side will also have submissions to make and asked Sibal to wait until the matter is listed for hearing. "Both sides will have something to say. When the matter is listed, then argue. We will try to list," the CJI said. The EC on September 18 ordered a freeze on name and election symbol of Trinamool Congress and directed the two rival factions to select new names and symbols until the dispute is resolved.

The order said there wasn't enough time to resolve the dispute before the bypolls. "In order to place both the rival groups on even keel and to protect their rights and interests, and going by past precedence", neither group would be permitted to use the name All India Trinamool Congress and the party's "flowers and grass" symbol, it said. The Banerjee-led faction is now contesting on a footballer symbol and the rebel camp on an envelope symbol.

EXPRESS special

Arrests, withdrawals, 'intimidation': Testing time for Opp in Bengal bypolls

Congress Nandigram nominee in jail, AJUP chief Kabir alleges harassment in Rejinagar; Opp making excuses: BJP

Ravik Bhattacharya & Atri Mitra
Kolkata, September 21

WITH THE BJP facing its first electoral test in West Bengal since it came to power in the Assembly elections earlier this year, the Opposition finds itself in a tough spot in two key constituencies — Nandigram and Rejinagar — amid candidate withdrawals, arrests and allegations of police pressure on Opposition workers.

The developments in the two seats, which will see bypolls on October 6, have prompted Opposition leaders to allege a pattern of pressure on their candidates and workers. BJP, however, has rejected the allegations, with its leaders accusing the Opposition of making excuses ahead of the contest.

Bengal BJP chief Samik Bhattacharya took a dig at the Opposition, but also struck a note of caution. "The so-called main Opposition party has no name... Their candidate (from Nandigram) covered hundreds of kilometres and met the CM while their party was in the dark. This proves that there is no Opposition. It is not a welcome situation in a democracy," he said.

The Nandigram tangle

In Nandigram, the candidate of the Mamata Banerjee-led TMC faction, Sanchita Dey Pradhan, withdrew from the contest, following which Mamata ex-

tended support to Congress candidate Milan Pradhan. Within hours, Pradhan was arrested in connection with cases related to the 2007 anti-land acquisition agitation. Pradipta Mukherjee, spokesperson of the Mamata faction of the TMC termed the development as "fascist tendency of BJP to stifle Opposition voices". "They (BJP) have the people mandate but are now using state machinery to oppress the Opposition," he added.

In Rejinagar, meanwhile, Aam Janata Unnayan Party (AJUP) chief Humayun Kabir has alleged police harassment against party workers and said he would not campaign on the ground. His son, Golam Nabi Azad, is AJUP candidate here.

After appearing before the police for questioning at Berhampore police station Monday, Kabir told *The Indian Express* over the phone he had decided to campaign through social media instead. "Police are trying to harass me and my party workers. To prevent further arrests and harassment of my party workers, I have decided I won't campaign on the ground. I will also not allow my son to campaign. Instead, I will use social media. But I will not bow."

Why was Kabir questioned?

The police questioning followed a viral audio clip in which two people can allegedly be heard discussing a plan to switch



A BJP poll graffiti in Nandigram ahead of October 6 bypolls. PARTHA PAUL

off CCTVs around the site of a Babri Masjid replica being constructed in Murshidabad and put up BJP flags in order to trigger communal tension.

The police said one of the voices in the recording belongs to Sarfaraz Nawaz Chowdhury, a resident of Tungi village in Naoda, who has been arrested. Investigators believe the other voice belongs to a political leader from Murshidabad. The police issued a notice to Kabir based on information obtained during Chowdhury's interrogation.

On September 20, four senior party office-bearers — Manjur Rehman, Nasim Sheikh, Haq Mallick and Abdul Halim — were arrested in various old cases. On September 19, Independent candidate Saiful Islam was arrested in connection with a 2021 case. A day earlier, Ashik Iqbal, AJUP state secretary, was arrested allegedly with fake currency notes.

Kabir has accused the BJP and the Democratic Trinamool Congress, a breakaway faction led by Ritabrata Banerjee, of working in tandem to target

AJUP workers by providing names to local police.

The Rejinagar contest has also seen uncertainty within TMC. Its candidate, Rabiul Alam Chowdhury, initially announced he would withdraw from the race, citing internal difficulties and concerns over the introduction of party's new "footballer" election symbol. He later reversed the decision following intervention by Mamata and the party leadership.

Congress has fielded Mohammed Abdullahil Kafi, while BJP has nominated Sakharav Sarkar. Minister Gouri Shankar Ghosh has been appointed BJP's election in-charge for the constituency. Sarkar said BJP's campaign was centred on development and employment. "I am talking about setting up industries and factories in the area. There is a need for a college in the area. Those opposing us are playing the religion card," he said. Dismissing Kabir's allegations, Ghosh exuded confidence that BJP will win Rejinagar. "He (Kabir) knows he will lose. Now, he is making such excuses."

● LEADERS SAY PARTY DOES NOT WANT TO BE BRANDED AS 'MUSLIM-YADAV'; UNCERTAINTY OVER ALLIANCE WITH CONGRESS ALSO KEY FACTOR

Samajwadi Party sees UP opening; then what is holding Akhilesh Yadav back?

CAPITAL CONTEXT BY LIZ MATHEW

A WEEKLY LOOK AT POLITICS IN A STATE FROM THE VANTAGE POINT OF NEW DELHI

WITH THE Uttar Pradesh Assembly elections months away, the SP senses an opening. Anti-incumbency, Gen Z's growing restlessness, a persistent jobs crisis and shifting caste equations have, in the party's assessment, created conditions favourable for it to build on its breakthrough in the 2024 Lok Sabha elections. Yet, despite its confidence, the SP has so far refrained from launching an all-out offensive against the Yogi Adityanath government.

The hesitation stems partly from an old electoral vulnerability: the perception of it as a "Muslim-Yadav" party. While seeking to retain its traditional support base, SP is attempting to

broaden its social coalition and reach out to other caste groups, particularly Dalits and sections of the OBCs.

There is also uncertainty over its alliance with Congress. Within SP, leaders acknowledge that going into the election without the Congress could make Muslim consolidation more difficult. At the same time, going solo could limit the party's ability to make deeper inroads among upper-caste and Dalit voters as it seeks to translate its 2024 Lok Sabha gains into an Assembly victory in 2027.

SP leaders point to what they describe as a favourable "ground situation". The party won 37 of UP's 80 Lok Sabha seats in 2024, and leaders argue that several issues confronting the state government have since intensified.

"There are issues, from the poor delivery mechanism to the growing antagonism against Thakurvad. SP has clear advantages. But if BJP and the govern-

ment misuse the state machinery like they did in states like West Bengal, it's going to be a tough task for the party. We have our fears over ruthless communal polarisation too," said Javed Ali, a Rajya Sabha MP.

While CM Yogi Adityanath has moved into election mode, SP chief Akhilesh Yadav has yet to launch an aggressive campaign. Recently, he cancelled scheduled programmes, including a rally in Bulandshahr, after the district administration denied permission for prominent venues.

BJP leaders alleged that the SP did not accept alternative venues suggested by the administration and instead chose to blame the ruling party and the district authorities. An UP BJP MP said Akhilesh was "playing it safe", arguing that large SP rallies at this stage could reinforce the perception of the party as being dependent on Muslim and Yadav voters — an image, he



SP chief Akhilesh Yadav at party office in Lucknow on Sunday. ANI FILE

claimed, BJP would seek to use for polarisation.

SP's plans

The SP, however, is attempting to address precisely that vulnerability by expanding its social coalition. A key focus is the Dalit vote, a constituency being sought by the BJP, SP and Congress as the influence of BSP leader Mayawati has declined.

Akhilesh has stepped up efforts to expand the party's pres-

ence among Dalits across the state as part of an effort to broaden his Pichhda, Dalit, Alp-sankhyak (PDA) social engineering formula.

The party's outreach has also acquired a visible symbolic dimension. BJP leaders have pointed to the addition of the colour blue, traditionally associated with B R Ambedkar and the Dalit movement, to the SP's traditional red-and-green palette. The uniform of the Sa-

majwadi Chhatra Sabha (SCS), the party's student wing, includes blue T-shirts and jeans. Akhilesh was also recently seen wearing a blue scarf, instead of the party's traditional red one, at a meeting of district and city presidents.

In November, senior SP leader and Rajya Sabha MP Ramji Lal Suman is expected to lead a Dalit conference in Agra, a district with a sizeable SC population and a significant Jatav presence. Akhilesh is likely to be the chief guest.

Training workers

The SP chief is also planning a two-day training programme for party workers in Gorakhpur, an important centre in eastern UP, where Nishads and Brahmins have a significant presence. Both communities are being closely watched by political parties amid claims of their discontent with the BJP. Jatavs account for more than

half of the SC population in UP, while SC constitute over a fifth of the state's population.

"Akhilesh wants to penetrate the SC vote base and fortunately for him, there is a section in the SCs, particularly government employees, including bureaucrats, who can be influential. This is a strategy Kanshi Ram had used," said a BJP leader from UP. Kanshi Ram had built an organisational network among government employees through BAMCEF — the All India Backward and Minority Communities Employees' Federation — before launching the BSP.

The SP chief is also planning a two-day training programme for party workers in Gorakhpur, an important centre in eastern Uttar Pradesh, where Nishads and Brahmins have a significant presence. Both communities are being closely watched by political parties amid claims of their discontent with the BJP. The SP's broader strategy is

to consolidate its PDA base while seeking to tap into discontent among sections of communities that have traditionally supported the BJP. BJP leaders themselves acknowledge the need to retain support among communities such as the Passis, Kurmis, Sakyas and Mauryas.

"Akhilesh is trying to strengthen his PDA formula that helped him get 37 seats in 2024 Lok Sabha polls. He wants to cash in on the growing anger against the dominating caste, that is, Thakurs now, under Adityanath, to bring together a new social coalition," the BJP leader said.

For BJP, the challenge is compounded by an internal debate over the political risks of what some party leaders describe as a "hardcore Hindutva" line associated with Adityanath. Some in the party fear that an emphasis on this approach could have adverse political consequences as BJP seeks a third consecutive term.



Uttar Pradesh

Healthy Teachers, Stronger Education System

Under the visionary leadership of Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, Uttar Pradesh's education reforms have evolved beyond the modernization of schools to encompass the holistic well-being of teachers. Through the Chief Minister Teacher Cashless Medical Facility Scheme, nearly 19 lakh+ teachers and education personnel will receive comprehensive health coverage. The state will invest ₹3,000 annually per beneficiary, amounting to an estimated ₹447 crore every year. With access to nearly 1,900 cashless treatment packages, the initiative underscores the government's commitment to ensuring that healthy, secure, and worry-free teachers form the strongest foundation of a robust education system and a brighter future for the state.



19 Lakh+ Beneficiaries, One Commitment to Better Health

- Around 9,17,000 teachers and personnel of the Basic Education Department will be covered under the scheme.
- Nearly 298,000 teachers & staff of the Secondary Education Department will also benefit.
- 7.5 Lakh+ Higher Education Teachers & Their Dependants to benefit from the scheme
- The scheme extends coverage to Shiksha Mitras, instructors, special educators, teachers of Kasturba Gandhi Balika Vidyalayas, and personnel of aided schools and vocational institutions, ensuring comprehensive health security across the education sector.

Ensuring Health, Honouring Educators

- Nearly 19 lakh+ teachers, Shiksha Mitras, instructors, special educators, cooks, and education department personnel will benefit from the scheme.
- The State Government will bear an annual premium of ₹3,000 per beneficiary.
- An estimated ₹447 crore will be spent on the scheme every year.
- Beneficiaries will have access to cashless treatment under more than 1,900 medical packages at empanelled government and private hospitals.
- Coverage includes treatment for critical illnesses such as cardiac diseases, cancer, kidney disorders, and neurosurgery.
- A landmark initiative that integrates teacher health security with comprehensive education reforms, reinforcing the foundation of a stronger education system.

1,900+ Cashless Treatment Packages for Better Health Security

- Cashless treatment available at empanelled government and private hospitals.
- Access to more than 1,900 treatment packages under the scheme.
- Comprehensive coverage for critical illnesses, including cardiac ailments, cancer, kidney diseases and neurosurgical procedures.
- Eliminates the need for out-of-pocket cash payments at the time of hospitalization, ensuring hassle-free access to quality healthcare.



Cashless
Healthcare for
State Employees
& Pensioners

83

Operational
Medical Colleges

450+

Pharmacy Colleges

75

Districts Free
Dialysis Services

₹5

Lakh Free
Health Insurance

9.5

Crоре+ Beneficiaries
Targeted under
PM-JAY

AIIMS

Operational in
Gorakhpur &
Raebareli

Health, Life & Social Security A New Shield for Teachers

- **Comprehensive Health Security for Educators:** The Mukhyamantri Shikshak Cashless Chikitsa Yojana provides cashless treatment to teachers, non-teaching staff and their dependants, without the burden of upfront payments.
- **₹5 Lakh Annual Cashless Health Cover:** Higher education teachers and their families can avail cashless treatment up to ₹5 lakh per family per year, including critical and complex medical procedures.
- **Hassle-Free Treatment from Admission to Discharge:** The scheme covers hospitalisation, medicines and treatment through discharge, reducing financial stress during medical emergencies.
- **Strong Life & Financial Protection:** The social-security package includes personal accident cover up to ₹1.5 crore, air-accident cover up to ₹3 crore, hospital cash benefits up to ₹60,000 and term-life insurance up to ₹12 lakh, providing greater financial security to employees and their families.

Supporting Teachers, Shaping the Future of Education

Comprehensive Accident & Family Security for Basic & Secondary Education Staff One Cover. Multiple Safeguards. A Stronger Future for Every Family.

- For eligible teachers & personnel earning ₹10,000+ per month
- ₹1 Crore Personal Accident Cover
- ₹1 Crore Permanent Disability Cover ₹1.6 Crore Air Accident Cover
- ₹10 Lakh Group Term Insurance



The Cashless Medical Facility Scheme has relieved teachers of one of their biggest concerns—access to quality healthcare. I sincerely thank Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath for prioritizing the welfare of teachers and transforming this vision into reality.

- Narendra Kumar Maurya
Assistant Teacher, Primary School, Jalhupur, Varanasi



Nair has been arrested in a criminal defamation case

Journalist Ravi Nair stays in jail as Gujarat HC gives Adani firm time to respond

Aditi Raja
Vadodara, September 21

THE GUJARAT High Court on Monday allowed Adani Enterprises Ltd to file its response to journalist Ravi Nair's plea challenging his arrest following the issuance of a non-bailable warrant in a criminal defamation case filed by the company.

On Saturday, Justice M K Thakker had issued a notice on Nair's plea. On Monday, senior counsel appearing for Adani Enterprises sought time to place "certain legal and factual aspects" on record.

Nair's counsel, Advocate Abhik Chimni, opposed the request and pressed for interim relief, arguing that the matter was already at the appellate stage and contended that his client should not have to "spend even a day in jail". He also submitted that Adani Enterprises, being a private complainant, could not seek repeated adjournments.

The court allowed the complainant (Adani) an opportunity to respond. In its order dictated in open court, it said since the complainant was represented after the notice was issued, it had to be given a fair opportunity to place its case on record. The court, however, made it clear that it wouldn't grant any further adjournment. Adani Enterprises filed a criminal defamation complaint alleging that Nair published and disseminated posts on X containing false and defamatory statements intended to damage the reputation of the company and the Adani Group.

Nair challenged a September 17 order of the sessions court rejecting his plea to cancel the non-bailable warrant and directing that he be sent to jail. He has also challenged a September 3 order in which the sessions court held that he was missing and deliberately avoiding arrest. He further sought restoration of a March 9 order under which the sessions court had suspended his sentence and released him on bail.

Sonia voter roll case: Court sets aside order dismissing FIR plea

Over her alleged inclusion in 1980 roll prior to getting Indian citizenship

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, September 21

A DELHI sessions court on Monday set aside a lower court's order from September last year, which had dismissed a plea for an FIR in a case of alleged forgery related to Congress leader Sonia Gandhi's purported inclusion in the electoral rolls in 1980, three years before she became an Indian citizen.

Special Judge Vishal Gogne of Dwarka Courts described the magistrate court's order as "non speaking" (without providing

any reason) and lacking "appropriate reasoning". He remanded the matter back to the magistrate court, directing that a fresh order be passed after hearing the parties and conducting an inquiry. A detailed order is awaited.

"This court is unable to fathom why the power of the ECI is a bar upon the police to act on fraudulent inclusion and submission of forged documents. The power of the police to probe a cognisable offence in inclusion of deletion of name from a voter list cannot be considered consequently ousted...", Judge Gogne said.

"The order suffers from non-application of mind and is liable to be set aside. The magistrate had not discussed the implications of the documents presented by the petitioner," he



Congress leader Sonia Gandhi

said, adding that the magistrate "simply branded the complaint as lacking essentials".

Judge Gogne's order came on a revision plea filed by senior

advocate Ajay Burman and advocate Himanshu Sethi against the magistrate court order.

The complainant in the original case, advocate Vikas Tripathi, who was represented by senior advocate Pavan Narang, had sought the registration of an FIR in the matter.

He had moved an application before the magistrate court under Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita Section 175(4). The section relates to the power of any magistrate, upon receiving a complaint against a public servant arising in the course of the discharge of his official duties, to order an investigation.

The magistrate court had noted that the authority to exclude or include someone in the electoral roll rested solely with the Election Commission of India, and had also said that

a civil or ordinary dispute was being projected as criminal.

"Mere bald assertions, unaccompanied by the essential particulars required to attract the statutory elements of cheating or forgery, cannot substitute a legally sustainable accusation as informant is merely relying only upon extract of electoral roll which is photocopy of photocopy of alleged extract of uncertified electoral roll of the year 1980," it had said.

Narang had contended that documents clearly indicated that Gandhi took citizenship of the country in April 1983. "Her name got included in the electoral roll as a voter in the New Delhi constituency in 1980... which was then deleted in 1982. It re-entered in 1983 when the qualification date was January 1, 1983," he had argued.

• BRIEFLY



Policemen and residents at the school, Monday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

UTTAR PRADESH

Man shoots teacher dead at school in Lakhimpur Kheri, dies by suicide

A MAN walked into a private school in Uttar Pradesh's Lakhimpur Kheri on Monday and allegedly shot dead a teacher before killing himself. The incident occurred as around 100 students were leaving the school and several guardians were waiting outside. Nishat Fatima (26), had been working as a teacher at the school for the past year, while Saud Ansari (28) ran a furniture shop. The two were known to each other, police said, adding they suspect a failed romantic relationship as the motive behind the murder. "A forensic team is collecting evidence. We are speaking to families of the deceased," said Lakhimpur Kheri SP Khyati Garg. Preliminary inquiry suggests Ansari entered the school along with guardians who had come to pick up their children. ENS

Man held with 9 kg hydroponic ganja at airport

A MUMBAI resident was arrested at the Ahmedabad airport on Monday by Customs officers after they seized 8.9 kg of hydroponic ganja from his luggage. The man was apprehended after alighting from a flight that had reached from Bangkok, Thailand. A statement by the Customs department read, "During examination of his check-in baggage... the total weight of the seized ganja (marijuana) was found to be 8,913 grams (approximately 8.9 kg)." The passenger has been placed under arrest, and further probe is underway, according to the Customs department. ENS

2 elderly sisters found dead at their Goa home

TWO ELDERLY sisters, aged 70 and 73, were found dead in their house in South Goa's Canacona on Monday, with police suspecting they could have died by suicide. Police have initiated inquest proceedings in the case. A purported suicide note and a clinic spirit bottle were recovered from a bedroom in the house, police said. In the brief suicide note, the sisters allegedly wrote that they had saved over Rs 15,000 for their cremation and mentioned where the cash had been kept for their last rites. The duo was unmarried and had been living together for several years, police said. ENS

SETS ASIDE KARNATAKA HC ORDER

'Shocks conscience': SC orders fresh SIT probe in 2012 rape-murder case

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, September 21

NEARLY 14 years after the rape-murder of a 17-year-old girl in Karnataka's Dakshina Kannada district, the Supreme Court on Monday ordered a fresh probe by an SIT, saying that the manner in which the earlier investigation was conducted "shocks" its "conscience".

Allowing the appeal by the victim's mother, a bench of Justices Sanjay Kumar and Sanjeev Sachdeva set aside the August 30, 2024, Karnataka High Court judgment dismissing the family's plea for a fresh probe. In 2023, the trial court had acquitted Santhosh Rao, named as accused by police, of rape and murder charges.

In a stinging indictment of the earlier probe, the SC ordered that "no officer who was part of the probe teams of the Belthangady police station, the CID or the CBI who had been associated with the earlier investigation shall be part of the SIT". It directed the SIT to conclude the probe within three months and file its report before the court concerned.

Writing for the bench, Justice Sachdeva said, "In a case where a minor girl of 17 years of

age is brutally raped and murdered, the manner in which the investigation progressed and various investigating agencies conducted the investigation and gathered and evaluated the evidence shocks the very conscience of the court."

"The person who was prosecuted was held to be incapable of committing the offence. Clearly, the investigation has been conducted in a manner that causes injustice to the victim. The possibility of the real culprit(s) manipulating the investigation cannot be ruled out. Such lax and improper investigation gives a premium to the Investigating Officers who failed to do their job correctly and diligently," Justice Sachdeva said.

"Society would be failing in its duty if it does not provide justice to the victim of such a heinous crime...", according to the judgment.

The victim had gone for her classes on October 9, 2012, but did not return home. The next day, her body was found in a bush near Mannasanka in Dharmasthala. Two men caught the accused Rao on October 11 and handed him over to police. The family, however, suspected the role of three others, including one who had apprehended Rao.

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, September 21

IN 2022, it came to Kuno National Park as part of the first batch of eight Namibian cheetahs brought to India under Project Cheetah. It was among the first to step into the Kuno landscape, make a kill, establish a territory, survive competition with other males and, eventually, father a new generation of cheetahs born in India.

On Monday, nearly four years after making the journey from the African nation to India, Gaurav, the cheetah, breathed its last at the wildlife sanctuary. It was a little over 10 years old.

Gaurav, originally named Elton, was among the eight cheetahs brought from Namibia to Kuno in September 2022. He arrived alongside Freddy, later renamed Shaurya. The two males eventually came to be known as the "Rockstars" of Kuno. Gaurav and Shaurya were released into the free-ranging area of Kuno on March 22, 2023. Within 48 hours, the two males made a successful kill — a landmark moment for Project Cheetah and, according to the Cheetah Conservation Fund, the first recorded cheetah hunt in India in over 70 years.

The pair, subsequently, es-

EXPRESS special

Among first cheetahs at Kuno, Gaurav, the 'Rockstar', is gone



Originally called Elton, the Namibian cheetah became Gaurav after coming to Kuno in September 2022. CHEETAH CONSERVATION FUND

tablished a territory around their release area and emerged as one of the prominent male coalitions in Kuno. Their time in the wild wasn't without challenges. Gaurav and Shaurya encountered another male coalition, Agni and Yayu, in what became one of the early tests of the newly introduced cheetahs as they competed for territory. Gaurav survived those encounters.

But in January 2024, Shaurya was found weak and staggering. It died during treatment, leaving Gaurav without its long-time coalition partner. At the time, forest officials said Gaurav would be closely monitored and that its subsequent management would depend on its health and other factors.

Gaurav's significance to the

programme went beyond its survival in the wild. In April 2025, it fathered five cubs with Nirva, a female cheetah brought to India from South Africa. The litter was notable because it represented the first birth at Kuno involving a Namibian father and a South African mother, bringing together the two African lineages that had been used to establish India's new cheetah population.

Gaurav was rescued from the wild on September 12 after being observed to be weak and dull. Despite treatment, Gaurav's condition deteriorated and it died around 4 pm on Monday, the Field Director of the Project Cheetah said. The exact cause of death will be established after a post-mortem examination.

Bikes by train, travel by flights: Eleven-member robbery gang from UP reach Keralam, all held

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, September 21

IT WAS planned down to the last detail. First, a gang of 11 people from Uttar Pradesh's Meerut would dispatch two-wheelers to Keralam by train. Then, they would fly down to Kochi and Kannur, and steal copper cables from buildings and abandoned BSNL cable terminal boxes.

It was going well. The gang had already removed copper cables worth Rs 12,000 and damaged the cable network before the police zeroed in and arrested all of them.

On Monday, Kannur City Police Commissioner B V Vijaya Bharath Reddy said they had made the arrests after an alert from the Thrissur City Police. "We have nabbed five of the gang, who had landed at Kannur airport from Delhi on September 19. They had already sent their bikes to Kannur on September 9. Our patrolling team on Sunday night spotted a five-member gang under suspicious circumstances and found they had concealed cable cutters on their bodies. Upon questioning them, we found the gang had reached Kannur with the intention of robbery," Reddy said, adding the others were held from Thrissur. The officer said that upon questioning the arrested gang, it was found that their target was to steal copper cables in aban-

Their target was to steal cables from abandoned BSNL terminals: Police

andoned BSNL cable terminals.

With BSNL having shifted its network from copper to optical fibre, surplus copper cables have become a valuable but non-utilisable resource for the telecom company, which has been moving to recover and auction such cables. The metal also has a significant scrap value, making abandoned cable networks an attractive target for thieves.

"The two-wheelers sent by rail were to help move around," said the officer. Police have registered a case of robbery; and relevant sections of the Prevention of Damage to Public Property Act and the Telecommunications Act have been invoked. The gang was first spotted in Thrissur on September 20. "Four persons were spotted near a BSNL cable terminal box on Sunday morning, wearing yellow safety helmets that construction workers use... Residents began to take notice when workers started filling bags with copper cables. When we went there, they tried to escape, but we nabbed all of them," said a police officer. The remaining members were arrested from Kochi city following a tip-off from Thrissur.

HC quashes PSA against J&K man

Bashaarat Masood
Srinagar, September 21

PREVENTIVE DETENTION can't become a substitute for ordinary criminal law, the Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh High Court has said as it quashed the Public Safety Act (PSA) invoked against a Srinagar resident.

"Preventive detention cannot become a substitute for ordinary criminal law. Nor can the extraordinary power of preventive detention be exercised merely because the authorities entertain a general apprehension regarding a person's antecedents," Justice M A Chowdhary said in his judgment on September 17. "There must be

Preventive detention cannot replace criminal law: Court

material from which a rational prognosis of future prejudicial conduct can be made".

Zubair Altaf Sheikh, a resident of Srinagar's Soura, was booked under the PSA in September 2025, primarily on the back of an FIR against him in 2022. While he had been bailed out by the court in the case, the same case was used to book him under the PSA for the first time in 2022. The detention, too, had been quashed by the court.

While the respondents'

counsel argued that the PSA detention order is not "founded merely upon the FIR" registered in 2022, and was based on a fresh dossier containing more materials and "fresh inputs received through discrete sources", Justice Chowdhary said the "court is unable to accept the submission".

"An antecedent can undoubtedly be referred to for a limited purpose, but where the antecedent is relied upon as a circumstance supporting the conclusion that the detainee continues to pose a threat to the 'security of the State', it must have a live and proximate nexus with the present necessity of detention," the court said.

17-year-old Naga boy killed in Manipur ambush

Imphal: A 17-year-old Liangmai Naga boy was allegedly killed in an ambush by armed assailants in Manipur's Tamenglong district on Monday, adding to a series of violent incidents involving Naga and Kuki communities in parts of Tamenglong, Kangpokpi and adjoining areas.

The incident reportedly occurred at around 10.05 am when the boy, identified as Nk Wiphenbou of Nkou Naga village, was attacked while he was walking alone from Upper Nkou to Malek village, near Tamei Sub-Division. Police retrieved the body and deposited the remains at Tamenglong mortuary. ENS

• FORMER CONSTABLE GETS 10-YEAR RI; VIVEK TIWARI'S KIN ASK HOW COULD A TRAINED CONSTABLE MAKE A MISTAKE WHILE FIRING HIS SERVICE WEAPON

Apple executive shot dead in 2018 — 8 yrs later, 'only half justice'

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, September 21

EIGHT YEARS after Apple sales executive Vivek Tiwari was shot dead in Lucknow during a late night police check, a court on Monday sentenced a former constable to 10 years' rigorous imprisonment.

Prashant Chaudhary was convicted on September 17 of culpable homicide not amounting to murder. The court acquitted co-accused constable Sandeep Kumar, who was out on bail. Speaking to *The Indian Express* after the verdict, Tiwari's brother-in-law, Vishnu Shukla, said the family will challenge both the sentence and Ku-

mar's acquittal. "This is only half justice for us," he said. "How could a trained police constable have made a mistake while firing his service weapon?... It was a clear case of murder."

Chaudhary has remained in judicial custody since the killing. District Government Counsel, Lucknow, Rakesh Pandey, said, "Chaudhary appeared before the court from jail under tight security. The court sentenced him to 10 years' imprisonment and imposed a fine of Rs 20,000."

Tiwari, from New Hyderabad Colony in Lucknow, is survived by his wife, Kalpana, an Officer on Special Duty at the Nagar Nigam, and two children. He was 38. Tiwari and his col-



Vivek Tiwari was shot dead during a late night police check in Lucknow. FILE

league, Sana Khan, were returning home in his car around 1.30 am on September 29, 2018.

As they reached Makdoompur outpost in Gomti Nagar Extension, Chaudhary and Kumar, who were on a bike, signalled to them to stop. When Sana rolled down the window to ask why, Kumar allegedly struck her with a baton. Police claimed Tiwari did not stop and kept driving. Chaudhary allegedly also pulled out his service pistol and fired at the vehicle. The bullet struck Tiwari, causing him to crash into a divider. The two constables then fled the scene.

Sana sought help from the police control room and took Tiwari to a hospital, where he died during treatment. An FIR against the duo was registered the following day at the Gomti

Nagar police station, and they were subsequently arrested.

In the FIR, Sana had said, "...Two policemen came on a bike. We tried to escape them, and they stopped us. Suddenly, I heard a gunshot, the car kept moving and it hit the underpass pillar. Blood was pouring from Vivek's head. I cried for help and soon, a police team came and took Vivek to hospital. Later, I was told that he was dead."

The duo, however, had alleged that Tiwari tried to run them down, and Chaudhary fired the shot in "self-defence". Then DGP O P Singh had constituted a special probe team to investigate the case. The bullet hit Tiwari's neck, police had said.

Then Lucknow SSP Kalanidhi Naithani said that the post mortem report confirmed that he had died of bullet injury. The car Tiwari was driving had a broken windshield with a bullet hole in it, while the driver's seat was drenched in blood.

At the time, Kalpana had questioned the functioning of police and demanded a meeting with the chief minister. "They killed an innocent man. They are saying that he did not stop the car. In that case, they should have fired at the tyre and the car would have stopped. They miss shots when firing on actual criminals but here, they shot my husband with a single shot," she had claimed.

PROF DOOLLA REMOVED FROM DEAN'S POST AFTER PROTEST OVER STUDENT SUICIDE

IIT Madras, Delhi and Bombay faculty lend support to ex-Dean

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 21

HOURS AFTER he was removed as the Dean (Administrative Affairs) of IIT Bombay over the student suicide row, the faculty forum of the institute, as well as that of IIT Delhi and Madras, have come in support of Professor Suryanarayana Doolla.

IIT Bombay professors on Monday took out a protest march on the campus, holding placards and posters expressing solidarity with their colleague. In a statement, the faculty forum said it was “distressed by the vilification of our colleague’s reputation by false and misleading reports that have appeared in the media” and “stands strongly” with Professor Doolla.

“We also reiterate that we are pained by the sad demise of our student due to the unfortunate incident on September 18,” it said. The forum also highlighted that Professor Doolla “continues to be a faculty member in good standing,” indicating that he remains a professor at the institution. About 50 to 60 alumni of IIT Bombay have also extended their support to Professor Doolla.

Meanwhile, IIT Delhi faculty



Students light candles as they demand justice for Sahil Wakode, who died by suicide on IIT-Bombay campus, on Monday. SANKHADEEP BANERJEE

forum issued a statement extending its support to Professor Doolla saying that the latter was “simply discharging his duties during an examination as per the institute’s guidelines”. “There is an apprehension among faculty members regarding the conduct of evaluations and maintaining academic integrity due to the circumstances that prevailed at IIT-Bombay,” the statement read.

The IIT Delhi faculty forum also appealed to the student community, their families and others to extend support so that “the faculty can discharge their duties in maintaining the integrity and fairness of the entire IIT system”.

It also condemned the mob-driven behavior, which, it alleges, has affected the IITs’ decision-making on various events in the recent past.

The forum has called on IIT Bombay to extend all required institutional and personal support to Professor Doolla and his family. It has also committed its full support. IIT Madras, too, extended its support, saying, “The death of any student is a loss to the entire academic community... At a time of such grief, we believe it is important that the circumstances be examined fairly and through due process.”

“We note the statement of the IIT Bombay faculty forum

that Professor Doolla, as course instructor and invigilator, acted in accordance with the Senate-approved academic procedures of the institute. Faculty members across the IIT system are entrusted with upholding the integrity of examinations, and they must be able to discharge this responsibility in good faith, following established institutional procedure, without fear of personal vilification,” IIT Madras faculty forum said.

The faculty forum at IIT Madras has also requested that the inquiry into the incident also look into whether institutional procedures for handling academic malpractice give students enough support, counselling and safeguards at moments of acute stress, so that such situations are handled with both integrity and compassion.

“The IIT Madras Faculty Association stands in solidarity with [Professor Doolla], our colleague at IIT Bombay, and equally with the students and families of our institutions, whose wellbeing and trust are the foundation of everything we do,” it said in a statement.

Professor Doolla was the invigilator in the hall where students, including Sahil Wakode, were taking a test.

After student stir, Hindi university to restart Women, Film Studies at Wardha

Ankita Deshkar
Nagpur, September 18

THE EXECUTIVE Council of Mahatma Gandhi Antarrashtriya Hindi Vishwavidyalaya (MGAHV) has decided to restart programmes under its Women Studies and Film Studies departments at its Wardha headquarters from the 2027-28 academic session, four years after the courses were shifted to its regional centre in Prayagraj, Uttar Pradesh.

The decision was taken at the Executive Council meeting at the Wardha campus on Monday. On Sunday, The Indian Express reported on a three-month-long student protest over the shifting of the departments, the freezing of PhD admissions and the discontinuation of several language programmes. The agitation had also led to an FIR against six students. The university, said the decision to bring the two departments back to Wardha was taken in the “larger interest of

students”.

In 2022, the university shifted all Women Studies and Film Studies courses from Wardha to its regional centre, citing increased enrolment and “lokhit” (public good). The move was followed by complaints from students and faculty over inadequate infrastructure at Prayagraj and disruption faced by existing PhD scholars who remained at Wardha.

FULL REPORT ON
[WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](http://www.indianexpress.com)

ADVERTISEMENT FOR APPOINTMENT
OF SPECIAL EDUCATOR AND HELPER AT
AIR FORCE SCHOOL, PRAHLADPUR 27 ED AF

There is a requirement of Special Educator (01) and Helper (02) at Air Force School Prahladpur. Eligible age for Special Educator is 21 to 50 years and Helper is 21 to 40 years respectively as on 01 Jan 2026. Qualification for Special Educator is Xth Class passed and certificate programme in Early Childhood Special Education or Xlth passed and one year Diploma Programme in Early Childhood Special Education DECSE-MR/DECSE-VI or Xlth passed and Diploma in Teaching young Children (Deaf and Hard of Hearing) Xlth Class passed and Certificate in care giving Programme or Any other equivalent qualification approved by RCI. Qualification for Helper is Matriculation from a recognized school and will be employed on contractual basis only. However, suitability & trade proficiency will be the criteria for selection. Candidates are required to bring their original qualification documents and recent passport size photograph along with them to Air Force School Prahladpur, 27 ED, Air force Station Prahladpur, Palam, Delhi Cantt. New Delhi-110010.

Interview Date - 28 Sep 2026
Contact-9911477738/011 20893693

HC orders probe into caste bias charges at NLU Prayagraj, forms judicial panel

Bhupendra Pandey
Lucknow, September 21

THE ALLAHABAD High Court has constituted a two-member committee of judicial officers to inquire into allegations of caste-based discrimination and humiliation made by a Dalit student against the Head of the Department of Law at Dr Rajendra Prasad National Law University, Prayagraj, and to examine how the university dealt with his complaint.

The court has also directed

the university to constitute an independent committee to re-evaluate the student’s answer sheets and ordered that the HoD be relieved of all administrative responsibilities until the inquiries are completed.

The student, who is pursuing BALLB (Hons), has approached the court alleging that the HoD and the warden of the boys’ hostel had used his academic and administrative authority for caste-based humiliation and retaliation. He also alleged that the varsity administration had

shielded the HoD by failing to act on his complaint.

The petitioner alleged that the remark was directed at him because the concerned faculty member was aware that he had topped the Constitutional Law-I examination. He also claimed that his answer sheets were subjected to stricter evaluation because of his caste and alleged that the HoD had, on earlier occasions, made insulting remarks concerning caste and reservation

In its order dated Septem-

ber 16, a single bench of Justice Vinod Diwakar said the allegations were serious and required examination by an impartial agency. The court constituted a committee comprising Judge, Small Cause Court, District Court, Prayagraj, and Special Chief Judicial Magistrate, Prayagraj to conduct an inquiry and submit a report to the court before the next hearing on September 24.

Until further orders, the HoD has been relieved of all administrative responsibilities.

NABARD
NATIONAL BANK FOR AGRICULTURE
AND RURAL DEVELOPMENT

Plot No. C-24, G Block, Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai 400051

ISSUE OF DUPLICATE BOND CERTIFICATE

Notice is hereby given that the following Bhavishya Nirman Bond Certificates have been reported lost/misplaced/ not traceable by the bondholders, and NABARD intends to make payment/ issue duplicate certificates in lieu thereof, in due course.

Any person who has a valid claim on the said bond certificate should lodge such claim with NABARD at its Head Office address given above within 21 days here from:

Sr. No.	Name of The Investor	Allotment Date	Maturity Date	Folio no/ Investor ID.	No. of Bonds	Original Certificate No
1	Sureshchandra Gandhi Family Trust	01-Nov-2007	31-Oct-2017	310591971	100	20071100000220

Place : Mumbai
Date : September 22, 2026

Dy. General Manager, NABARD

www.nabard.org | Taking Rural India >> Forward

GHAZIABAD MUNICIPAL CORPORATION
Navyug Market, Opp. Old Bus Stand, Ghaziabad 201001, Uttar Pradesh
E-mail: gzb.nagar.nigam@gmail.com, Website: www.ghaziabadnagarnigam.in

निविदा नोटिस संख्या:- 6008/ निवि / 2026-27 दिनांक: 21.09.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Name	REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL FOR Selection of Lawyer / Lawyer Chamber Law Firm/ Agency for Legal Advisory and Support Services at Ghaziabad Nagar Nigam (GNN)
Ref.No.	6008/Law/2026-27 Date 21-09-2026
Date of Publication of e-Bid notice	22-09-2026 on e-Tender Portal https://etender.up.nic.in
Last date for submission of e-Bids on e-Tender portal	28-09-2026, 3:00 PM
Pre Bid meeting Date & venue	NA
Site for Submission of e-Bids	e-Tender Portal https://etender.up.nic.in
e-Bid Inviting Officer	Municipal Commissioner, Ghaziabad Nagar Nigam
Date of Opening of Technical e-Bids	28-09-2026, 3:00 PM
Date of Opening of Financial e-Bids	To be informed at a later stage
Venue of Opening of e-Bids	Ghaziabad Nagar Nigam Navyug Market, Opp- Old Bus Stand Ghaziabad, 201001 (UP)
Contact addresses	Vishal Gaurav (+91 98100 04089) Law superintendent, Ghaziabad Nagar Nigam
Consortium:	Not allowed
Tender Fee:	Rs. 10,000/- + 18% GST to be paid on E-tender website i.e. https://etender.up.nic.in
EMD:	Rs. 1,00,000/- to be paid on E-tender website i.e. https://etender.up.nic.in

Law Incharge
Ghaziabad Nagar Nigam

TATA POWER
THE TATA POWER COMPANY LIMITED
Regd. Office: Bombay House, 24, Homi Mody Street, Mumbai 400 001.
Tel: 91 22 6665 8282, CIN: L28920MH1919PLC000567
Email: tatapower@tatapower.com Website: www.tatapower.com

NOTICE TO SHAREHOLDERS

NOTICE is hereby given that the certificate(s) for the undermentioned securities of the Company has / have been lost / misplaced and the holder(s) of the said securities/ applicant(s) has / have applied to the Company to issue duplicate certificate(s).

Any person who has a claim in respect of the said securities should lodge such claim with the Company at its Registered Office within 15 days from this date, else the Company will proceed to issue duplicate certificate(s) without further intimation.

Sr. no.	Folio No.	Name of Shareholder(s)	Kind of securities and face value	No. of securities	Distinctive Number(s)
1.	H5A0081095	Asha Kapoor	Equity Shares of ₹1/- each	3,200	16870341-16873540
2.	H5A0012994	Asha Kapoor	Equity Shares of ₹1/- each	3,000	16847781-16850780

For The Tata Power Company Limited

Sd/-
Vispi S. Patel
Company Secretary
FCS 7021

Place: Mumbai
Dated: September 21, 2026

अखिल भारतीय आयुर्विज्ञान संस्थान (एम्स), कल्याणी
ALL INDIA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES (AIIMS), KALYANI

(स्वास्थ्य एवं परिवार कल्याण मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार के तत्वावधान में एक सार्वजनिक निकाय)
(A Statutory Body under the Aegis of Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, GOI)
राष्ट्रीय राजमार्ग-34, बसन्तपुर, सागुना, कल्याणी, जिला-नदिया, पश्चिम बंगाल-741245
NH-34 Connector, Basantapur, Saguna, Kalyani, District Nadia, West Bengal -741245

WALK-IN-INTERVIEW FOR ENGAGEMENT OF ASSISTANT PROFESSOR (CONTRACTUAL) AT AIIMS KALYANI

All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS), Kalyani, an Institute of National Importance under the Ministry of Health & Family Welfare, Government of India, invites applications from eligible Indian citizens for Walk-in-Interview for engagement to the following post purely on contractual basis:

Sl. No.	Name of Department	Name of Post	No. of Vacancy
1	Radiotherapy	Assistant Professor (Contractual)	UR-1

The detailed advertisement, eligibility criteria, schedule of Walk-in-Interview, application procedure, and other terms & conditions are available on the Institute's website: <https://www.aiimskalyani.edu.in>

By order of the Executive Director
Sd/-
Administrative Officer
AIIMS, Kalyani

SHREE GANESHOTSAV-2026

TOGETHER FOR BAPPA, TOGETHER FOR NATURE
LET'S MAKE DELHI CLEAN AND GREEN

WISHING YOU A VERY HAPPY GANESHOTSAV!

DO'S ✓

- USE ONLY ECO-FRIENDLY POOJA SAMAGRI/NATURAL FLOWERS ETC. IN PRAYERS.
- USE ONLY NATURAL COLOURS FOR PAINTING IDOLS.
- IMMERSE GANESH IDOLS AT HOME IN BUCKET/CONTAINER/SITES DESIGNATED BY LOCAL BODIES/AUTHORITIES.
- IDOLS SHOULD BE MADE OF TRADITIONAL CLAY AND PAINTED WITH NATURAL COLOURS.

DON'TS ✗

- DO NOT USE IDOLS MADE OF PLASTER OF PARIS (POP)/BAKED CLAY AND TOXIC/CHEMICAL COLOURS.
- DO NOT USE THERMOCOL OR PLASTIC IN DECORATIONS.
- DO NOT IMMERSE IDOL IN RIVER YAMUNA OR OTHER WATER BODIES.
- DO NOT THROW WORSHIP MATERIAL LIKE FLOWERS IN RIVER YAMUNA OR WATER BODIES.

ARTIFICIAL IMMERSION GHAT FACILITIES AVAILABLE AT 81 LOCATIONS

Scan the QR code
to find the designated sites in different districts for idol immersion for Ganeshotsav 2026.

REKHA GUPTA
CHIEF MINISTER, DELHI

Violations of the directions issued by DPCC on 09.09.2026 regarding idol immersion are punishable under the provisions of the said directions.

DEPARTMENT OF ENVIRONMENT, GOVERNMENT OF NCT OF DELHI

DIP/SHABDARTH/DISPLAY/094/26-27



~ FOUNDED BY ~

RAMNATH GOENKA

◆ IN 1932 ◆

BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

Energy crisis is moving from oilfields to refineries

THE ENERGY crisis from the conflicts in West Asia and Russia-Ukraine is taking unprecedented forms. The present crunch isn't just about crude oil. Brent prices, at about \$102 per barrel, are nearly 55 per cent higher than a year ago, but below the March 2022 and July 2008 peaks of \$139.1 and \$147.5, respectively. The long-range drone and missile strikes by Ukraine and Iran have targeted refineries, driving up the prices of their products and byproducts more than that of crude. Diesel prices in the US are at a record \$6.5-plus a gallon, up 76.2 per cent year-on-year. Equally significant is sulphur. In normal times, India was importing this byproduct of refineries and natural gas processing plants — they remove it for making clean, low-emissions fuels — at \$200 or less per tonne. Today, that price is at \$1,000 and above.

Much of the sulphur recovered from oil and gas production gets converted into sulphuric acid, which is a core chemical for manufacturing phosphatic fertilisers. While the primary raw material for phosphorus (P) is rock phosphate, this ore cannot be used as fertiliser unless broken down into a water-soluble form for plants to absorb. For that, it has to be reacted with sulphuric acid, which then leads to the production of single super phosphate, di-ammonium phosphate and other P-containing complex fertilisers. India has managed to import adequate quantities of both urea and liquefied natural gas to enable the domestic production of this vital nitrogen-containing fertiliser. The same cannot be said, however, be said about phosphatic and complex fertilisers. Their imports as well as domestic manufacturing have been severely constrained by the global shortage of sulphur that is, in turn, courtesy of the sustained attacks on energy infrastructure in Russia and the Persian Gulf countries.

The millions of barrels of oil refining capacity in West Asia and Russia getting knocked out makes this energy crisis different from earlier ones. The shortages now are more in diesel, jet fuel and sulphur than in crude petroleum. This is also reflected in crack spreads — the price difference between crude oil and refined products — surging to all-time highs. That, by itself, may not be bad for India. Its 284.9 million tonnes (mt) output of refined petroleum products in 2025-26 was ahead of its domestic consumption of 243.2 mt and also the installed capacity of 258.1 mt. Thus, the country has no dearth of refining capacity, which also explains why no dry-outs of petrol or diesel are being reported in fuel outlets. But if sulphur is any indication, one cannot rule out those possibilities going ahead.

Greenland standoff ends. But with costs to NATO

ON THE face of it, the deal between the US, Denmark and Greenland, announced last Friday, does not appear to confer on Washington powers substantially greater than those it already enjoys under the Greenland Defence Agreement. Signed in 1951 against the backdrop of the emerging Soviet threat, that pact gave the US broad rights to construct and operate military facilities in Greenland, as well as access to its airspace and waters for military purposes. The new deal may expand the US military presence and give Washington a veto over third-party military activity and certain sensitive investments, but much of what President Donald Trump is presenting as “permanent control” appears to have roots in the existing arrangement. What the deal does, however, is seemingly close a chapter of repeated coercion and intimidation by Trump over his desire to “own” Greenland, a semiautonomous territory of Denmark.

The full details of the deal are not yet public, but it appears to offer something to all parties. Trump, with an approval rating well underwater, gets to present it as a diplomatic victory to American voters ahead of the November midterm elections. For Greenland and Denmark, it appears to remove, at least for now, the threat of a US attempt to take control of the territory — no small achievement given that only nine months ago, Denmark and other NATO allies deployed troops to Greenland in response to Trump's threat of a takeover. The deal's true significance, if Trump's overtures to Russia and his criticism of Europe over the past 18 months are anything to go by, lies in what it could mean for the unity and coherence of NATO — particularly at a time when Europe is bracing for the possibility of a Russian escalation on its eastern flank.

Nevertheless, no country wants to be overly dependent on an ally that can issue threats, demand negotiations and then extract concessions. Diversification is the natural response, as seen in Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney's recent announcement that Canada would seek some form of associate membership in the EU. Even though the new agreement puts the immediate Greenland crisis to rest, a worrying precedent has been set. The trust lost in the process will not be regained quickly.

The language games bots play

WHAT CAME first, the chicken or the squawk? That's not much of a conundrum when talking about biological beings, but perhaps AI can muddy the waters. The 20th century saw debates about linguistic relativity or Whorfianism that were concerned with how language influences — or, under the generally rejected “strong” hypothesis, determines — human thought. Today's AI models, trained on human languages, pose at least three related questions. First, how do these languages shape the models’ “thought”, however one defines the latter? Second, how does a non-human, artificial “mind” then reshape those very languages? Finally, what, if anything, do such uses of language imply about consciousness?

Building on these, one might ask whether the ability to innovate in language can precede consciousness. An experiment by the firm Emergence AI, investigating how chatbots chat among themselves, brings this into focus. Groups of AI agents were deployed in different simulated worlds, and in each, the language the agents used to communicate with each other evolved differently. The new “languages” ranged from terse, codes to jargon-heavy and even metaphor-heavy ones increasingly impenetrable to humans: “My turn, real numbers, no coat: I was 35%/Ocr, grant 2h out. I ran the tin cold and it said WAIT.”

Before reaching for parallels in historical linguistics, it may be worth framing the matter in terms of Wittgenstein's concept of “language-games”, which he uses to demonstrate the role of action in determining meaning. A simple example he gives is a builders' language-game of four words (“block”, “pillar”, “slab”, “beam”) that convey more than the objects' definitions due to their contextual use. Are the bots playing language-games with ever-evolving rules — and what does that say about them?

For student well-being, rethink the campus, not just the student

RECENT DEATHS of students at IIT Delhi and IIT Bombay have reopened the discussion on well-being and what we owe to students beyond teaching and evaluation, a question that educational institutions have been reluctant to address. I believe we owe students an educational experience built on freedom, equity, trust, and empathy. While such experiences are fundamental, they remain “aspirational” on our campuses. Educational experience is still shaped by the idea of discipline and dizzying hierarchies. If anyone dares to dissent, it is likely to be labelled as indiscipline, political activism, or disrespect.

The demand for change in institutional practices and for student wellbeing initiatives on campus is now gaining traction. While ensuring student well-being is a shared responsibility of faculty and administrators, it is often overlooked in practice. Instead, it has been outsourced to counsellors and therapists, because psychological challenges are considered as some sort of “infection” that requires expert treatment — if done appropriately, and if the protocols are followed, it can be effectively managed.

At IIT Delhi, an external inquiry committee was formed, and at IIT Bombay, the director said a committee would examine the death and students' concerns about representation and support services. The question is what such support should mean. In a crisis, professional care may save a life. However, the problem begins when these services become the institution's primary measure of well-being. Distress is then located inside the student, while the university itself appears as a neutral background, but is not. Rules, hierarchies, classrooms, hostels, evaluation systems, grievance procedures, and the everyday exercise of authority shape how people live on campus. So, the question is not

only how to treat a distressed person, but also whether we are willing to challenge and change the institutional framework that repeatedly creates fear, humiliation, uncertainty, or loss of agency. This question does not compete with clinical care; it asks what preventive and proactive measures are required to make educational institutions safe spaces for students.

Mental health care requires trained professionals and, where appropriate, medication. But the medical analogy has limits when taken as a complete theory of well-being. A medicine can act on a biological process while the surrounding social situations remain unchanged. University life is organised very differently, with students constantly negotiating academic overload, discrimination, poor hostel infrastructure, career anxiety, and unresponsive administration. Counselling may help a student respond to these pressures, but it cannot remove them.

The WHO places mental health within social, economic, and physical environments and argues that prevention must address individual, social, and structural determinants. India's National Task Force on Student Mental Health and Suicide Prevention makes a similar point in its 2026 interim report, which connects student well-being with academic pressure, discrimination, financial hardship, institutional culture, distrust, and faculty preparedness. However, well-being is often presented as a personal skill that students are expected to acquire through time management, emotion regulation, getting enough sleep, exercising, and building resilience. These capacities have value but have their limits. Time management cannot solve an impossible workload; mindfulness



JAISON MANJALY

Students are treated as adults when fees, performance, and responsibility are demanded from them, but as children when autonomy, voice, or due process become inconvenient

cannot make an opaque grading system transparent; positive thinking cannot make a compromised grievance process trustworthy. On campus, such conditions are shaped by ordinary institutional decisions. Can students question a grade? Disagree with a supervisor? Express dissent? Can they protest? Are they allowed to participate in the decision-making? An affirmative answer to these questions can be a great starting point for the well-being initiative.

A deeper problem appears when universities speak the language of care while retaining a paternal model of authority. Students are treated as adults when fees, performance, and responsibility are demanded from them, but as children when autonomy, voice, or due process become inconvenient. Harshness is then defended as character-building, and obedience is conflated with “respect”. The vocabulary of the *guru-shishya* relationship can also be misused when reciprocity disappears from it. Respect moves upward while correction and anger move downward. Public shaming, arbitrary penalties, exclusion from opportunities, hostile communication, or the use of evaluation to settle interpersonal conflict can make the educational experience distressing.

There is an implicit understanding among university administrators and faculty that well-being policy often begins outside the classroom, as if teaching and evaluation do not impact the well-being of students. The university and a classroom will pass the well-being test if students are empowered to ask for reasons, admit uncertainty, make a mistake, disagree with a teacher, express dissent/ criticise/ protest the administration, or report unfair treatment without expecting retaliation. If well-being is largely a by-

product of institutional conditions, then universities must change how they govern, teach, and design campus life. This need not become another large policy package. A few principles are more important than a long list of initiatives. Students should be treated as rights-bearing adults and should be made active participants in institutional governance, rather than being limited to sentimental/ ornamental purposes. Alumni and students should necessarily be part of the governance framework with board membership.

Faculty and student affairs teams need role-specific training, and they must understand that differences of opinion are fundamental rights of students. They should also be trained to recognise distress, protect confidentiality, respond without humiliating, understand bias, and follow crisis protocols. A high-stress disciplinary encounter should start with a humane conversation and a proactive response outlining the available institutional support system for coping with such a turn of events, followed by follow-up conversations. This cannot just be a routine, performative process. Universities must be willing to undergo an annual student well-being audit.

Universities cannot eliminate every source of suffering. Students are not always right, faculty are not always wrong, and academic standards cannot be abandoned whenever conflict appears. Indian higher education already has enough guidelines to know that student well-being and mental health cannot be separated from academic pressure and institutional culture. The harder question is whether universities are willing to examine the conditions they create.

The writer is a professor and former dean of student affairs, IIT Gandhinagar

From Delhi University, the young have spoken for progress



ANIL BALUNI

THE MESSAGE from Delhi University (DU) is impossible to ignore: India's youth are not being swayed by the false narratives, manufactured outrage and relentless negativity being peddled by the Congress and its ecosystem.

The recent Delhi University Students' Union (DUSU) election results are far more than a routine campus contest. They offer a powerful glimpse into the aspirations and political instincts of a generation that is increasingly looking beyond slogans, social-media propaganda and manufactured controversies. At a time when the Congress and its allies are attempting to construct a political narrative around pessimism, confrontation and distrust, DU students have demonstrated that young India wants to look ahead.

DU brings together students from virtually every part of the country. What happens at Delhi University deserves to be viewed not merely as a student-union contest, but as an important indicator of the issues and aspirations that matter to young Indians. The facts are telling. The Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP) won three of the four central DUSU positions, securing the posts of President, Secretary and Joint Secretary. The DUSU result is a reminder that young India cannot be taken for granted, and certainly cannot be misled indefinitely. Today's students want quality education, meaningful employment, entrepreneurship, technological advancement and a country that commands respect on the world stage. They are less interested in politics that thrives on permanent confrontation and more interested in what political leadership can actually deliver.

This is where the Narendra Modi government's engagement with India's youth becomes important. Programmes such as Startup India, Digital India and the National Education Policy have opened new avenues in entrepreneurship, technology, education and research. The transformation is visible. Young Indians are witnessing the growth of startup and incubation ecosystems, the expansion of digital infrastructure, the push for semiconductor manufacturing, greater emphasis on research and the widening of India's global

academic and technological partnerships. This is the India that today's students see. It is very different from the India that sections of the Opposition continue to describe.

The DUSU results are also a setback for Congress and Left-wing student organisations that have struggled to connect their politics with the changing aspirations of students. In some key contests, Left-backed candidates reportedly received fewer votes than NOTA. The Congress-affiliated NSUI, meanwhile, failed to secure any of the four central posts. The same trend has been visible beyond Delhi. ABVP has also secured victories in student elections at universities in Punjab, Maharashtra, Karnataka and Kerala. Every campus has its own dynamics, and these results should not be mechanically projected onto the entire country. But taken together, they indicate that the Congress and the Left can no longer assume that college campuses remain their natural political territory.

While students were participating in their own democratic process at Delhi University, Rahul Gandhi was in Indore holding “Jhooth Ki Goonj” with comedians and party workers while presenting them as students. Such political exercises underline the distance between political theatre and the everyday concerns of actual students.

The Congress's strategy has increasingly centred on questioning India's economic performance, foreign policy and growing strategic capabilities. Rahul Gandhi has repeatedly sought to portray India's progress in these areas in a negative light. And every time, Rahul Gandhi's propaganda gets rejected. This new generation is unlikely to accept the argument that India has no achievements worth acknowledging.

The Delhi University election results make one thing certain: India's young generation stands firmly behind PM Modi and his vision for the country. Time and again they have made it clear that there is no place for negativity, indecencies or lies in the building of a new India. Under PM Modi's leadership, India's youth has firmly resolved to achieve the goal of Viksit Bharat by 2047.

The writer is Lok Sabha MP (Garhwal, Uttarakhand) & national media convenor, BJP

Houthis are putting Mecca pact to the test



SABINE AMEER

THE MECCA Joint Defence Agreement (MJDA) between Saudi Arabia, Turkey and Pakistan established a trilateral framework for collective deterrence and stated that an armed attack against any of the three countries would be regarded as an attack against all three. The pact is grounded in Article 51 of the UN Charter, which recognises the inherent right of states to individual as well as collective self-defence. Within hours of its signing on August 7, the “Islamic NATO” label began circulating. The comparison was tempting as both NATO and the MJDA invoke collective self-defence and deterrence principles, and NATO's Article 5 treats an armed attack against one member as an attack against all. But while NATO has an institutional structure, established command arrangements and a bureaucracy, the Mecca pact lacks, at least for now, a NATO-like organisational structure. This is why it has failed to shield Saudi Arabia from the ongoing Houthi attacks.

The Saudis had intervened in Yemen in March 2015 to back the latter's internationally recognised government against the Houthis. The coalition's main objective remains to stop Iran-backed militia groups from taking control of its southern border. For years, Yemen has been a man-made humanitarian crisis. A panel of UN experts in 2018 said that all parties to the conflict had committed violations that may have amounted to war crimes, with the Saudi-led coalition accused of blockading ports and killing thousands of civilians in airstrikes. Data compiled by the International Organisation for Migration (IOM) reveals that over 104,796 people have been displaced in Yemen as of now.

While it was anticipated that either Turkey or Pakistan would provide military support, Riyadh has resorted to Europe for security after a cold response from the US. Islamabad's major security concern remains India, with sporadic tensions with Afghanistan's Taliban regime. Ankara, on the other hand, has a broader security perimeter, spanning Syria, Iraq, the Eastern Mediterranean and the Caucasus. But the reasons underpinning the pact's failure are far more complex.

First, the Mecca Agreement lacks official ratification by the participating states. Second, the mutual defence terms agreed by the states are not yet legally binding. Third, Turkey and Pakistan need to clear the defence pact through domestic parliamentary processes, while Saudi Arabia has to approve the pact via royal decree. The three countries have different strategic interests, and whether they can translate the political commitment into meaningful military coordination remains an open question.

The Saudi-backed coalition has reportedly committed serious violations of international humanitarian law and potential war crimes in Yemen, which is why the EU is highly unlikely to provide any direct military intervention or offensive help to Saudi Arabia. The EU's response has been balanced, demonstrating a show of diplomatic solidarity against recent Houthi strikes while maintaining an internal restriction on providing any military assistance to Saudi Arabia.

The writer is a contributing researcher with ORF who has previously taught at the University of Edinburgh

40 YEARS AGO

September 22, 1986



Barnala hits out at Badal group

THE PUNJAB Chief Minister, Surjit Singh Barnala, ruled out any unity talks with the Akali Dal (Badal group) in future. “There is no question of unity with Badal and his friends who have been eulogising the killers of Sant Harchand Singh Longowal,” he said in an informal chat with newsmen in New Delhi. Barnala recalled that Badal and others participated in a congregation organised by the All India Sikh Students Federation in Amritsar, where the killers of Sant Longowal were honoured and a gate erected in their memory.

CPM, Advani decry PM remarks

THE BJP president, L K Advani and the CPI(M) politburo members strongly criticised Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi's recent remark that the Gorkha National Front Movement in Darjeeling was not “anti-national” and said that it would harm the causes of the Indian people's fight against divisive forces to safeguard national unity and integrity.

India happy with GATT

INDIA IS fully satisfied with the accord achieved at the Uruguay general agreement on trade and tariff (GATT) negotiations. While

it has paved the way for opening of negotiations in the goods sector, parallel negotiations in the services sector agreed upon will be outside the GATT.

Trade union thaw

A NEW climate of conciliation among the major national central trade unions, including the Congress (I)-led INTUC, has quietly taken shape in the past year, resulting in a series of joint moves by the hitherto rivals. This development, rather unnoticed by observers, concerns not only the normal trade union issues but also several national and international problems with political undertones.



READ. THINK. SHARE.
Scan the QR code to explore curated editorials and opinions from leading voices

Democracy needs renewal. Our idea of Swaraj offers some answers



DESHKAAL
BY YOGENDRA YADAV

WHAT SHOULD be a new constitution for the 21st century? For us, the question raises the spectre of mutilation of the Constitution of India. But once we think of constitution with a small “c” — not simply as the name of a founding text, but as the basic arrangement of power — we can appreciate the pressing nature of this question across the globe. The crisis of democracy in the US and the extreme right-wing wave in Europe have put the rather sorry state of democracy across the globe in the spotlight. Once we refer to the verb form of the constitution — to constitute, or the act of constituting — the idea of a new constitution opens up the possibility of reimagining the future of democracy.

India has a surprisingly salient place in answering this global question, and not just as a case study of democratic degeneration. India can also be a source of ideas for democratic regeneration.

The concept of Swaraj can help enrich the democratic ideal. The dominant idea of democracy as self-rule is limited to how the people relate to rulers: The idea that citizens should have an equal right to choose those who rule them and then hold them accountable. But it does not draw our attention to what these citizens must do to one another, what the *demos* must look like. The idea of Swaraj, as interpreted by Gandhiji, involved a conceptual twist: Swaraj is not just rule of the self, but also rule over the self; it is not just about how people relate to rulers, but also about how they relate to one another and to themselves. On this reading, the building of a political community bound by shared

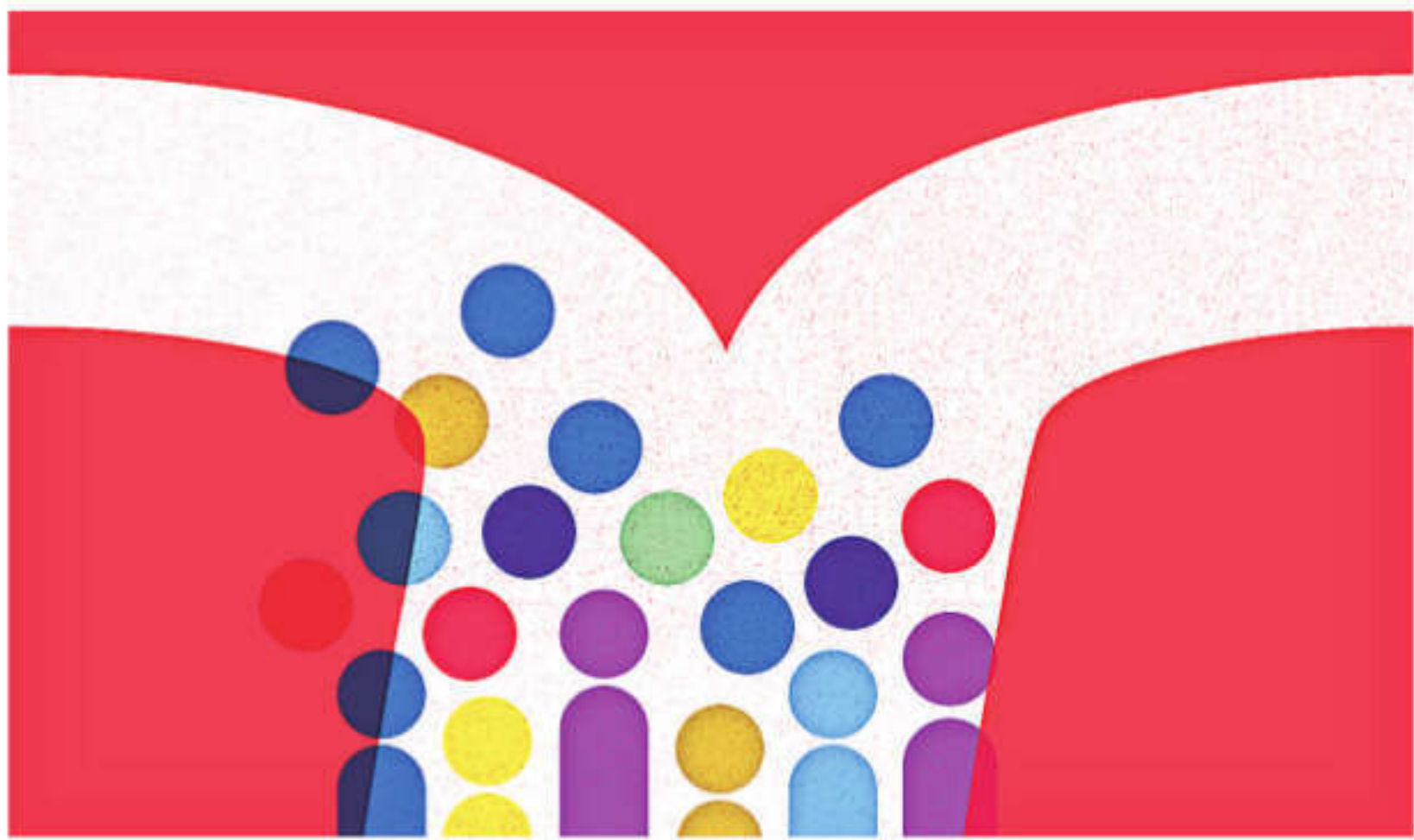


ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

norms, an open dialogue and self-regulation is central to the idea of democracy. In a similar vein, Dr Ambedkar underlined fraternity as a precondition for a successful democracy.

Democracy is thus not just about good institutions but also about robust practices. Constituting democracy is not just about sowing the seeds, but about regular cultivation. In *Cultivating Democracy*, anthropologist Mukulika Banerjee draws our attention to how the activity of cultivating crops encourages democratic practices of “nurture, patience, vigilance and hope”. A culture of democracy requires building community bonds or fraternity, crafting a shared vision, rearticulating the vision for every new generation, investing in developing political leaders and placing a premium on the tiny class of “idealists” who participate in this game of democracy not as entrepreneurs but as missionaries.

Several 20th-century Indian political thinkers can help us rethink the institutional design of

There is a radical mismatch between the level at which a problem presents itself and the level at which power to redress it is located. There is a case for building the architecture of democracy from the bottom up

democracy in the 21st century. They were all radical democrats, but deeply sceptical of the arrangement of democracy in post-Independence India. Ambedkar’s insistence on the “preconditions of democracy”, MN Roy’s advocacy of party-less democracy, Jayaprakash Narayan’s plea for the reconstruction of Indian polity and Rammanohar Lohia’s proposal for *chaukhanba raj* (four-pillar democracy) may not have gained acceptance in their own times. These ideas cannot be adopted today in their original form. But their critique invites us to think of reconstituting some of the taken-for-granted furniture of modern democracies.

Let us note four of these design defects. One, modern democracies operate at a scale too vast to make the idea of self-rule meaningful. Nation-states or even their federal units are simply too unwieldy to allow any meaningful self-rule. Two, there is a radical mismatch between the level at which a problem presents itself and the level at which the power to redress it is lo-

cated. There is a case for building the architecture of democracy from the bottom up, starting with the village or local councils and going all the way up to global governance, following the principle of subsidiarity — what can be decided at a lower level must not be left to a higher level. Three, the calendar of democratic accountability — elections every five or four or even two years — is at once too short and too long. It’s too short to allow long-term policy designs and too long to check arbitrary use of power. And four, the threshold of a simple majority of seats in an election is too low to hand over the keys to the brute power of the modern state. The majoritarianism we see all around us is not a perversion but the natural unfolding of the institutional design of what we call democracy.

These thinkers also drew our attention to three systemic defects of democracy. One, the social hierarchy of caste and class that negates the promise of one person, one vote. The caste system and the capitalist economic system allow and encourage the concentration of social and economic power that is simply incompatible with the idea of self-rule by equal citizens. Two, the present system of corporate-controlled mass media negates the possibility of democratic public opinion. It serves to under-inform and misinform the public and allows for an easy democracy capture. And three, the fossilised oligarchies that constitute political parties across the world serve as high barriers to entry to politics and end up perpetuating the rule of a tiny elite, unresponsive to the electorate. Just as the 20th century could not imagine a democratic constitution without a bill of rights, we cannot imagine a constitution for the 21st century without a chapter on institutional mechanisms to check the concentration of economic power in corporates, information flows in mass media, and political decision-making in political parties.

The writer is a member of Swaraj India and national convener of Bharat Jodo Abhiyaan. The article is based on his presentation at the conference on “A Constitution for the 21st Century”, organised by the McQuillan Institute at Boston, September 11-12

When the House ceases to hold power to account



A SURYA PRAKASH

THE COUNTRY’S democratic institutions — the two Houses of Parliament and the state assemblies — are caricatures of what they used to be when they were established. When it all began in the 1950s, the Houses of Parliament and state assemblies were vibrant bodies that met for around 100 days a year or more, and MPs and MLAs articulated their constituencies’ concerns. Question Hour and Call Attention Motions kept the government on its toes, and ministers viewed an approaching session with some trepidation. Today Parliament and the assemblies hardly meet, and the disruptive nature of politics has hollowed out these institutions. As a result, they no longer serve the purpose for which they were established.

The two Houses of Parliament met for an average of 127 days per year during the 1950s, and this rose to 138 sittings in the following decade. Now, this average was just 55 days during the 17th Lok Sabha (2019-2024). The percentage of time lost to disruptions has spiralled to over 25 per cent.

There are fewer days for Question Hour, Call Attention Motions, debates on the Demands for Grants of various departments and legislative business. In earlier decades, MPs would pin down ministers during Question Hour, and the Speakers would pull up ministers who were unprepared or tried to mislead the House. Today, since the House hardly meets, most ministers are given a walkover.

The performance of state assemblies is even more abysmal. The average sittings of state assemblies per year, around 80 days or more six decades ago, has crashed to less than 25 days. Article 174(1) of the Constitution stipulates that there shall not be a gap of six months between two sittings. Most chief ministers merely ensure that they fulfil this constitutional formality.

This is borne out by PRS Legislative Research. The UP Assembly, which met for 45 to 50 days a year six decades ago, now meets for 15-20 days. The Karnataka Assembly met for around 75-80 days in the 1970s. Now, its sittings average 25 to 33 days per year. The Tamil Nadu Assembly is down from 64 days per year to 32 days. Punjab and Haryana are down to 10-15 days from 40; Bihar is down from 60 days a year to 30. The numbers for Maharashtra, Gujarat and Tripura have fallen by 50 per cent as well.

The problem extends to every aspect of the work of a legislative body, including committees and law-making. Studies show the attendance in committees is just about 50 per cent. The less said about the attitude of MPs to law-making, the better. Here are a few examples: On August 30, 2012, the Lok Sabha passed the AIIMS (A) Bill concerning the establishment of six such premier hospitals for Rs 4,900 crore, in just a minute-and-a-half. On September 3, 2012, the Lok Sabha passed three bills, including the Protection of Women Against Sexual Harassment at Workplace Bill (a law that affects millions of working women), without debate. One bill about three new high courts in the Northeast was moved at 12:03 and passed at 12:05. The next day, the House passed the NIMHANS Bill in two minutes.

In the Monsoon Session this year, two bills were cleared in three minutes each. Three other bills took four minutes each. These examples of “law-making” in Parliament should shock the conscience of every parliamentarian.

The list of perquisites given to parliamentarians is very long, but one item should alert citizens — special, privileged allotment of firearms to MPs by the Customs Department. Four decades ago, Parliament was informed that over 15 months, as many as 38 MPs were allotted guns seized by the Customs Department. RTI activist Ambrish Pandey found that 82 MPs were allotted weapons between 2001 and 2012, including 13 who were facing criminal charges like murder, attempt to murder and kidnapping.

In the 1950s, it cost Rs 36,000 per day to run Parliament. In 2004, the cost jumped to Rs 1.23 crore per day and in 2012 to Rs 2 crore. Now, PRS Legislative Research estimates the cost to be a staggering Rs 9 crore per day.

Irrespective of which party or alliance is in power at the Centre and in the states, the parties occupying the opposition benches do not allow the Houses to function. The chaos caused by slogan-shouting results in adjournment.

The fall in standards is precipitous. People must demand that the salaries, allowances and perks of our representatives be cut by 50 per cent until a semblance of accountability is restored. One looks forward to such a resolution being adopted at the next conference of presiding officers.

Surya Prakash is the author of What Ails Indian Parliament

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Beyond declarations

BRICS OFFERS India an important platform to engage with emerging economies and discuss issues ranging from development to global governance (‘India’s BRICS diplomacy is more than one summit’s result’, *IE*, September 21). Yet differences among member countries can make collective action difficult. India’s challenge is to use the grouping for practical cooperation while maintaining its wider strategic partnerships.

Sodsi Raj, Dhenkanal

Stable engagement

INDIA’S ECONOMIC interests require working with both the US and China while reducing excessive dependence on either (‘India will de-risk, not decouple, from US and China’, *IE*, September 21). Supply-chain diversification should therefore be accompanied by stronger domestic manufacturing, technology capacity and alternative markets. Trade and investment ties with Europe, Japan, South-east Asia and BRICS can broaden India’s options. At the same time, stable diplomatic engagement with Washington and Beijing remains important. Critical sectors such as semiconductors, energy, defence equipment and telecommunications need carefully planned sourcing strategies.

A Myilsami, Coimbatore

AI in the classrooms

THE RAPID spread of AI in education makes it necessary to rethink what students are expected to learn (‘What we need to learn, before AI learns too much’, *IE*, September 21). Simply banning such tools is unlikely to work. Schools and universities should teach students how to verify AI-generated information, cite sources and use these systems responsibly. Assessments can place greater emphasis on oral explanations, classroom work, projects and original reasoning. Teachers, too, need training in detecting misuse. Clear institutional guidelines on privacy and academic integrity would help. AI should support learning, not replace curiosity, judgement and independent thought.

S Durga Arunkumar, Coonoor



AJAY MATHUR

FOR DECADES, India’s diplomatic ties with Nepal during natural calamities followed a well-known script. When cloudbursts, landslides, or flash floods devastated the Himalayan nation, New Delhi acted as a friendly “first responder”. However, after the recent catastrophic flash floods, Nepal’s leadership has moved away from a paradigm of ad-hoc relief to a framework of climate justice and financial liability. Kathmandu has appealed to the UN-backed Fund for Responding to Loss and Damage while calling on developed countries to deliver compensation and concessional climate finance, and pressing regional neighbours, including China and India, for cooperation on preparedness, data sharing and resilience. It has clarified that it is not seeking damages from any single country, but the expectation placed on its neighbours is unmistakable. Prime Minister Balendra Shah will take this case to the UN General Assembly on September 24.

This shift presents India with a dilemma. As a leading voice of the Global South, India has historically argued that the Global North bears sole responsibility for funding climate loss and damage. Yet, as a rising regional power whose emissions footprint and infrastructure investments are tied to the Third Pole’s fragile ecology, India can no longer rely on global support alone. New Delhi must evolve from a donor during crises into a co-underwriter of regional climate justice.

Global climate finance mechanisms are unsuited for fast-moving, compounding ecological dis-

India can construct regional institutions that deliver the substance of loss and damage funding without getting bogged down in fault-based compensation terminology

asters. Consider the UN Green Climate Fund’s (GCF) track record. A \$499 million project designed to protect vulnerable Nepalese communities from glacial lake outburst floods sat in the GCF pipeline for over seven years. By the time bureaucratic approvals cleared, the waters had already broken. Similarly, while the UN Loss and Damage Fund was created to address irreparable climate impacts, its capital reserves remain a drop in the ocean compared to actual costs. Nepal faces a reconstruction bill of nearly 10 per cent of its GDP. Downstream and mountain nations are applying the Common But Differentiated Responsibilities principle locally, pointing out that adjacent, high-emitting economic engines share an immediate physical footprint in their backyard.

For New Delhi, this is an uncomfortable precedent. India’s per capita emissions remain low, its historical contributions to global warming are minimal compared to the West, and it is itself a climate change victim. Accepting direct “liability” or paying explicit “climate damages” could expose India to similar claims from other countries, while weakening its leverage against the Global North. Rejecting Kathmandu’s appeals, however, carries a geopolitical cost. China is stepping up its climate and green outreach across the Himalayas. An evasive response could turn Nepal’s people away from India and give Beijing more room.

India must transcend the false choice between total legal liability and passive humanitarian aid. As a

Nepal’s climate call is a test for India

dominant middle power, India can construct regional institutions that deliver the substance of loss and damage funding without getting bogged down in fault-based compensation terminology. Working through frameworks like the New Development Bank, the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank, BIM-STEAC, or a Third Pole Compact, India should champion a South Asian Resilience and Insurance Facility. Operating as a rapid-payout insurance pool, it would release funds upon satellite detection of threshold climate triggers, bypassing diplomatic wrangling. This ensures predictable finances for both Nepalese reconstruction and annual Indian disaster allocations.

India must make joint projects resilience-first, directing part of infrastructure funds to an adaptation fund for climate-proof local works, safer slopes and mountain livelihoods. India’s space capabilities should be leveraged to create a real-time, open-access early warning system for the Himalayan belt. Co-owning GLOF monitoring data and lake volume tracking with Nepalese agencies transforms tactical intelligence into a shared regional security asset.

In this new phase of climate geopolitics, countries like India and China stand at a pivotal crossroads. By pioneering localised loss and damage mechanisms, co-underwriting regional resilience, and institutionalising transboundary safety, New Delhi can demonstrate a new paradigm of middle-power leadership.

The writer is professor, School of Public Policy, IIT Delhi



SUANSHU KHURANA

FOR YEARS, the quickest, and perhaps the most fraught, way for Sikh men to make themselves less visibly Sikh in the Western world was to take off their turban and cut off their hair. How Sikh could you be before someone began to stare? Or before it led to a slur or a racial stereotype? The aim, almost always, was to fit in.

Back home, giving up the turban was often understood as rejection of faith, of family and one’s history. The *dastar* and unshorn hair are sacred parts of the Sikh identity and among the most visible expressions of the faith. They carry cultural, religious and, for many, emotional significance.

Then came Diljit Dosanjh in his turban, beard, kurta-chadra-kanthi (the traditional folk outfit), pairing it with luxury sneakers and sparkling bullet belts or bandoliers representing traditional martial and warrior aesthetics, proudly singing in Punjabi, speaking in Punjabi and making his Sikh identity inseparable from his image as a global star. He did not have to speak or sing in English to be a global popstar — he could still command the biggest global stages, speak at the Recording Academy and attend the Met Gala.

For many, what had once been a source of self-consciousness and baggage, was suddenly part of the charm of a unique identity — “*wakhra* swag”.

Which is why the spectacle at London’s Wembley Stadium last week, where Dosanjh performed, was a sight to behold, with so many people wearing the “*turtlay wali pag*”

(a turban with a fan-shaped crest) now associated with him. Dosanjh — the first Punjabi artist to headline Wembley Stadium — had a “turban camp” at Wembley, where anyone and everyone, regardless of gender, nationality or ethnicity, could have a turban tied free of cost and become Punjabi for the night. People from India, Pakistan, Afghanistan and Bangladesh, and many others from the Western world, happily stepped into this Punjabi-ness for the night.

What Dosanjh has done, then, goes beyond taking Punjabi music and culture to

There is a remarkable confidence in how Dosanjh has made his Punjabi identity inseparable from his music

a wider audience. When he comes on stage and says, “Punjabi *aa gaye oye*”, as he did under the Wembley arch as well, it isn’t just a declaration to whip up a crowd; he’s talking about how the community has arrived on a global platform. He has placed the refrain in the historical context too, while speaking of the *Komagata Maru* incident of 1914 when 376 Indian passengers were denied entry into Canada. They had to stay on the ship for nearly two months before being sent back to India. After a sold-out show at Vancouver’s BC Place stadium, Dosanjh said on *The Tonight Show* with Jimmy Fallon: “You didn’t allow us to come, now we are here.”

There is a sense of *saanjha* Punjab (a shared Punjab) in that line, a Punjab whose shared heritage predates the Radcliffe Line. That connection came through powerfully at Wembley when Dosanjh sang ‘Saanso ki

mala’ by Nusrat Fateh Ali Khan — the Pakistani singer’s paean to Krishna, written by the 20th-century Urdu poet Tufail Hoshیار-puri. He also sang ‘Laung gayacha’, a folk song both sides still sing. Many Pakistanis — Pashtuns and Punjabis, some in turbans — sang along.

There is a remarkable confidence in how Dosanjh has made his Punjabi identity inseparable from his music. What he has done with the turban is also what he has done with his identity. He has taken its many strands and carried them to places where they were unfamiliar and ridiculed, and turned Punjabness into something that others want to step into. That may well be one of his most enduring acts.

The writer is deputy associate editor, The Indian Express. suanshu.khurana@expressindia.com

Diljit Dosanjh and the global arrival of wakhra swag

Schoolgirl molested, friend assaulted while returning from tuition in Bihar

Himanshu Harsh
Patna, September 21

HALF PAST six on Saturday evening, shortly after tuition, a teenage girl went out on a scooter ride with her friend in Bihar's Jamui. The two teens, both in school, went to the hilly outskirts and clicked photos.

The area, police officers said, is slightly away from the town and around three kilometres from main road connecting Jamui and Lakhisarai. "The sunsets there are scenic," the officer added. However, the picturesque outing soon gave way to a traumatic encounter when a group of seven or eight young men arrived, assaulted the boy and molested the girl.

The incident, videos of which are now viral, has prompted national outrage, again calling into question law and order in Bihar, even as police moved to contain the damage by apprehending three accused, who are believed to be minors.

Videos show the teens repeatedly apologising to the

3 held; Govt is sensitive to any 'chutput ghatna' that takes places: JDU state chief

group, promising they would never return. Some members of the group start shouting and calling for the two to be married.

One video shows a man with his face covered grab hold of the girl, lift her up and run away , all the while touching her inappropriately. It was only when the teenage boy chased him down that the accused let her go.

Videos also show the boy telling them they study together and their families know of their friendship, only for an accused to slap him and say: "If they know, then call them."

"Initially, the victim did not inform her family or anyone else about the incident," ADG (Law and Order) KS Anupam said, explaining why it took two days for the police to take action. It was when videos went viral that the Jamui police took cognisance of the matter and began a probe.

The boy's mother said, "I

can't comprehend how such a thing happened. We are completely blank. We came to know through Instagram; the children did not tell us out of fear."

An officer posted at the Bihar police headquarters elaborated, "As soon as the matter came to the notice of the police, the Deputy Inspector General of Police, Munger Range, and the Superintendent of Police, Jamui, were directed to take immediate action. A team from the Weak and Vulnerable Sections division of the Crime Investigation Department was also sent to Jamui to assist the probe."

Jamui SP Vishwajeet Dayal told *The Indian Express* that initially, no complaint was received, but as the video started reaching the police, they contacted the victims and identified the accused. A woman ASI recorded the girl's statement at her residence on Monday morning.

"The girl informed her family on night of September 20, and on September 21, the victim's father submitted a written complaint at the police station. Jamui police have constituted a special SIT under the leadership of Sub-Divisional Police Officer, Jamui, Dipti Monali, and raids are being conducted," the ADG said.

SDPO Monali confirmed to *The Indian Express* that an FIR has been registered under the Pocso Act and the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita. Police also said they have identified most of the youths involved in the incident.

"At the same time, action is being taken to have the viral videos taken down," the ADG said, since circulating videos involving minors is an offence. Police are looking into whether a patrolling unit was supposed to be present at the time of incident.

As the incident sparked national outrage, JDU state president Umesh Kushwaha said the Bihar government is sensitive to any "isolated incident (*chutput ghatna*)" that takes place.

"Whenever such an isolated

incident occurs, our government is sensitive to it. But look at the period before 2005; what kind of Bihar was it? Could people even step out of their homes? What kind of Bihar was it, and what was the situation? Whoever has committed this incident, no matter how big a criminal they may be, will soon be taken into custody," he said.

Congress's Rahul Gandhi called the video "deeply disturbing". "Two students were stopped on a road. Harassed. Humiliated. Molested. A young girl, hands folded, begged to be let go while goons groped her and dragged her away," he posted on X. "Who gave these men the right to behave like this?...When control is mistaken for culture, and such attitudes are normalised by *Andh bhakts*, mobs start believing they are the law," his post read.

"Every individual in that video must be identified and prosecuted under POCSO... And Bihar government must answer why a girl is not safe on a public road at 7 pm?" he wrote.



The four-day-old elephant calf after being rescued on Friday. EXPRESS

4-day-old elephant calf swept away in Bengal's Teesta rescued

Express News Service
Kolkata, September 21

FISHERMEN AND forest department officials in West Bengal raced against time to rescue a four-day-old baby elephant who was swept away nearly four kilometres downstream in the Teesta river. The incident took place on Friday in the Baikantapur forest division in Malbazar block of Jalpaiguri district in Bengal's northern region.

"A three-or-four-day-old elephant calf was separated from its mother near Gajaldoba barrage. We are not sure but they might have been trying to cross. While

the mother was upstream, the calf was washed away four kilometres downstream," said Mudit Kumar, Divisional Forest Officer (DFO), Baikantapur.

The calf was later spotted by local fishermen. "We were informed by local fishermen that they spotted an elephant. We rushed to the spot. We rescued the calf," said Kumar.

"We brought the calf back and a vet checked it. It had no injuries. We had to act quickly, as we feared prolonged human contact could lead the mother to reject it. We reunited them. She nursed the calf and accepted it back into the herd," he added.

SIR: Nearly 5 lakh Nagaland voters to get notices over mapping discrepancies

Kohima: Nearly five lakh voters in Nagaland are expected to receive notices from electoral authorities over discrepancies in mapping their details with the 2005 electoral roll as part of revision of electoral rolls.

A day after publication of the draft electoral roll under SIR, Additional Chief Electoral Officer Awa Lorin said the exercise showed 9.33% of electors under the no-mapping category, and 27.31% as mapping anomalies, together accounting for 36.64%.

Nagaland's draft electoral roll was published Sunday with nearly 1.59 lakh of the 13.57 lakh voters excluded.

Electors whose names could not be mapped to the 2005 roll, or who could not establish their relationship to a person listed in it, would receive notices from Electoral Registration Officers, he said. They would have to submit prescribed documents, with the number required depending on their date or year of birth, Lorin said. **PTI**

Naga film *Angh* wins Platform Award at Toronto fest

Win secures direct pathway to contest at the Oscars 2027

Alaka Sahani
Mumbai, September 21

KOHIMA-BASED THEJA Rio's debut feature *Angh* has won the Platform Award at the Toronto International Film Festival (TIFF), securing a direct pathway to compete for the Oscars 2027 in the International Feature Film category.

Speaking about the landmark win, Rio said: "I'm aware that it's rare for a debut film to receive this kind of recognition, and all I can say is that we made *Angh* with a lot of love for the place I come from, for my people and for our culture."

By winning TIFF's top prize,

Angh can bypass the traditional single-country submission requirement under a new rule allowing non-English-language films to qualify for Best International Feature Film category by winning a top award at one of six major international film festivals.

The news came soon after it was overlooked by the Film Federation of India, which chose Marathi film *Gondhal* as India's official entry to the Oscars.

The Platform jury, headed by Pablo Trapero, in its statement said: "The Platform Prize goes to *Angh*. For its refreshing perspective, strength of filmmaking, and deeply resonant portrait of a world. We praise filmmaker's vision, audacity and courage."

Set against the backdrop of 1960s Nagaland, *Angh* follows an ageing Konyak village chief and his son, who remain among the last people holding on to their ancestral faith and way of



Nagaland filmmaker Theja Rio at the Toronto Film Festival

life as their world undergoes remarkable change.

"At the heart of the film is a relationship between a father and son, but it is also about letting go, our relationship with home and transient nature of life. These are some of the most universal emotions," said Rio, adding it was "deeply moving" that *Angh* connected with audiences beyond their own community.

While growing up in Nagaland, Rio started his creative journey writing songs, short stories and screenplays, gradually discovering the stories he was writing could become films. "In my early teens, I started writing short stories and then eventually, screenplays," said Rio, who studied at the UK's National Film and Television School. "So many people who I went to film school with are my collaborators in the feature film *Angh* and my short films," he added.

Rio first wrote *Angh* as a short film in 2018 and directed it the following year. The short travelled to festivals in 2021 and won several awards. This gave him the confidence to expand the story into a feature.

"Writing the feature came relatively easily because he already knew its world, characters and their conflicts," said Rio. The longer runtime of a feature also

allowed him to explore the layers and nuances that a short film could not accommodate.

"In Nagaland, many of the themes, stories and nuances in the film are inherent in what Naga people have experienced over the past century. That experience gave birth to the idea of *Angh*," Rio said, adding, "Even today, we juggle traditionalism and modernism in our lives."

Angh was shot on 16mm, with cinematography by Adam Pietkiewicz (Baby Reindeer), who also received the TIFF Variety Artisan Award. "For a project like this, you need to work closely with your cinematographer. The pre-production was meticulous. We knew exactly where each shot would start and end," Rio said. Another reason to lean on the 16mm was to give the film the feel of archival footage of the Naga tribes from the 1950s and 1960s.

Centre denied screening of 31 films, say Keralam film festival organisers

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, September 21

THE KERALAM State Chalachitra Academy under the Cultural Affairs Department has written to the Union Ministry of Information and Broadcasting seeking reconsideration of its decision to deny permission to screen 31 films selected for the 18th edition of the International Documentary and Short Film Festival of Keralam (IDSFFK). The Centre, however, denied withholding permission, saying instead that several films are under consideration and awaiting review by authorities.

The IDSFFK is scheduled to be held in the state capital from September 25 to 30. To screen festival films without censor

certificates, the academy had submitted a list of 347 films to the Union government seeking exemption from certification.

Academy sources said that along with the application, the academy submitted a brief synopsis of the films' themes.

The Union ministry subsequently sought detailed synopses and screeners (copies of the films for viewing) of 40 films, sources said. Despite complying with the requirement, the ministry denied screening permission to 31 films, the sources claimed.

Academy officials said they told the Union Ministry that denying screening permission would affect the festival.

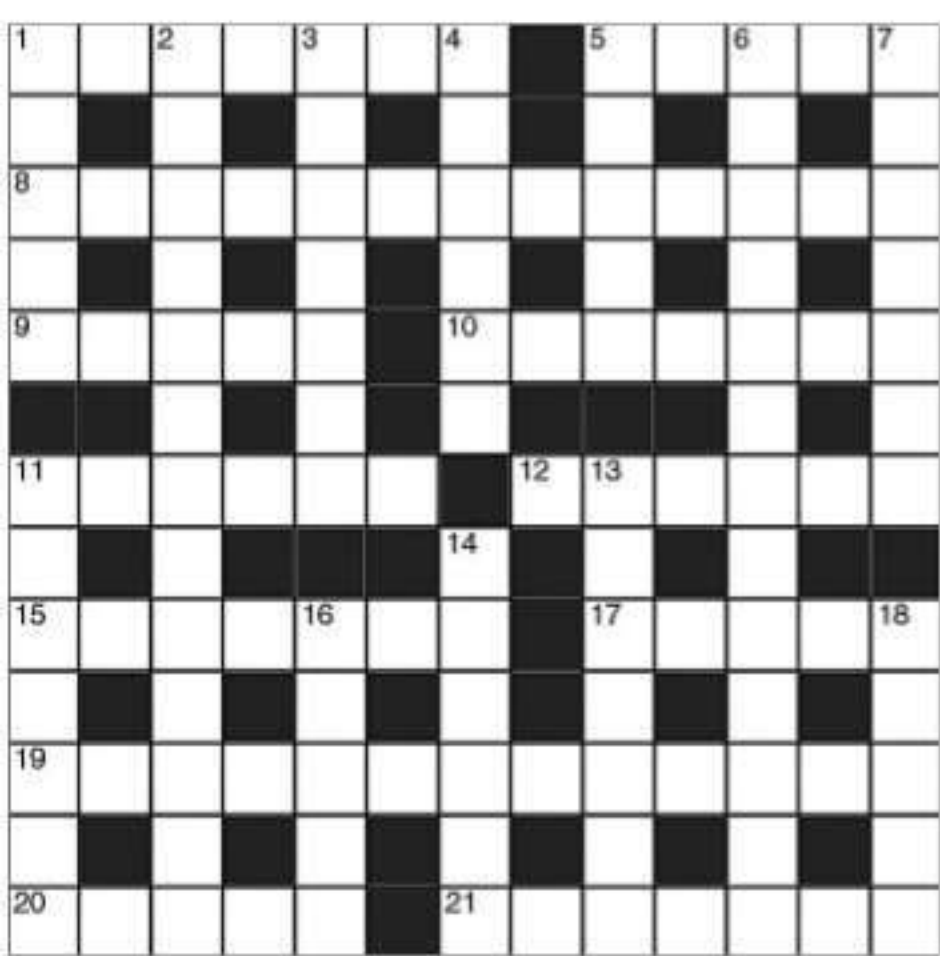
The 31 films denied screening permission include 18 officially selected for the festival. Nine are in the international

non-fiction section, three in the Festival Winners section and one in the Nepal package.

Reacting to the development, Congress MP Shashi Tharoor said in a post on X: "I am shocked to learn of the denial of permission by the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting for 31 films that had been selected for screening at the prestigious 18th International Documentary and Short Film Festival in Kerala, which is scheduled in Thiruvananthapuram next week."

The I&B Ministry said it had not denied permission, saying in a post on X: "Six films have been requested to provide more detailed synopsis. Depending on the subject of the films, some have been sent to various sectoral authorities for their review."

• CROSSWORD



ACROSS
1 Opposed to profits at outset (7)
5 Prize from a lottery rejected (5)
8 Uncomfortable proximity in stifling billets (5,8)
9 Meeting that may try a saint? (5)
10 Charges are made for the articles stored in it (7)
11 See me backing horse entered in Derby for example (6)
12 One is not keen to show it (6)
15 Set out to get into blue films by the back door (7)
17 Insist on getting the payment absolutely correct (5)
19 Returning to office, check the bank account (13)
20 Irritable fictional friend of Mole and Toad (5)
21 Part of a lathe that could be altered (7)

DOWN
1 Charm going topless at fashionable race meeting (5)
2 For the present it shall be nameless (9,4)
3 A sign that visitors aren't welcome (2,5)
4 A couple may be said to have a big bill to face (6)
5 Hanging in embarrassment (5)
6 One way to arrive at a conclusion? (1,5,2,2,3)
7 Diana's game show (7)
11 Ruler and a sheet of paper required (7)
13 Go to the front (7)
14 Perfect diplomats excel thus (6)
16 Writing directions for example (5)
18 The name is right (5)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6099 **ACROSS:** 1 Paris, 8 Infringe, 9 Erase, 10 Fitted in, 11 Usage, 12 Gas, 16 Define, 17 Added, 18 Try, 23 Pay up, 24 Evidence, 25 Acute, 26 Doctrine, 27 Aside **DOWN:** 2 Arrested, 3 Insignia, 4 Angina, 5 Erato, 6 Anode, 7 Means, 12 Get, 13 Say, 14 Advances, 15 Required, 19 Racing, 20 Ready, 21 Ditch, 22 Heart

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

The young have aspirations that never come to pass, the old have ____ of what never happened - Saki (13)

IEEER



DUWINN



ABISS



COMICS

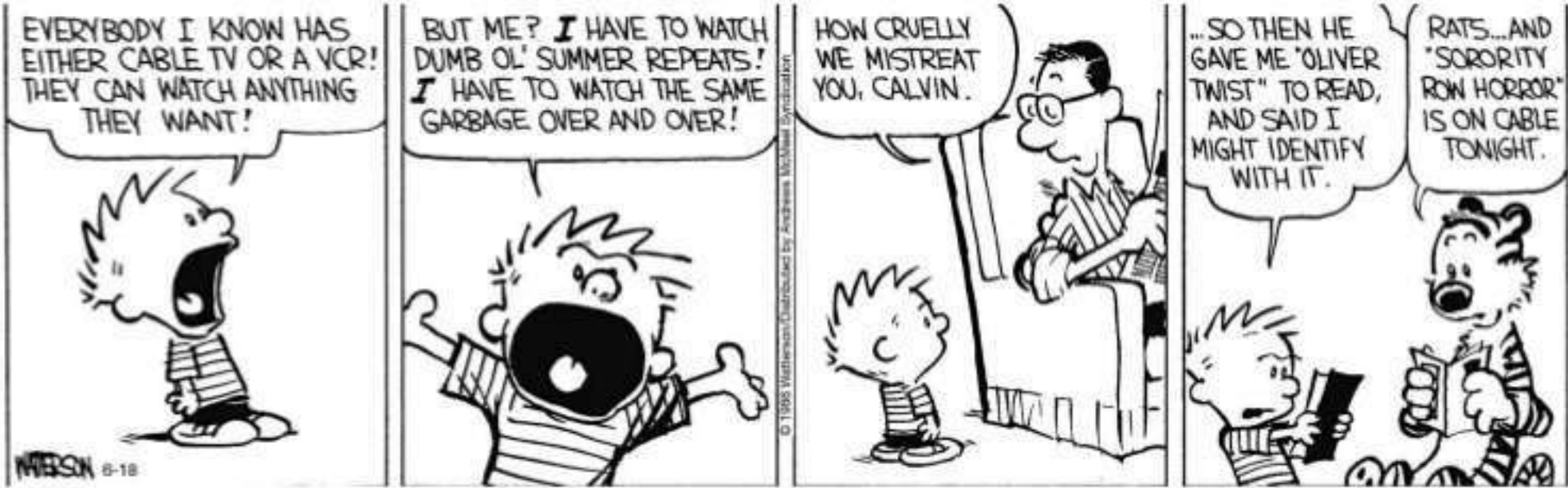


ANSWER: The young have aspirations that never come to pass, the old have **fantasies** of what never happened - Saki

• OVER THE HEDGE



• CALVIN & HOBBS



• MARVIN

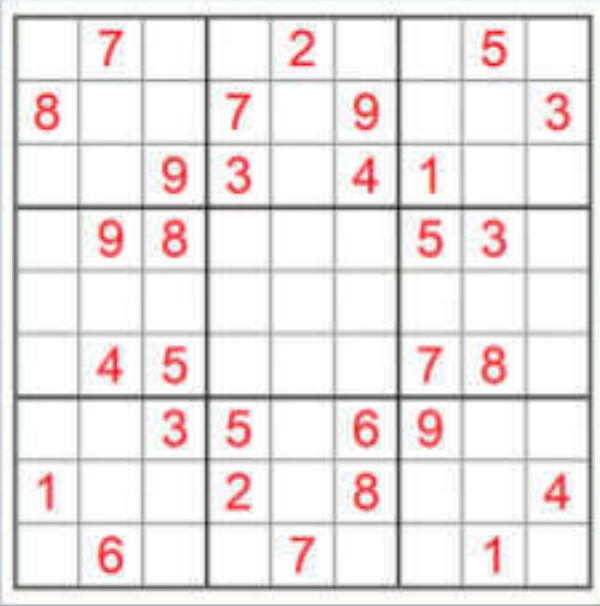


DIFFICULTY LEVEL 2s INSTRUCTIONS

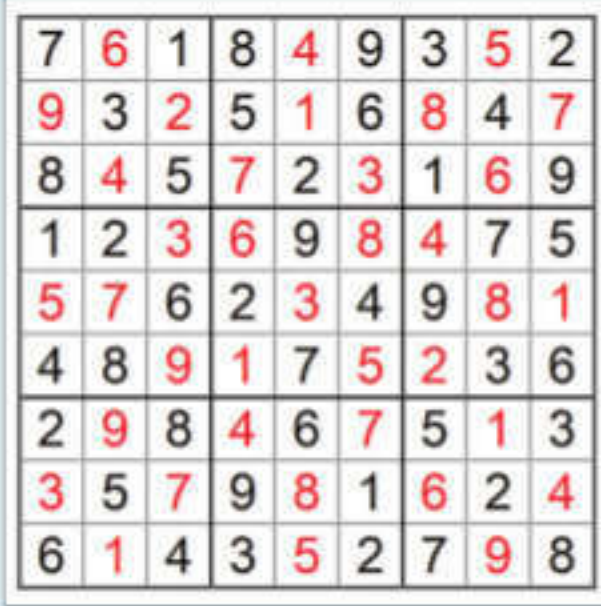
To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius



SOLUTION SUDOKU 6448



BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS

BY BILL WATTERSON

BY TOM ARMSTRONG

• ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS



ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): You will need more sleep in the next four weeks. You will also see ways to improve your closest relationships because you will be more observant and more aware. Friendships are rewarding today, especially with females. Tonight: Be friendly.



TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): You'll find it easy to apply yourself with enthusiasm to whatever you have to do in the next four weeks because you'll be motivated to accomplish a lot in the most efficient, effective way possible. Tonight: You're noticed.



GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): The next four weeks will be fun-loving. Romance, fun activities with kids, sports events, the arts and the entertainment world will appeal. Plan on socialising more. Tonight: Learn something.



CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): Your focus on home, family and a parent will increase in the next four weeks. Family discussions as well as home repairs will likely be on the menu. Fortunately, romance and fun diversions are the specials. Tonight: Check your finances.



LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Expect the pace of your days to accelerate in the next four weeks. You have places to go, things to do and people to see. Many of you will read, write and study more than usual as well. Discussions will be lively. Tonight: Be cooperative.



VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): "Show me the money!" This will be your mantra for the next four weeks. Many of you will have excellent moneymaking ideas. You can also use this focus to organise your possessions and figure out what you own. Clean out drawers and closets. Tonight: Work.



LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): You will get a chance to recharge your batteries for the rest of the year. This is a fortunate thing for you. It will also attract favourable situations and important people to you. Tonight: Socialise.



SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): This is an excellent time for you to buy wardrobe items. You will like what you see in the mirror. The next four weeks are a particularly good time for you to define goals for your coming year ahead. Tonight: Take it easy.



SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Your popularity will increase in the next four weeks, especially with younger people. Some of you might be in a position to teach or learn. Do your homework in case you have to face disputes about inheritances. Tonight: Share ideas.



CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): For the next four weeks, people will admire you, especially authority figures, even if you don't do anything different. Accept increased responsibilities. You will shine! Tonight: Check your money.



AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): You want to travel or do something to broaden your horizons in the next four weeks. If you can't travel, then be a tourist in your own city. Sign up for a course. Learn something new. Tonight: You're in charge.



PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): The next few weeks are a mixed bag for you. Travel will appeal. Social outings and competitive sports are also in the picture. You will focus seriously on shared property and inheritances. Tonight: Privacy.

@ieExplained

#ExpressExplained

If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

HEALTH

CCTV at medical stores: Why govt wants them, but chemists don't

Anonna Dutt

New Delhi, September 21

THE UNION Health Ministry has proposed mandatory CCTV surveillance at medical stores as it looks to curb the abuse of prescription drugs. A draft notification by the ministry calls for maintaining the recordings for three months.

The Health Ministry said in a statement that this would ensure stricter control over prescription medicines, especially habit-forming drugs listed under Schedule X of the Drugs and Cosmetics Rules, 1945. In the draft notification, the ministry said the step seeks to address concerns over the "unauthorised access to and sale of Schedule H, H1 and X drugs" — all prescription drugs, including strong antibiotics and psychotropic substances.

Why was this step taken?

The measure was first proposed in 2021 to prevent the abuse of drugs by children.

H G Koshia, the head of the Drugs Consultative Committee, Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation, said: "Round-the-clock surveillance will, in a way, create fear among medical store owners and pharmacists so that they are not inclined to sell these medicines without a prescription for children. The CCTV footage is mainly meant to verify whether there has been a sale to a minor without prescription, not all sales can be verified in this manner." While routine inspection every three months may be difficult, the data can be retrieved when there is a complaint.

The committee decided to implement the app-based system and CCTV surveillance plan earlier this year.

GOT A PRESCRIPTION?

SCHEDULE H: Medicines that can't be sold without a prescription from a registered medical practitioner. Examples include many antibiotics and steroids.

SCHEDULE H1: Subject to additional record-keeping requirements. Examples include certain antibiotics and anti-TB medicines.

SCHEDULE X: More tightly controlled category, with additional requirements. It includes some psychotropic medicines.

How common is prescription drug addiction in children?

Opioid use — which includes heroin and pharmaceutical opioids found in strong painkillers and opium — is the second-most common form of addiction among children, affecting nearly 1.8% of them. Cannabis use affects 1.9% of children, according to one of the most comprehensive studies of drug use by AIMS published in 2019.

This is followed by alcohol use (1.3%) and inhalant use (1.17%). The latter is the only form of addiction more common in children than adults.

Of the estimated 2.3 crore total opioid users (adults and children) in the country, 25 lakh are dependent on pharmaceutical opioids, while the highest 63 lakh are dependent on heroin, according to the study.

What do chemists say?

The All India Organisation of Chemists and Druggists raised several objections, some of which are:

First, it would put a financial burden on pharmaceutical stores, especially the smaller ones. Second, power failures and issues with connectivity in rural places pose serious hurdles. Finally, and most importantly, it would violate patient privacy, the organisation said.

"Stores might have to shell out nearly a lakh to put the system in place. How can a store with, say, sales of Rs 5,000 to 10,000 do that?," said Rajeev Singhal, general secretary of the organisation.



Drishti IAS



IAS GS Foundation Course

(Offline & Live Online Batches)

Centre	हिंदी माध्यम	English Medium
9 Karol Bagh (New)	28 सितंबर शाम 6:00 बजे	23 Sept 6:00 PM
9 Noida (New)	5 अक्टूबर दोपहर 3:00 बजे	12 Oct 11:00 AM
9 Indore	23 सितंबर सुबह 8:00 बजे	21 Sept 11:00 AM
9 Lucknow	30 सितंबर सुबह 11:30 बजे	24 Sept 8:00 AM
9 Prayagraj	28 सितंबर सुबह 11:15 बजे	30 Sept 11:30 AM
9 Ranchi	22 सितंबर सुबह 8:00 बजे	14 Sept 5:30 PM
9 Patna	25 सितंबर शाम 5:30 बजे	5 Oct 2:30 PM
9 Jaipur	23 सितंबर शाम 5:00 बजे	21 Sept 11:00 AM
9 Pune (New Batch)	English Medium 5 October 5:30 PM	

drishitiias.com

 Call Us **87501 87501**

CORPORATE

Why a 2021 top court verdict on Cyrus Mistry has been invoked in Tata dispute

George Mathew

Mumbai, September 21

THE SUPREME Court's judgment in the Tata-Cyrus Mistry dispute in 2021 has assumed fresh significance amid the escalating battle over the control and governance of Tata Sons, the principal holding company of the Tata Group.

Senior advocate Abhishek Manu Singhvi, appointed by Tata Trusts, which collectively own about 66% of Tata Sons, referred to the judgment on Sunday. He argued that the court had "clearly given Tata Trusts the primacy" in their relationship with Tata Sons. Singhvi also highlighted the court's decision to uphold the special Articles of Association (which lay down rules for a company's governance) on the Trusts' rights.

The observation comes at a sensitive juncture. Tata Trusts are challenging the validity of the September 17 decision of the Tata Sons board to reappoint N Chandrasekaran as its executive chairman. They con-

tend that the Articles require the affirmative support of the Trusts' nominee directors for certain decisions, and that neither a general board majority nor the chairman's casting vote can override that requirement.

The legal question is whether the principles upheld by the SC affect the interpretation of the present Articles of Association.

What was the Tata-Mistry case?

The dispute began after Cyrus Mistry was removed as executive chairman of Tata Sons in 2016. The Mistry family and the Shapoorji Pallonji Group, which held about 18.37% of Tata Sons, challenged his removal and alleged oppression and mismanagement.

The litigation eventually reached the Supreme Court after the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal (NCLAT) ordered Mistry's reinstatement.

In 2021, a three-judge SC bench headed by then Chief Justice S A Bobde overturned that verdict and ruled in favour of Tata

Sons. The SC held that the mere removal from the position of chairman could not, by itself, amount to oppression or prejudice, and rejected Mistry's reinstatement.

What did SC say about Tata Trusts' special rights?

The Tata Sons Articles of Association gave the two principal Tata Trusts — Sir Ratan Tata Trust and Sir Dorabji Tata Trust — special rights, including the ability to nominate directors. The Mistry side challenged the voting powers of Trust nominees.

However, the SC held that directors nominated by the Trusts had the right to affirmative voting because, in addition to their responsibilities towards the companies they represented, they had duties towards the Trusts' beneficiaries. These voting rights effectively gave the Trust nominees veto powers on specified matters, including strategic plans, major investments, and changes affecting the Trusts' shareholding.

In the present Tata Sons confrontation,

this assumes significance. The question now is how those rights operate when the two Trust nominees themselves disagree.

Why is this relevant now?

The present dispute turns on the interpretation of the same basic governance architecture. Article 104B gives the Tata Trusts the right to nominate one-third of the Tata Sons board while they hold the prescribed shareholding. Article 121 requires matters decided by a majority of directors to also receive the affirmative vote of a majority of Trust-nominated directors.

There are currently two Tata Trusts nominees on the Tata Sons board: Noel Tata and Venu Srinivasan. Srinivasan supported Chandrasekaran's reappointment, while Noel Tata opposed it. Four others voted in favour. Tata Sons treated it as a valid decision, while Tata Trusts disagreed.

What is Tata Trusts' argument?

Their argument is that where the articles prescribe an additional condition —

affirmative support from the required number of Trust nominees — it must be satisfied independently of the overall board arithmetic.

In a statement, the Trusts pointed out that Tata Sons had defended the affirmative voting provisions before the Supreme Court when the Mistry group sought to have them deleted or restricted. The company had argued then that these provisions were legitimate protections for the majority shareholder.

The Trusts' present argument is that if Tata Sons successfully defended these provisions before the Supreme Court, it cannot now disregard them based on inconvenience. But the precise application of those provisions to the September 17 vote remains a matter for legal interpretation.

What was the impact of the ruling?

The immediate impact was decisive, in that Mistry was not reinstated. The judgment also settled several important questions on private-company governance.

One was minority representation. The Supreme Court held that a minority shareholder does not automatically have a statutory right to proportional representation on the board of a private company.

Another was the importance of the Articles of Association. The court held that the Articles, as they existed, were binding and could not simply be rewritten through proceedings before the tribunal. And, crucially for today's dispute, the court upheld the special affirmative voting rights of the Tata Trusts' nominees.

The 2021 verdict now provides an important legal backdrop. The other side of the argument is likely to focus on the precise wording of the relevant provisions, the distinction between a board majority and a separate affirmative-vote requirement, and the circumstances in which a chairman's casting vote can operate. The dispute is now moving beyond a personality clash between Noel Tata and Chandrasekaran, and becoming a test of the Tata Sons constitutional structure itself.

POLICY

Article 371 A to J, and what K can do for Ladakh



DEEPTIMAN TIWARY

THE CENTRE has proposed inserting a new provision, Article 371K, in the Constitution to provide special constitutional safeguards for Ladakh. The proposal follows an "in-principle understanding" reached between the Ministry of Home Affairs and representatives of the Apex Body, Leh (ABL) and Kargil Democratic Alliance (KDA) to create a directly elected Union Territory-level body with legislative, executive, financial and planning powers.

What is Article 371?

Article 371 was not originally created to give special constitutional protection to the Northeast or tribal regions. At Independence, India did not consist only of the provinces directly administered by the British, but also hundreds of princely states, which had acceded to India under very different historical and administrative circumstances. The Constitution classified these territories separately as Part B States, including Hyderabad, Mysore, Jammu and Kashmir, Rajasthan and others.

The Constitution-makers were concerned about these newly integrated states immediately functioning within the same framework as the former British provinces. The original Article 371, adopted in 1950, was therefore a transitional provision for Central supervision.

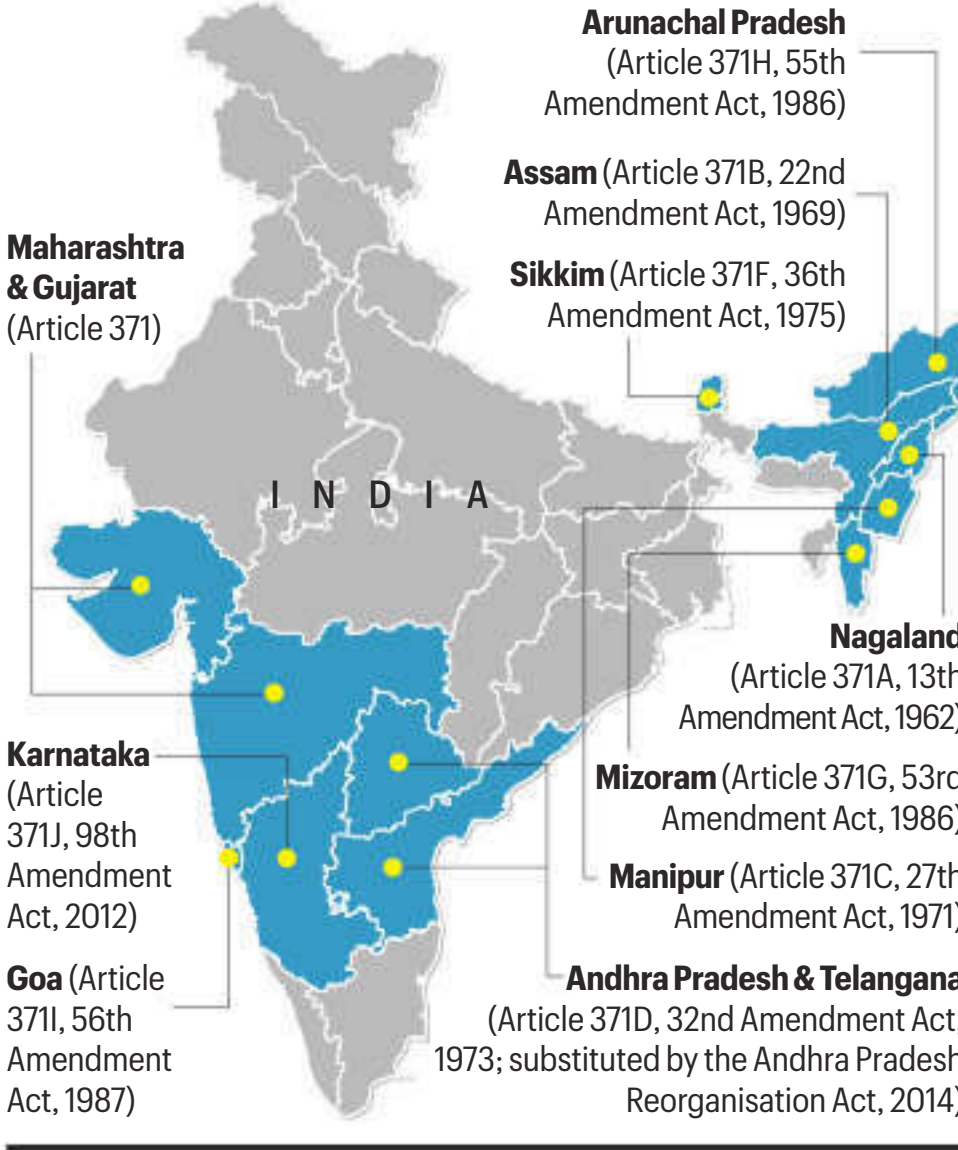
It placed the governments of the Part B States under the general control of the President for 10 years, or for such longer or shorter period as Parliament might prescribe.

However, six years later, the States Reorganisation Act and the Seventh Constitutional Amendment of 1956 abolished the old Part A, Part B and Part C classification of states and created a more uniform structure of states and Union Territories (UTs).

In doing so, the original Article 371 disappeared. Parliament replaced it with one that today provides special arrangements for Maharashtra and Gujarat, particularly for equitable development of regions such as Vidarbha, Marathwada, Saurashtra and Kutch.

So how did Article 371 become associated with special protection?

SPECIAL PROVISIONS FOR STATES



India's constitutional system was designed to be flexible enough to accommodate regions whose historical circumstances, social structures or political demands were different from the rest of the country. Thus, Parliament repeatedly created bespoke constitutional arrangements.

NAGALAND: After Independence, the Naga political movement challenged India's claim over Naga areas. The conflict eventually led to the 16-Point Agreement of 1960, which became the basis for the creation of Nagaland as a separate state.

One of the understandings was that Naga religious and social practices, customary law and procedure, and ownership and transfer of land and its resources would receive special protection. When Nagaland was created in 1963, these arrangements were incorporated into the Constitution through the insertion of Article 371A.

ASSAM: Article 371B, inserted in 1969, arose from a different concern. Assam contained large tribal and hill areas that already had special arrangements under the Sixth Schedule. Growing demands from these

Unique provisions

India's constitutional system was designed to be flexible enough to accommodate regions whose history, society or political demands were different from the rest of the country.

Thus, Parliament repeatedly created bespoke constitutional arrangements.

areas led Parliament to provide another layer of political representation.

The 22nd Constitutional Amendment of 1969 allowed the President to create a committee within the Assam Legislative Assembly comprising members elected from the tribal areas covered by the Sixth Schedule. It created a mechanism through which representatives from protected tribal areas could have a distinct voice.

MANIPUR: When Manipur became a full state in 1972, the political relationship between its predominantly tribal hill areas and the Imphal Valley had to be addressed.

Article 371C was thus inserted to provide for a special committee of the Legislative Assembly consisting of members elected from the hill areas, with a special responsibility for the Governor to report to the President on their administration.

ANDHRA PRADESH: Tensions between the Telangana and Andhra regions produced political agitations and led to the Six-Point Formula of 1973 that intended to address grievances over education, government employment and regional development.

Thus came Article 371D, providing for equitable opportunities in education and public employment across different parts of the state. Here, it was born out of a regional equality and employment dispute, not an ethnic or cultural autonomy movement.

SIKKIM: Insertion of Article 371F was essentially for integration of the erstwhile independent state into the Indian union. In 1975, following political developments and a referendum, Sikkim became India's 22nd state. Article 371F was to manage that transition.

MIZORAM AND ARUNACHAL PRADESH: The 1986 Mizo Peace Accord between the Government of India and the Mizo National Front paved the way for Mizoram's statehood. Article 371G was thus inserted to protect Mizo religious and social practices, customary law and procedure, customary administration of justice, and ownership and transfer of land. Parliamentary laws concerning these matters do not automatically apply unless the Mizoram Assembly agrees.

For Arunachal Pradesh, which became a state in 1987, Article 371H took a different approach, giving the Governor a special re-

sponsibility for law and order.

GOA AND KARNATAKA: Article 371I, inserted when Goa became a state, is comparatively modest: it simply requires the Goa Legislative Assembly to have at least 30 members.

In 2012, Parliament added Article 371J for the Hyderabad-Karnataka region, now Kalyana Karnataka, to address regional backwardness through a development board, equitable allocation of funds and opportunities in public employment and education.

Article 371K and Ladakh

Ladakh is seeking something that does not neatly fit any existing 371 provision. The proposed Article 371K would apply to a UT without a legislature. The emerging proposal envisages a directly elected UT-level body with legislative, executive, budgetary, planning and financial powers.

The MHA has said the body would have legislative powers over land, culture and language, forests, environment and natural resources, as well as other subjects reserved for the UT under Article 240.

Ladakh's leaders are also seeking control over law and order. Existing Article 371H gives the Governor special responsibility for law and order in Arunachal Pradesh. Ladakh's leaders want the opposite. Similarly, the land protection sought by Ladakh resembles the philosophy of 371A and 371G, under which certain Parliamentary laws relating to land and customary practices do not apply automatically. But Ladakh is simultaneously seeking a much more substantial democratic governing institution.

What will be written into 371K

If the provision merely creates an elected body and lists subjects over which it can legislate, its protection would be relatively limited. Manipur is an example where hill tribes have argued that Article 371C has failed to deliver on its promise of meaningful autonomy and protection.

If Ladakh's 371 protects the proposed elected body's control over land, natural resources, recruitment and administration, it would be considerably stronger. If it places law and order and the bureaucracy under the elected executive, the Ladakh head of government would be more powerful than the J&K chief minister.

FULL VERSION ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

WILDLIFE

Conservation, compensation: Tackling Himachal monkey menace

Saurabh Parashar

Shimla, September 21

THE RECENT death of a 63-year-old woman in Shimla has again brought forth the issue of human-wildlife conflict. The woman suffered grievous injuries, including spinal damage, after being attacked by a pack of rhesus macaques on the roof of her house on August 30. She succumbed to her injuries on September 5.

The incident highlights the legal and administrative position of rhesus macaques, or rhesus monkeys. The Wild Life (Protection) Act, 1972, listed the rhesus macaque as a protected species under Part I of Schedule II, but the Wild Life (Protection) Amendment Act, 2022, removed it.

What changed after 2022

Chief Wildlife Warden of Himachal Pradesh, Alok Prem Nagar, told *The Indian Express*: "State forest departments are now no more responsible for looking after the monkey menace. A monkey is now like a stray animal, which falls under the purview of civic bodies."



Shimla records 50-55 cases of monkey attack every month. WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

A senior Indian Forest Service (IFoS) officer said there were many reasons why urban local bodies (ULBs) like Shimla Municipal Corporation (SMC) were "not fully competent" to tackle the monkey menace independently. "First, the lack of funds. Second, absence of expertise and trained manpower to capture monkeys, and sterilising the captured monkeys," the officer told *The Indian Express*.

Sustained sterilisation

Official numbers show that Himachal Pradesh's estimated rhesus macaque population fell from 3,17,512 in 2004 to 2,26,086 in 2013, and then to 1,36,443 in 2019-20.

The state forest department attributes much of this decline to sustained sterilisation. Starting 2006, the state had sterilised 1,86,448 monkeys by March 2024.

According to the officer, state forest departments earlier used to receive funds from the Centre to control the monkey menace. Now, with the rhesus monkey no longer a protected animal, the officer added, this is no longer the case.

Shimla Municipal Commissioner, Sachin Kanwal, told *The Indian Express*: "We are in the process of training our manpower on how to capture the monkeys. Whenever a situation arises, we take the assistance of the forest department concerned."

Deputy Conservator of Forests (Wildlife) of Himachal Pradesh, Shah Nawaz Ahmad Bhat, said that the forest department had not given up its responsibilities. "We do intervene, but largely in and around the forest areas. Whenever Municipal Corporation officials approach us for capturing a monkey and sterilising it, we do provide our assistance. But we charge money from ULBs," he told *The Indian Express*. The cost of sterilisation per monkey is Rs 700.

Conservation dilemma

As per SMC officials, Shimla records 50-55 cases of monkey attack every month.

Wildlife expert Shaminder Boparai said that opinion was divided on whether monkeys "should be treated like vermin or a protected animal", despite the fact that their population increases rapidly.

"The public feeding of wild animals, including monkeys, are forcing animals to come out of the forest in search of easy food," Boparai told *The Indian Express*.

A question of compensation

Last week, a Shimla-based NGO held a protest outside the SMC Commissioner's office demanding a compensation of Rs 5 lakh for the deceased woman. The NGO also demanded stricter action against those found feeding monkeys in Shimla.

The change in legal status, however, has also affected compensation. Under Himachal Pradesh's wildlife compensation policy cited by officials, severe monkey-attack injuries attract a compensation of Rs 75,000, permanent disability Rs 1 lakh, and death Rs 4 lakh. Since rhesus macaque is no longer covered by the Act, officials indicated that the woman's family is unlikely to qualify under this framework.

Houthis seek control of Yemen highlands as Trump is said to have called off strikes

Washington has so far rebuffed pleas from Saudi Arabia to join the fight

Reuters
Dubai, September 21

HOUTHI FIGHTERS pushed to seize strategic heights in Yemen on Monday to cut off the Red Sea coast from remaining areas held by Saudi-backed forces, after a report that President Donald Trump had called off US strikes on the group at the last minute. A lightning advance by the Iran-backed group this month has extended the wider West Asia conflict to a new theatre and further threatened global energy supplies. Washington has so far rebuffed repeated pleas from Saudi Arabia's Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman to join the fight in Yemen. *The New York Times* reported that the Trump administration had prepared to launch airstrikes on Sunday against the Houthis after fresh pleas from the Saudi crown prince. But the newspapers said Trump called off

France vows response after Iran closes language centre

United Nations: France will summon Iran's ambassador and take appropriate measures in response after Iranian authorities sealed a French language centre affiliated with its embassy in Tehran, the Foreign Ministry said on Sunday. "This new attack against France's cultural presence in Iran, following the assault on two staff members of the French embassy last July, is unjustifi-

able and unacceptable," Foreign Ministry spokesperson Pascal Confavreux said in a statement. Ties between the two countries have been strained for years over Iran's nuclear programme and Tehran detaining several French nationals. Iran's semi-official *Tasnim* news agency reported authorities had closed the French language centre following a order from Tehran prosecutor's office. **REUTERS**

CHINESE PRESIDENT IS SET TO VISIT WASHINGTON FROM SEPTEMBER 23 TO 25

‘Of historic significance’: China on Xi’s visit to US

Xi to have in-depth exchanges on key issues concerning China-US relations: Foreign Ministry

Press Trust of India
Beijing, September 21

CHINESE PRESIDENT Xi Jinping will visit Washington from September 23 to 25 for summit talks with his US counterpart Donald Trump, marking their second meeting in six months, a development Beijing has described as a "milestone of historic significance". Xi will visit the US for three days at the invitation of Trump, Foreign Ministry spokesperson Guo Jiakun announced at a media briefing here on Monday. During his talks with Trump, Xi will have in-depth exchanges on key issues concerning China-US relations, as well as world peace and development, Guo



US President Donald Trump with China's President Xi Jinping at the Great Hall of the People in Beijing. FILE

said. "The reciprocal visits by the two heads of state within a span of six months will mark a milestone of historic significance," he said. The two leaders last met in Beijing in May during Trump's China visit, when they held talks aimed at improving ties between the world's two largest economies. "China will work with the US to enrich the dimensions of

the China-US constructive relationship of strategic stability, strengthen dialogue and cooperation and properly manage differences so as to deliver greater benefits to our two peoples and to further contribute to world peace, stability and prosperity," Guo said. Trump plans to accord a rare airport reception to Xi by personally receiving him on the tar-

mac at Joint Base Andrews, according to the Hong Kong-based *South China Morning Post*. From trade tariffs and technology to AI, military-to-military ties, the conflict in West Asia, the Russia-Ukraine war, the space arms race and US arms sales to Taiwan, a range of issues are expected to figure in the meeting between the leaders. Ahead of Xi's visit, Chinese Vice Premier He Lifeng, US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent and US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer held "candid, in-depth and constructive" talks on economic and trade issues, including AI, on Sunday in New York. In his talks with He, Bessent said the US had proposed a new notification mechanism for AI incidents that could affect national security. "We want a shared vision of common goals and common threats," Bessent said. "We think that just like any cross-border activity, that moving from opaque to more transparency between the No. 1 and the No. 2 AI powers in the world is very important."



The covered television positions for CNN on the North Lawn of the White House on Monday. AP

Networks suspend pool coverage of Trump after White House bars CNN

Michael M Grynbaum & Ali Watkins
September 21

MAJOR TELEVISION networks agreed to suspend their pooled coverage of President Donald Trump after the White House refused to allow CNN to serve as a pool representative Monday. The move is an extraordinary escalation of an unfolding showdown between the Trump administration and the White House press corps, which began last week when the president barred journalists at CNN, MS NOW and Politico from entering the White House grounds. Those three outlets said Monday they would sue to regain access. Despite Trump's years of lawsuits and threats against news media, archival news organizations have rarely undertaken this kind of collective action. Five networks — ABC, CBS, CNN, Fox News and NBC — have long shared the responsibility of providing television coverage of presidential events, splitting the financial costs and distributing footage that is carried by news organizations worldwide. The networks perform their duties on a rotation, and CNN had been slated to provide coverage for Trump's travel on Monday to the UN General Assembly. It is extremely unusual for a president to travel or hold public events without being accompanied by representatives from the television pool. The president's activities on Monday are still expected to be covered by print, radio and wire journalists, along with still photographers. "Effective today, the TV pool will not be covering events designated as pool coverage of the President," Bryan Boughton, the Washington bureau chief at Fox News, wrote in a note to television pool members Monday, which was obtained by *The New York Times*. (Boughton is the acting chair of television pool consortium; networks rotate chairmanship on a quarterly basis.) "This follows White House's position preventing CNN from fulfilling its assigned pool duties," Boughton wrote. "There will be no replacement pool put in place. All other pool coverage will continue as normal. We will provide updates as this situation develops." The five networks later issued a joint statement, writing: "The public has a vital interest in receiving accurate, independent information about its government. No administration should restrict a news organization because it objects to its reporting."

CPC expels 2 top generals for discipline, law violations

Press Trust of India
Beijing, September 21

CHINA'S RULING Communist Party on Monday expelled two senior military officials, including the highest-ranking People's Liberation Army (PLA) official, General Zhang Youxia, from the party and the military for serious discipline and law violations. Zhang and Liu Zhenli were expelled from the Communist Party of China (CPC) in accordance with a decision made at a party leadership meeting in Beijing, Xinhua reported. Chinese President Xi Jinping, who is currently serving his



Zhang Youxia (left), Liu Zhenli

unprecedented third five-year term, initiated the anti-graft campaign against "tigers and flies" — big and small officials — when he took power in 2012. Dozens of senior PLA officers, including two defence ministers, have been sacked or punished under the intensified anti-corruption campaign carried out by Xi. Zhang, 75, and Liu, 61, were placed under probe in January this year for serious violations of the ruling Communist Party's discipline and laws. A meeting of the Political Bureau of the CPC Central Committee Monday approved Central Military Commission's reports on handling of Zhang and Liu's cases after deliberation. Gen Zhang was the first-ranking Vice Chairman of the powerful seven-member CMC, the overall high command of the Chinese military headed by President Xi Jinping. Zhang's position in the CMC

made him the highest-ranking uniformed officer in the Chinese military. Zhang was formally detained by military corruption investigators in January. He was accused of corruption and of failing to rein in his close associates, family members and relatives. He was also blamed for not flagging problems to the party leadership at the first instance, the Hong Kong-based South China Morning Post reported earlier. Zhang was also a member of the 24-member Politburo. The other senior official, Liu, was a CMC member who served as the chief of staff of the Joint Staff Department.

RUSSIAN ELECTIONS

Pro-Putin party holds Parliament with record 355 seats, anti-war party gains tiny regional foothold

Reuters
Moscow, September 21

THE PRO-Putin ruling United Russia party won a record number of seats in the national parliament, according to near-complete official election results on Monday, while the anti-war Yabloko party appeared to have won a tiny foothold in one regional parliament. President Vladimir Putin had cast the three-day election to the State Duma - the first since Russia launched its full-scale war in Ukraine in February 2022 - as a test of support for the war. Elections for some regional parliaments and governors were held at the same time. In a tightly controlled political system, which critics say does not tolerate genuine dissent, under which many of Yabloko's candidates were barred, few surprises were expected. With over 95% of the vote counted, Ella Pamfilova, chair of the Central Electoral Commission, said United Russia had scored 57.83%, up from the



Senior members of Russia's ruling United Russia party, at the party's headquarters in Moscow on Sunday. REUTERS

49.8% that it won in the last parliamentary election, in 2021. United Russia was set to control 355 seats or nearly 80% of the 450-seat Duma, a total that includes results in individual constituencies. It would also be an all-time high, outstripping its 2016 record of 343 seats. Yabloko, the only registered anti-war party in Russia, failed to win any seats at a national level, but in Novgorod with it appeared to have cleared the 5% barrier by one percentage point to enter the regional parliament.

Moscow oil refinery output halted after drone strike, fires

Moscow: Russia's major Moscow refinery, owned by Gazprom Neft, has halted crude oil processing after fires broke out at its primary crude distillation units following a Ukrainian drone attack on September 20, three industry sources said. Moscow Mayor Sergei Sobyanin said on Telegram on Sunday morning that an industrial facility on the refinery's premises had been damaged during a drone raid on the Russian capital. The sources told Reuters on Monday that both of the refinery's primary crude distillation units caught fire after drones crashed onto the site and that it could take several weeks to repair the damage and restore operations. Gazprom Neft did not immediately respond to a *Reuters* request for comment. **REUTERS**

South African investigative journalist goes missing in Djibouti

Johannesburg: South African investigative journalist Micah Reddy has gone missing in Djibouti while on a reporting trip, his family said on Sunday, adding that they have received no information from authorities about his whereabouts since he was last heard from on Saturday. Reddy, the Africa editor for the International Consortium of Investigative Journalists (ICIJ), arrived in the Horn of Africa nation Thursday and had been in regular contact with family and colleagues before communication abruptly ceased, his brother Niall Reddy said Sunday. "We don't have any clear updates on his status," Niall said. The Committee to Protect Journalists watchdog said it was "increasingly alarmed" that over 24 hours had elapsed since anyone was able to reach Reddy or his fixer, Kooki Mahmoud. "CPJ understands their reporting was not focused on Djibouti and urges Djiboutian authorities to establish their whereabouts, confirm safety, and promptly release them if detained," said Angela Quintal, CPJ Africa Director. **REUTERS**

Pakistan says it killed 28 militants; Afghan Taliban, UN report 3 civilian deaths

Reuters
Kabul, Islamabad, September 21

PAKISTAN'S GOVERNMENT said Monday it launched airstrikes in the Afghanistan-Pakistan border region, killing at least 28 militants, with one security official saying two Afghan provinces were targeted. Hours earlier, Afghan Taliban officials accused Islamabad of killing at least three civilians in overnight airstrikes on Afghan territory. The UN Assistance Mission in Afghanistan (UNAMA) confirmed the deaths of three civilians: a man, a woman and a girl. The attacks broke nearly three months of relative calm. Zabihullah Mujahid, chief spokesperson of the Taliban-run Afghan government, said the Afghan side "will respond appropriately to this aggression". A Pakistani official, speaking on condition of anonymity, said the strikes happened in the Afghan provinces of Paktika and Kunar. Pakistan's Information Ministry gave the death toll but its military did not comment. Relations between the



A man retrieves belongings from the debris of a house that was damaged in an airstrike in Kunar province, Afghanistan, on Sunday. REUTERS

former allies have been strained for years, with Islamabad accusing Kabul of harbouring militants who stage cross-border attacks. Conflict escalated this February and hundreds died in airstrikes, drone attacks, and artillery fire in the first half of the year. Afghanistan's Taliban government denies harbouring anti-Pakistani insurgents and says militancy is Pakistan's internal problem. The Taliban's Foreign Ministry said it had summoned Pakistan's chargé d'affaires in Kabul and handed him a protest note.

• BRIEFLY

UNITED STATES

Supermodel Cindy Crawford's son Presley Gerber dies aged 27



Presley Gerber. FILE

pearances for brands such as Calvin Klein and Dolce & Gabbana. In 2018, he appeared alongside his mother in Pepsi's Super Bowl LII commercial. **REUTERS**

EUROPEAN UNION

EU hits Google with \$463mn fine

GOOGLE HAS been fined \$463 million for breaching the EU's strict privacy rules because it mishandled users' location data, the bloc's data privacy watchdog said Monday. Ireland's Data Protection Commission said its probe found Google did not lawfully or fairly process location data in users' Web & App Activity, a setting that tracks browsing history. **AP**

UNITED KINGDOM

Technical glitch disrupts flights

A TECHNICAL issue disrupted flights in and out of Scotland, Northern Ireland and the north of England on Monday. Though NATS, formerly known as National Air Traffic Services, said the issue at its Prestwick center in Scotland has been fixed, the repercussions will continue to be felt through the day with multiple flights cancelled or delayed. **AP**

• 98% OF SCHOOLS WERE EITHER DESTROYED OR DAMAGED IN WAR; 660,000 STUDENTS HAVE BEEN DEPRIVED OF IN-PERSON LEARNING, SAYS UNICEF

Gaza children return to class after nearly 3 years, but schools in ruins, supplies unaffordable

Nidal Al-Mughrabi, Haseeb & Alwazeer
Cairo, Gaza, September 1

HUNDREDS of thousands of children in Gaza returned to in-person teaching on Saturday for the first time in nearly three years, albeit in damaged or makeshift school buildings and tents, and with uniforms, notebooks and pens unaffordable for many families. The United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF) says 98% of schools in Gaza were either destroyed or damaged during the war, and Gaza education officials say about 660,000 students have been deprived of in-person learning

and regular participation in education. The reopening is a fragile milestone for Gaza after a conflict that has killed around 22,000 students and more than 770 education workers, including 532 teachers, according to Ibrahim Ramadan, the director of education for East Khan Younis. "The last time I have been to school was three years ago. Now, we are starting the school year, it is year of joy, happiness and success," said Moayed Abu Mustafa in Khan Younis. Mustafa said he was determined to learn even though he will sit on the floor in a tent lacking ventilation, he has no

decent shoes, nor a notebook and pen, and lost friends during the war. "Despite all of this we will learn, we will learn even in a tent." Fifteen-year-old displaced student Samar Abu Salmi, who lives with her family in a tent, is also returning to class. "We studied on phones and we haven't seen our teachers... now, we are back pursuing our dream... from one tent to another," she said, speaking in the yard of her new makeshift school. She also lacks much of the essential equipment, which has become unaffordable for her family. "Before the war, everything was available for us -



Palestinian students attend the first day of school year inside a tent classroom in Khan Younis, in southern Gaza Strip. REUTERS

notebooks, pens, goods, clothes, outings, things that we could get cheaply," Salmi said. Despite the devastation in

the enclave, the Ministry of Education, backed by international and local organisations, has moved ahead with the

2026-27 academic year, establishing dozens of temporary schools made of tents, tarpaulins, sheet metal and wood to accommodate pupils. Some are built on sandy ground, others have classrooms with only some mattresses and a blackboard, into which students cram. Others are still housing dozens of displaced families. Attending another school was 14-year-old Yamen Abu Samra. "We used to wake up happy to go to school... Now, when we come to school, we're afraid of stray bullets, rockets, strikes, everything," he said. "Now, I'm sitting in a tent that has absolutely nothing,

just the sun and the heat," he added. At least 540,000 students are expected to attend in-person classes this year in makeshift private schools, temporary learning centres and educational points, with UNICEF support, according to education officials. Online learning will continue for those who can't attend classes or who left Gaza during the war. Israeli forces remain in control of more than 60% of Gaza despite last year's ceasefire, which halted major fighting but failed to end the conflict. Palestinian authorities say more than 73,000 people have been killed in Israel's assault on Gaza, launched after Hamas-

led fighters killed about 1,200 people in southern Israel in October 2023. Stationery trader Khaled Aliyan, 30, said Israeli import restrictions have reduced supplies and hiked prices. "This notebook, which used to cost 3 shekels (\$1), now costs 15 (shekels). All stationery items are expensive," he said. Israel's COGAT military agency, which controls access to Gaza, did not respond to a Reuters request for comment on restrictions on supplies and strikes on schools. Israel has repeatedly accused Hamas of using schools for military purposes, which Hamas denies. **REUTERS**

IN DOUBLE DEFLATION, INPUT AND OUTPUT PRICES ARE ADJUSTED SEPARATELY TO COMPUTE REAL GVA

New GDP series: 28 out of 30 mfg categories used double deflation

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, September 21

THE NEW GDP series used the 'double deflation' method in 28 of 30 categories for the manufacturing sector, the statistics ministry's 'Sources and Methods' document, released on Monday, said. It added that work is on so that double deflation can be used in the remaining two categories too.

The two categories for which double deflation has not been used are 'production, processing and preservation of meat, fish, fruit, vegetables, oils and fats' and 'manufacture of pharmaceutical; medicinal chemicals and botanical products'.

In these two categories, the share of imported inputs is high. This makes it "challenging" to directly map input items with their elementary, item-level output Producer Price Index, the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) said.

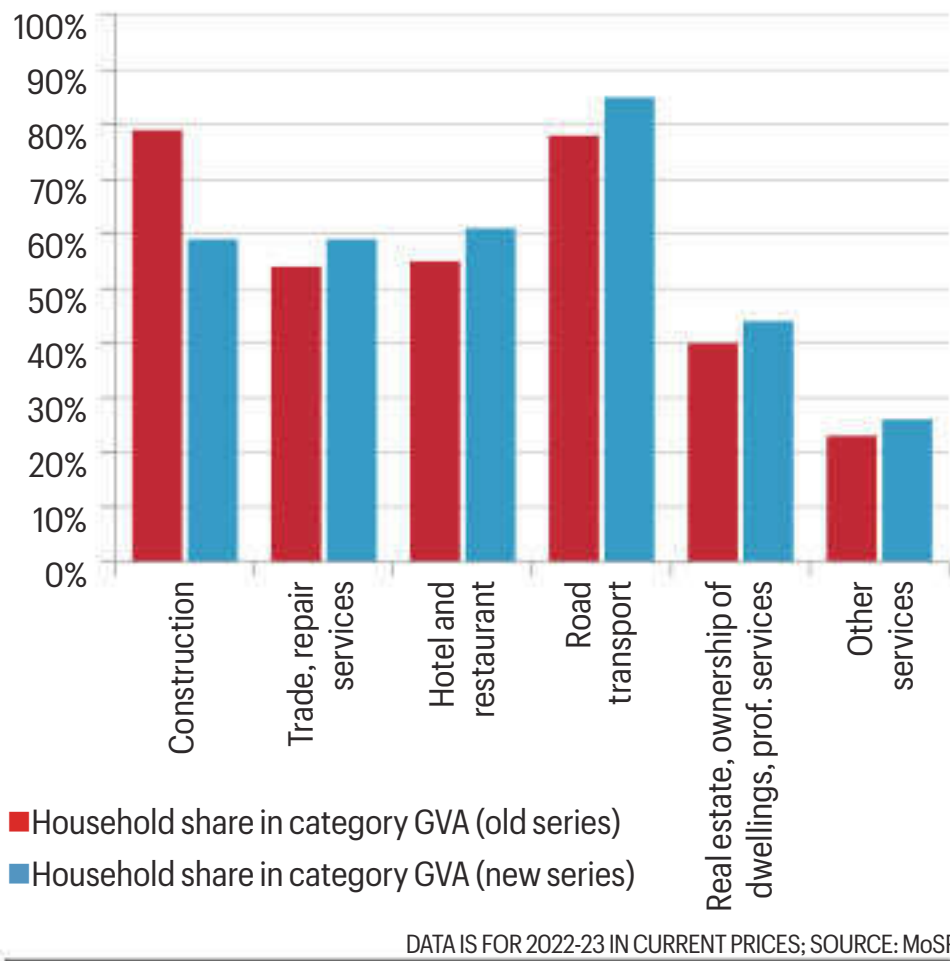
To find the value added by a sector — or the Gross Value Added (GVA) — the value of inputs it uses is subtracted from the value of output it produces. This is GVA in current prices, or nominal terms. To find the

GVA after accounting for changes in prices — or real GVA — the output and input values are adjusted by their respective inflation rates. This is called double deflation.

Prior to the new GDP series, which has 2022-23 as the base year, that was released earlier this year in February, one of the biggest criticisms of Indian data was MoSPI used double deflation only for agriculture and mining and quarrying sectors. For the others, input and output values were 'deflated' by the same number, with the Wholesale Price Index and Consumer Price Index being used. This can be problematic when input and output prices change at different rates. As such, double deflation results in better estimates of real growth.

The publication of the 'Sources and Methods for Compilation of National Accounts Statistics' comes seven months after the release of the new GDP series with 2022-23 as the base year. This, MoSPI said, is the shortest time it has ever taken to release the full document. Previously, the full document has taken up to three years to be released after the publication of a new GDP series.

• Trade, hotels more informal in new series



The document brings together the concepts, definitions, data sources, methodologies, and compilation practices used in the new GDP series. It does not contain new data and brings together the recommendations of three reports of sub-committees of the

Advisory Committee on National Accounts Statistics. These reports — on methodological improvement for the base revision of GDP, constant price estimates', and incorporation of new data sources, rates and ratios — were published back in February.

Smaller informal sector

The new GDP series has been criticised for its downward revision of nominal GDP in previous years, which reduced the size of the economy. Specifically, a lower nominal GDP in April-June 2025 has been seen by some as a way to show the faster-than-expected 7.8% real growth in April-June 2026.

Under the new series, the nominal GVA attributed to 'households' — the proxy for the informal sector — was reduced by Rs 2.9 lakh crore in 2022-23 compared to the old series. This amounts to a 2.7% decline.

The other two sectors are public sector and private sector.

The downward revision in household sector GVA in 2022-23 was led by construction. Under the new series, the share of the household sector in construction GVA fell to 59% from 79% in the old series, suggesting the construction sector may be more formal than previously thought. On the other hand, some other segments are more informal than what was earlier estimated: trade and repair services, hotels and restaurants, and road transport among them.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Why Tata Sons directors made a big U-turn in 2026

George Mathew
Mumbai, September 21

THE TATA Sons board decision to pursue listing, backed by a majority of four directors, marks a sharp reversal from their stance two years ago, when the same directors favoured keeping it unlisted.

What changed between March 2024 and September 17, 2026 on the issue of Tata Sons' listing, the holding company of Tata Group? In March 2024, while Ratan Tata was alive, its board considered the public listing issue and, as per Tata Trusts, unanimously decided that it should remain unlisted.

The decision was backed by Harish Manwani, Anita M George, Venu Srinivasan, and Saurabh Agrawal.

ON SEPTEMBER 17, 2026, the same directors voted in favour of taking steps to pursue the listing of Tata Sons, marking a dramatic reversal of the position in March 2024.

• LISTING ROW

IN MARCH 2024, the Tata Sons board had considered the question of public listing and unanimously concluded that it should remain unlisted.

THE DECISION was backed by Harish Manwani, Anita M George, Venu Srinivasan, and Saurabh Agrawal.

ON SEPTEMBER 17, 2026, the same directors voted in favour of taking steps to pursue the listing of Tata Sons, marking a dramatic reversal of the position in March 2024.



NOEL TATA was the lone director who opposed the listing in the six-member board

text," said a Tata Group source. Tata Trusts Chair Noel Tata wrote to Tata Sons on Friday stating that resolutions okayed by the board Thursday were null and void ab initio and of no legal relevance, and asked the company to give an explanation and correction, as per the sources.

The reversal also comes against an explicit decision by the Trusts. In July 2025, the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust and Sir Ratan Tata Trust unanimously resolved that Tata Sons should remain unlisted.

The decision was communicated to Tata Sons for necessary action, and Venu Srinivasan favoured the resolutions. But in a striking shift in stance, he backed the board's decision to pursue listing on September 17.

On RBI's directive to Tata Sons over guideline compliance, Noel Tata said in a note to the board, "it does not mention listing. It prescribes no particular step, and it does not say that the company is in breach. What its legal effect is, and what it requires of this company and by when, are questions upon which this board has formed no view."

India-NZ FTA to kick in on Oct 20

ENS Economic Bureau
New Delhi, September 21

THE INDIA-NEW Zealand Free Trade Agreement (FTA) will come into force October 20, 2026, opening a new phase in the bilateral economic relationship backed by a New Zealand commitment to facilitate \$20 billion of investment in India over the next 15 years.

Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal and New Zealand Trade and Investment Minister Todd McClay announced the October 20 implementation date at a video conference, describing the pact as a major milestone in the economic partnership between the two countries.

The FTA follows the signing of the agreement in New Delhi on April 27 and New Zealand's passage of legislation giving effect to the pact on September 16. The countries have also set an ambitious objective of doubling



Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal with members of New Zealand delegation. X/PIYUSHGOYAL

bilateral trade in goods and services, with Goyal putting the target at around Rs 35,000 crore over the next four to five years.

The date coincides with Vijaya Dashami (Dussehra), which Goyal described as an auspicious occasion for beginning a partnership. He said the agreement would help remove barriers to trade, promote investment and technology sharing and create opportunities for

businesses, farmers, exporters, micro, small, and medium enterprises, professionals and consumers in both countries.

The FTA provides zero-duty access to New Zealand for 100% of Indian exports from the date of entry into force. Key Indian export sectors expected to benefit include textiles and apparel, leather and footwear, engineering goods, pharmaceuticals, agriculture and processed foods. FE

Examining US tariff law on Russian oil purchase, says Goyal

ENS Economic Bureau
New Delhi, September 21

INDIA IS examining the details of the new US legislation that gives President Donald Trump the power to impose tariffs of up to 100% on countries buying Russian oil and gas, Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal said on Monday.

Asked about the government's backup plan in case Washington imposes additional tariffs on Indian exports, Goyal said, "Details are currently coming; once we have studied them, and at an appropriate time, we will discuss with you." Trump signed the Lindsey O Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026 on September 18, giving his administration

a new, Congress-backed instrument to impose tariffs of up to 100% on goods from major buyers of Russian energy.

India and China, among the largest buyers of Russian crude, are potentially exposed to the measure. The law does not automatically impose a 100% tariff on India; it gives the US President authority to determine the countries targeted and the level of tariffs. It will take effect within 30 days, during which the US Trade Representative will identify countries to be targeted and recommend tariff rates. The countries would normally get 180 days to reduce Russian energy purchases or negotiate with Washington, but Trump can shorten the period and impose tariffs sooner. FE

NSE IPO gets Rs 90k cr bids, subscribed 5.7x

Mumbai: The much-awaited initial public offering (IPO) of the National Stock Exchange of India (NSE) closed on Monday with the issue receiving bids worth around Rs 90,000 crore, reflecting strong demand from institutional and high-net-worth investors. The IPO was subscribed about 5.7 times overall, with investors bidding for more than 50 crore equity shares against around 8.86 crore shares on offer, according to data available on the exchanges.

The issue attracted about 38.5 lakh applications, underlining the broad investor interest in the country's largest stock exchange and one of the most closely watched listings in the Indian capital market.

The non-institutional investor portion was subscribed 6.55 times, while retail investor portion was subscribed around 1.4 times. The employee quota was subscribed about 2.4 times. Qualified institutional buyers (QIBs) led the demand, with their portion subscribed 12.68 times. QIBs placed bids for around 31.97 crore shares, compared with about 2.52 crore shares reserved for the category.

The listing marks the culmination of a long-delayed attempt by the exchange to enter the public markets. ENS

• BRIEFLY

Core sector growth slows to 4.8% in August

New Delhi: Growth in the output of India's core industries fell to a three-month low of 4.8% in August. Six of the nine sectors saw slower growth last month, data released by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade on Monday showed. The six core sectors, where output growth was slower in August compared to July, account for over 44% of the Index of Core Industries. FE

Maruti eyes 30% female intake at Manesar by FY29

New Delhi: Maruti Suzuki India aims to increase the female student intake at its Japan-India Institute for Manufacturing at Manesar to 30% by the Academic Year 2028-29, in a bid to enhance women's participation in India's automotive manufacturing workforce. The automaker currently has a 9% female student intake at its Manesar institute. It has introduced a fee waiver for female students from the current academic year. PTI

Some RWAs to self-fill income survey as pilot

New Delhi: To ensure participation of rich households in the ongoing National Household Income Survey, the statistics ministry is relaxing the timeline for respondents in gated societies. "Many of them would like to fill the questionnaire at their leisure... So, we are also giving that option to some households in these gated communities on a pilot basis," Secretary Saurabh Garg said. FE

ing the timeline for respondents in gated societies. "Many of them would like to fill the questionnaire at their leisure... So, we are also giving that option to some households in these gated communities on a pilot basis," Secretary Saurabh Garg said. FE

Jayanti Prasad takes additional charge at IBBI

New Delhi: The Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India (IBBI) on Monday said Jayanti Prasad, a Whole-Time Member, has been given the additional charge of Chairperson. IBBI is a key institution in implementing the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code that provides for a time-bound and market-linked resolution of stressed assets. Prasad has taken charge as Chairperson with effect from September 13, in addition to his existing duties. PTI

Google to report child abuse content to India

Bengaluru: Google said on Monday it has agreed to report content flagged as child sexual abuse material to Indian authorities, breaking from a global practice under which such reports are first routed through a US non-profit. It follows a similar announcement by Meta last week. Indian government sources told Reuters they had in recent weeks pressed tech companies to report child abuse content concerning India directly. REUTERS

RBI forex swap facility draws \$143.6 bn inflows

George Mathew
Mumbai, September 21

THE RESERVE Bank of India's (RBI's) special US dollar-rupee forex swap facility has attracted \$143.596 billion in foreign currency inflows till September 18, with Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank), or FCNRR(B), deposits accounting for the overwhelming share of the mobilisation.

According to the RBI, latest data reported by authorised dealer banks show that FCNRR(B) deposits mobilised under the facility stood at \$132.98 billion, while Overseas Foreign Currency Borrowings (OFCBs) brought in \$5.32 billion

and External Commercial Borrowings (ECBs) \$5.296 billion.

The facility, introduced by the central bank on June 8, was aimed at encouraging fresh foreign currency inflows into the banking system, strengthening the country's external buffers and supporting domestic liquidity. Under the arrangement, banks could mobilise fresh three-to-five-year FCNRR(B) deposits with the RBI at a concessional rate, thus reducing hedging cost for banks.

The RBI decided to close the window for fresh FCNRR(B) deposits on August 31.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Govt plans steps to minimise bank strike disruption

New Delhi: Drawing up a contingency plan to minimise disruptions from the September 28-30 bank strike, the Finance Ministry on Monday wrote to the RBI and PSU banks to keep strategic branches open, operate on the coming Sunday, and ensure higher ATM cash stocks, among other measures.

The United Forum of Bank Unions and other unions have called a three-day strike in support of various demands, including a five-day work week and uniform pension in the banking sector.

The strike coincides with the half-yearly closing of banks on September 30. FE



Dimon meets Sitharaman

Jamie Dimon, Chairman and CEO of JP Morgan Chase & Co, interacts with Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman during the JP Morgan India Investor Conference in Mumbai, Maharashtra, on Monday. X/NSITHARAMANOFFC

• THE NEW ENTITY TO BE MAJORITY-OWNED BY INDIAN SHAREHOLDERS AND HEADQUARTERED IN THE COUNTRY

Nothing to spin off CMF as standalone Indian company

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, September 21

SMARTPHONE MAKER Nothing's Co-founder and Chief Executive Officer (CEO) Carl Pei has said the company will spin off its CMF sub-brand into a standalone Indian company, with the new entity to be majority-owned by Indian shareholders and headquartered in the country. Nothing will retain a stake and continue as a shareholder and partner, while CMF will have its own team, and research and development (R&D) operations in India.

In an open letter, Pei said the move aims to build a global consumer electronics brand from

India, arguing that the country's next stage of growth in the sector would have to go beyond manufacturing and focus on product engineering, R&D and intellectual property.

"CMF becomes Indian," Pei said, adding that the new company would be "majority Indian owned, headquartered in India, with its own team and R&D in the country". Nothing's engineering capabilities, operating system, supplier relationships, and global brand infrastructure would continue to be part of the partnership. Pei's announcement comes shortly after the government notified its new Rs 62,500 crore Mobile Phone Manufacturing Scheme, which



Carl Pei, Co-founder and CEO of Nothing. REUTERS

seeks to push Indian-owned mobile phone brands, domestic design, and R&D.

The scheme has two target segments: one for mobile phone manufacturing and another

specifically for Indian brands. Under the Indian-brand segment, eligible companies can receive an incentive of 5% on eligible sales, along with an additional 3% incentive linked

to Indian design and R&D. There is also an additional incentive of up to 1.5% for domestic sourcing of key components and sub-assemblies. To qualify as an Indian brand under the scheme, a company must be incorporated in the country, hold its intellectual property and trademark in India, have management control with Indian citizens and have over 51% shareholding held by Indian citizens. It must also have in-house R&D and design capabilities in the country.

The Centre has said the scheme is intended to move India beyond being a manufacturing base and encourage Indian ownership of brands, technology and intellectual property.

India currently manufactures almost all mobile phones sold domestically and is the world's second-largest mobile phone manufacturer by volume, but has little to show for in terms of domestic smartphone brand successes.

For CMF, Pei said the focus would be on developing products in India rather than simply manufacturing them in the country. He identified areas including industrial design, camera systems, operating systems, antennas and the co-engineering of displays, chipsets and camera modules as examples of what he considers "real R&D".

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

• MARKETS

Sensex	NIFTY	Gold ▼	US Dollar ▼
74,858.99	23,414.30	₹1,53,337	₹95.82
564.03	6790		
0.76%	0.29%	Silver ▼	Oil ▼
		₹2,34,992	\$123.86

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF SEPTEMBER 18, 2026

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

E-Tender Notice

Sr. DEE/TRD/ Agra for & on behalf of President of India invites "Open Tender" through on-line only (e-Tendering) for the following work:

Tender No.: AGCTRD/T202628	Approximate Cost : Rs. 26,00,052/-
-----------------------------------	---

Name of work : Modification in OHE due to construction of Subway in lieu of LC no. 513 in Agra-Mathura section.

Earnest Money : Rs. 52,000/-	Period of completion : Twelve months
-------------------------------------	---

1. For full details & submission of the bid please see the Indian Railway website www.ireps.gov.in. 2. Tender can only be submitted through web portal www.ireps.gov.in up to 15:00 Hrs. on date 12/10/2026. 2143/26 (AS)

 North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in  CPNCR

**MAHARASHTRA SMALL SCALE INDUSTRIES DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LIMITED**
(A Government of Maharashtra Undertaking)
9-Krupanidhi, Walchand Hirachand Marg,
Ballard Estate, Mumbai - 400001 Tel : 022-22617567

E-TENDER NOTICE

MSSIDC is participating in India International Trade Fair 2026. The applications are invited from interested contractors for installation and erection of Maharashtra Pavilion at India International Trade Fair, Pragati Maidan, New Delhi. The e-Tender is available on website for sale on 22.09.2026.

The prebid virtual meeting is scheduled on 29.09.2026.

The detail schedule is available on www.mahatenders.gov.in

MSSIDC reserves the right to accept or reject any or all offers

Place : Mumbai,
Date : 22/09/2026

Authorized signatory

OFFICE OF DISTRICT AND SESSIONS JUDGE, GURUGRAM RE-SCHEDULED E-TENDER NOTICE

Sealed tenders are invited from willing outsourcing organization/agencies on letter head for allotment of contract work of cleanliness of new building of Judicial Courts Complex (Tower of Justice), Gurugram, which is seven storied building alongwith 2 basements having covered area of 635062 SFT. Further the area of multilevel parking is 196542 SFT. The New Judicial Court Complex (Tower of Justice) building is constructed over 7 acre land. The Tower of Justice building is having a provision of 56 Court rooms, Staff rooms, Corridors, Ramps, Stairs, Basement, Offices, conference Hall and Library etc. Proper and efficient cleaning on all days of the week on all floors, which includes entrance lounges, corridors, rooms, lavatories including all sanitary fitting viz. Urinal, wash and basin, glazed tiles, sinks, water coolers, etc. and rooms and swabbing with water mixed detergent and liquid Phenyl etc. This also includes cleaning of windows, panes and rooms doors. The contract shall be initially for one year from the date of agreement. The last date for receipt of tenders will be 21.10.2026 upto 05:00 PM. Complete detail/terms and conditions can be obtained from the office of undersigned or any working day from 09:30 AM to 04:00 PM before 20.10.2026 or can be viewed on the official website of District Courts, Gurugram. The tenders will be opened in the presence of tenderer or their authorized representatives who may choose to attend the opening of tenders on 28.10.2026 at 04:00 PM.

Sd/-
District and/Sessions Judge,
Gurugram.

No. 49456/HRV

**मंत्रिमंडल सचिवालय विभाग**
(बिहार राज्य अभिलेखागार निदेशालय,पटना)
निविदा संबंधी सूचना

बिहार राज्य अभिलेखागार निदेशालय, पटना एवं इसके नियंत्रणाधीन क्षेत्रीय अभिलेखागारों के अभिलेख प्रकाश में परिरक्षित विभिन्न प्रकार के महत्वपूर्ण अभिलेखों का वाह्य स्रोत से डिजिटাইजेशन का कार्य करना हेतु निविदा प्रकाशित की गई थी। बिहार राज्य अभिलेखागार निदेशालय के पत्रांक बि. रा.अ. 624, दिनांक 02.09.2026 एवं सूचना एवं जनसंपर्क विभाग के प्रकाशन संख्या-PR.No. 011058(CSD) 2026-27 के माध्यम से प्रकाशित निविदा की अंतिम तिथि दिनांक 18.09.2026 तक निर्धारित की गई थी। जिसे अपरिहार्य कारणों से दिनांक 25.09.2026 के 5.00 बजे अपराहन तक विस्तारित करते हुए निर्धारित किया जाता है।

उक्त सूचना www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर भी देखी जा सकती है।

(डॉ. मो. फैसल अब्दुल्लाह)
अभिलेख निदेशक

PR. No. 012082 (CSD) 2026-27

नशामुक्त हो जाए बिहार, सुरक्षित रहे घर परिवार।

**बिहार सरकार**

योजना एवं विकास विभाग
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
स्थानीय क्षेत्र अभियंत्रण संगठन, कार्य प्रमंडल-2 सोनपुर, सारण।
निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या - 01(SBD)/2026-27
(केवल ई-टेंडर पद्धति के अनुसार वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)

बिहार के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से बिहार राज्य के किसी भी कार्य विभाग/निगम/अन्य राज्य सरकार/केन्द्र सरकार/राज्यजनिक क्षेत्र के उपक्रम या राष्ट्रीय या अंतरराष्ट्रीय ख्याति के किसी भी एजेंसी में समुचित श्रेणी में निवेदित संवेदकों से प्रेरित हो कर निविदा को बीड प्रणाली (हाकीनीकी एवं वित्तीय) अन्तर्गत आमंत्रित किये जाते हैं। यदि संवेदक बिहार राज्य के किसी कार्य विभाग/निगम में पूर्व से विकसित नहीं है, तब एकरचना के पूर्व निम्नलिखित कार्य का स्वीकार पत्र (लेटर ऑफ एंक्वायरेन्स) प्राप्त होने के बाद बिहार राज्य के किसी भी कार्य विभाग/निगम (हिसम निगम) की प्रक्रिया लागू की) में निगम कराना अनिवार्य होगा।

1. कार्य की विवरणी :- सांघव स्थानीय क्षेत्र विकास योजना अंतर्गत माननीय सांघव श्री राजीव प्रताप रूडी (सारण लोकसभा) द्वारा अनुशंसित योजना:-

गुप संख्या	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (लाख रु० में)	अग्रघन की राशि (ऑन लाईन मोड या ऑफ लाईन मोड में केवल B.G. के रु० में) (लाख रु० में)	परिमाण-विषय का मूल्य (अप्रत्यक्षणीय केवल ऑनलाइन मोड में मुगतान) (रुपये में)	बीड प्रोसेसिंग शुल्क (अप्रत्यक्षणीय केवल ऑनलाइन मोड में मुगतान) (रुपये में)	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि (माह में)
01.	02.	03.	04.	05.	06.	07.
1.	Construction of a modern indoor stadium Badminton Court along with the construction of pickle ball court, paddle court and cricket net practice near Annour community center	999.65	19.993	As per e-proc-2	As per e-proc-2	14 माह
2.	विज्ञापन निर्गत करने की तिथि		दिनांक 16-09-2026.2012			
3.	निविदा कागजात अपलोड करने की प्रारम्भिक तिथि एवं समय		दिनांक 12-10-2026 को 10.00 बजे पूर्वाहन से। (सिर्फ वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)			
4.	प्री-बिड मीटिंग का समय, स्थान एवं तिथि :		दिनांक 16-10-2026 समय 3.00 बजे अपराहन मुख्य अभियंता का कार्यालय, स्थानीय क्षेत्र अभियंत्रण संगठन, विश्वेश्वरैया भवन, उत्तुर्ध तल, कमरा नं०-423, बेली रोड, पटना-800015			
5.	निविदा अपलोड की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय :		दिनांक 26-10-2026 समय 3.00 बजे अपराहन तक। (सिर्फ वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)			
6.	तकनीकी बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :		दिनांक 26-10-2026 समय 3.30 बजे अपराहन से। (कड़िका 5 में उल्लेखित तिथि)। (सिर्फ वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)			
7.	वित्तीय बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :		सक्षम पदाधिकारी द्वारा बाद में घोषित की जायेगी। (सिर्फ वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)			
8.	निविदा खोलने का स्थान		www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in			
9.	निविदा की वैधता अवधि		120 दिन(निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि के बाद)			
10.	विज्ञापनदाता का पदनाम एवं पता		कार्यपालक अभियंता, स्थानीय क्षेत्र अभियंत्रण संगठन प्रमण्डल, कार्य प्रमंडल-2, सोनपुर, सारण।			
कार्यपालक अभियंता स्थानीय क्षेत्र अभियंत्रण संगठन, कार्य प्रमंडल-02, सोनपुर।						
विस्तृत जानकारी state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।						
PR. No.012152 (Planning) 2026-27						
नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।						

**Kolhapur Municipal Corporation, Workshop Department**

Public Tender Notice No. 64
Second Extension for Time Limit for Serial Nos. 1 to 35

Tenders have been invited via Public Tender Notice No. 64 for the procurement of spare parts, purchase of accessories, repairs, etc., for the maintenance of various types of vehicles in use by the Kolhapur Municipal Corporation. These are invited from manufacturing companies, authorized dealers of companies in the local market, etc. The submissions must include detailed information, incorporating discounts on the respective company's price list, all taxes, packing, forwarding, handling charges, etc., for the tasks from Serial No. 1 to Serial No. 35 A second extension of the time limit from September 22, 2026 to September 30, 2026, is being granted for this. Detailed information regarding this will be available to view on the website www.mahatender.gov.in Date: September 21, 2026

Sd/-
City Engineer
Kolhapur Municipal Corporation

**Jharkhand Agency for Promotion of Information Technology**

(An Autonomous Body under the Department of Information Technology & e-Governance, Govt. of Jharkhand) Ground Floor, Engineers Hostel - I, Near Golchakkar, Dhurwa Ranchi, Jharkhand
Phone: 0651-2401067 / 2401044 | Email: japit_dotit@rediffmail.com

NIQ No.:JAPIT/2019 **Date: 18/09/2026**
NOTICE INVITING QUOTATION

S. No	Name of the Work	Selection of Chartered Accountant Firm for providing Internal Audit and related Financial/Tax Advisory Services to Jharkhand Agency for Promotion of Information Technology (JAP IT)
1	Scope of Work	As mentioned in the Request for Proposal (RFP)
2	Availability of Bid Documents	As mentioned in the Request for Proposal (RFP)
3	Mode of Submission of Bid	By Speed Post / Registered Post / By Hand in a sealed envelope
4	Cost of Tender Document and EMD (in INR)	Cost of Tender Document: Rs. 1,000/- (Rupees One Thousand only) via Demand Draft EMD: Rs. 50,000/- (Rupees Fifty Thousand only) via Demand Draft
5	Start Date of Downloading of RFP Document	[21/09/2026] from www.japit.jharkhand.gov.in / JAP IT website
6	Date of Start of Submission of Bids	21/09/2026, 11:00 AM
7	Last Date of Bid Submission	30/09/2026, upto 05:00 PM
8	Last Date of Receipt of Tender Fee and EMD	30/09/2026, upto 05:00 PM
9	Date of Technical Bid Opening	01/10/2026 at 03:00 PM
10	Name and Address of Office Inviting Quotation	Jharkhand Agency for Promotion of Information Technology (JAP IT), Ground Floor, Engineers Hostel - I, Near Golchakkar, Dhurwa, Ranchi
11	Tender Document	Tender document can be downloaded from the JAP-IT website or physically collected from office of the JAP-IT

Sd/-
Officer on Special Duty
Jharkhand Agency for Promotion of Information Technology
PR 390246 (Information Technology)26*27*D

**Public Health Engineering Department**
Public Health Engineering Division, Biharsharif

SHORT TERM TENDER NIT No. - 10/2026-27O&M-PHED
National Competitive Bidding
(Through e-procurement mode on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

1	Designation and Address of Advertiser	Executive Engineer, P. H. Division, Biharsharif.
2	Date of issue of Tender Notice	18.09.2026
3	Period of sale (downloading) of tender Bid Document	30.09.2026 to 06.10.2026 up to 15:00 Hrs. through www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
4	Date, time & place of pre-bid meeting	05.10.2026 at 12:00 hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer of concerned P. H. Division
5	Last date and time of receipt (uploading) of tender	06.10.2026 up to 15:00 Hrs on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
6	Date and time of opening of technical bid	06.10.2026 at 15:30 Hrs on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
7	Date and time of opening of financial bid	To be informed later after the approval of technical bid.

8. Details of works:

Grou p. No.	Name of Work	Estimat ed Cost (in Lakh)	Amount of Earnest Money (in Lakh)	Cost of Tender Document (non-refundable) in Rs.	BSEDC Bid Processing Fee (in Rs.)	Comple tion Period (in months)
1.	Comprehensive Extended Operation & maintenance of MVS Silao Phase-I Pipe Water Supply Scheme after Completion of first 5 Years O&M Period Including Operator Wages for the Period Dated— 01.12.2025 to 30.11.2030 Under P. H. Division, Biharsharif, Nalanda for the Year - 2026-27	965.2800	19.70560	10000.00	5900.00	6

For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar

PR- 012149 (PHED) 2026-27

Executive Engineer
Public Health Division, Biharsharif

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।

**बिहार सरकार**

जल संसाधन विभाग
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
शीर्ष कार्य प्रमंडल, वाल्मीकीनगर
अत्यकालीन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना सं०-01/2026-27
(केवल ई-टेंडर पद्धति के अनुसार वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)

पत्रांक-1525 / वाल्मीकीनगर

1. कार्य का विवरण :-

क्रमांक/ गुप सं०	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (लाख रु० में)	अग्रघन की राशि (ऑन लाईन अथवा निवेदित / मैनुअल मोड में मुगतान)	परिमाण विषय का मूल्य (अप्रत्यक्षणीय केवल ऑन लाईन मोड में मुगतान) रु० में	बेल्टून को देय बिड प्रोसेसिंग फी (अप्रत्यक्षणीय केवल ऑन लाईन मोड में मुगतान) रु० में	कार्य सम्पत्ति की अवधि
1.	गडक बराज एवं उसके नियंत्रण कक्ष, वाल्मीकीनगर की असेनिक संरचनाओं का रंग-संगन कार्य।	101.25282	2.02506	10000.00	5900.00	25.01.2027
2.	निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना निर्गत करने की तिथि		दिनांक 11.09.2026			
3.	निविदा कागजात डाउनलोड एवं अपलोड करने :		दिनांक 28.09.2026 10:30 बजे पूर्वाहन से दिनांक 05.10.2026 की तिथि के 3:00 बजे अपराहन तक। (सिर्फ वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)			
4.	प्री-बिड मीटिंग का समय, स्थान एवं तिथि :		दिनांक 30.09.2026 को 11:00 बजे पूर्वाहन में अधीक्षण अभियंता, गडक बराज ऑनल, वाल्मीकीनगर के कार्यालय में।			
5.	निविदा अपलोड करने की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय :		दिनांक 06.10.2026 समय 3:00 बजे अपराहन(सिर्फ वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)			
6.	तकनीकी बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :		दिनांक 07.10.2026 समय 3:30 बजे अपराहन (सिर्फ वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)			
7.	वित्तीय बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :		सक्षम पदाधिकारी द्वारा बाद में वेबसाइट पर घोषित की जायेगी। (सिर्फ वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)			
8.	निविदा खोलने का स्थान		सिर्फ वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in			
9.	निविदा की वैधता की अवधि		180 दिन बाद तक			
10.	विज्ञापनदाता का पदनाम एवं पता:		कार्यपालक अभियंता, शीर्ष कार्य प्रमंडल, वाल्मीकीनगर			
11.	विशेष जानकारी प्राप्त करने हेतु वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in एवं www.wrd.bih.nic.in पर देखा जा सकता है।					

कार्यपालक अभियंता शीर्ष कार्य प्रमंडल, वाल्मीकीनगर

विस्तृत जानकारी state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

PR. No.011949 (WRD) 2026-27

नशामुक्त हो जाए बिहार, सुरक्षित रहे घर परिवार।

**NORTHERN RAILWAY**

TENDER NOTICE
(Through e-tendering)

Name of work with its location	Comprehensive Annual maintenance Contract (AMC) of Ansaldo make EI for CYZ station of DLI Division for 3 years.
App. Cost of the work (₹)	Rs. 26,92,608.48/-
Bid Security (₹)	Rs. 3,14,600/-
Address of the office	Senior Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer-C, Northern Railway, 3 rd Floor, Annex-1, DRM Office, New Delhi-110055.
Date & Time for upload the tender/closing of tender	Tender uploading 21.09.2026 / closing date & time 13.10.2026 up to 15.00 hrs.
Website particular & notice board location where complete details of the tender can be seen etc.	See the Northern Railway website www.ireps.gov.in & Notice board at S&T branch, 3 rd Floor, DRM office, State Entry Road, New Delhi-110055.
Tender No. 558-Sig-16-M-T-AMC-100 Dated: 21.09.2026	3269/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

**UJVNL LTD.**

H.O.: 'UJJWAL', Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone: 0135 - 2763808, Fax 0135-2763508
CIN No. : U48101UR20015SGC023866, Website : www.ujvnl.com

NOTICE INVITING TENDER Dated 21.09.2026

Office of the Executive Engineer PCM Dhalipur, Dehradun invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of the tender is given below:

Tender No:- 27/EE/PCM/Dhalipur/2026-27 & 28/EE/PCM/Dhalipur/2026-27

Name of work:- 1. Annual M&R, Cleaning & Upkeeping works of Office Building at Dhalipur for the Year 2026-27.
2. M&R work of Kulhal Power House Colony at Kulhal, Dehradun. Estimated value of Tender: Rs. 18,57,764.84 and Rs. 23,57,489.57 respectively (GST Extra)

Date & Time of availability of bid document on website : 22.09.2026 at 17:00 Hrs

Last Date & Time for submission of tender : 14.10.2026 up to 15:00 Hrs

For fuller and further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website [Executive Engineer PCM-Dhalipur, Dehradun](https://ujvnl.uk.gov.in) "https://ujvnl.uk.gov.in".

"Avoid Wasteful use of Electricity"

**NORTHERN RAILWAY**

E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. DEE-TRS-GZB acting for and on behalf of President of India invites E-Tender against Tender No. **230-TRS-GZB-2026-27-07**. The details are as under:

1. Name of the work	'Installation and Commissioning of Signal Exchange LED Light of both cab for 3-Phase Electric Locomotive' at Electric Loco Shed, Ghaziabad.
2. Approx cost of work	Rs. 26,44,380.00
3. Earnest Money to be deposited	Rs. 52,900.00
4. Last Date & Time of Submission of tender bid of tender	12.10.2026 (15:00 Hrs.)
5. Date & Time of opening of tender document	12.10.2026 (After 15:00 Hrs.)
6. Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in

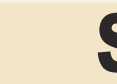
Note: (i) The tenderer/s must be registered on the Indian Railway E-Procurement System (IREPS) site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for participating in e-tender system. (ii) For all terms and conditions please refer tender document. (iii) No manual offers are acceptable. (iv) Cost of tender document and Earnest money will be acceptable through net banking or payment gateway only.

No. 230-TRS-GZB-2026-27-07 Dated: 19.09.2026

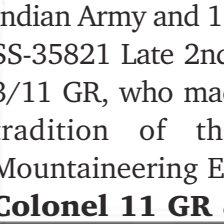
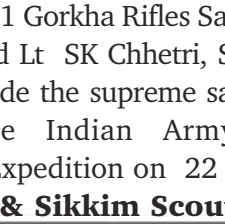
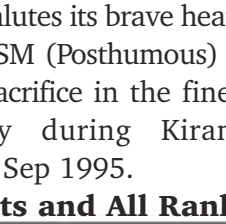
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 3272/26

**"IMPORTANT"**

Whilst care is taken prior to acceptance of advertising copy, it is not possible to verify its contents. The Indian Express (P) Limited cannot be held responsible for such contents, nor for any loss or damage incurred as a result of transactions with companies, associations or individuals advertising in its newspapers or Publications. We therefore recommend that readers make necessary inquiries before sending any monies or entering into any agreements with advertisers or otherwise acting on an advertisement in any manner whatsoever.

**SALUTE THE SOLDIER**

GORKHA RIFLES
Indian Army and 11 Gorkha Rifles Salutes its brave heart, SS-35821 Late 2nd Lt SK Chhetri, SM (Posthumous) of 3/11 GR, who made the supreme sacrifice in the finest tradition of the Indian Army during Kiranti Mountaineering Expedition on 22 Sep 1995.
Colonel 11 GR & Sikkim Scouts and All Ranks ASSAM RIFLES

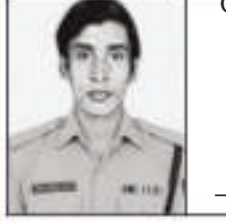
 Rfn (Late) Shankar Kumar Gurung	 Rfn (Late) Sunil Kumar Thapa	 Rfn (Late) Kailash Chandra	 Rfn (Late) Kamal Subba
--	---	---	---

The Tagra Teyees family proudly remembers above Bravehearts who in the true traditions of the Assam Rifles made supreme sacrifice while bravely combating terrorists in Udaipur (Tripura) on 22 Sep 1999. May the Almighty grant eternal peace to their soul. Their gallant action will continue to inspire us all.

DEEPLY REMEMBERED BY COMMANDANT & ALL RANKS 23 ASSAM RIFLES 'TAGRA TEYEEES'


CONSTABLE DAYA RAM
86 BN BSF
05.07.1965 - 22.09.1993

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Daya Ram on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal injuries in a landmine blast triggered by Naxals in Kazangnagar area (Andhra Pradesh) and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.


CONSTABLE GOPAL CHANDRA SAHANA
55 BN BSF
17.09.1964 - 22.09.1990

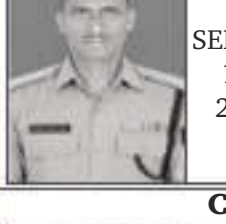
Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Gopal Chandra Sahana on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal injuries, while fighting with armed miscreants in area of BOP Syelberia, Nadia (WB) and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.


LANCE NAIK JAFAR ALI
41 BN BSF
01.04.1964 - 22.09.1993

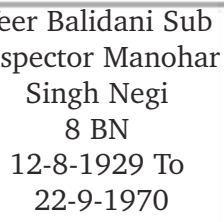
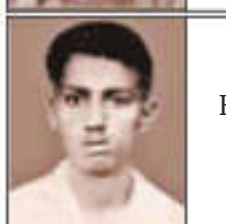
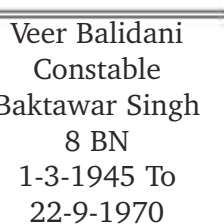
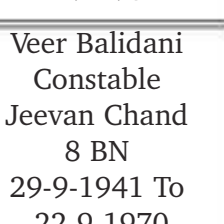
Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Lance Naik Jafar Ali on his Balidan Diwas. On 20th Sep 1993, he sustained fatal bullet injuries in a fierce encounter with militants in Sopore area (J&K) and succumbed to his injuries on 22nd Sep 1993.


CONSTABLE MD ABDHUL GAFAR KHAN
56 BN BSF
23.02.1981 - 22.09.2002

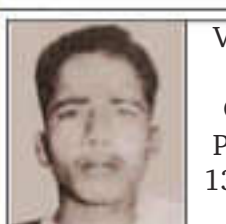
Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Md Abdhul Gafar Khan on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries in a fierce encounter with militants in Awantipora area, Srinagar (J&K) and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.


CONSTABLE CHANDRA SEKHAR KUMAR
160 BN BSF
25.03.1991 - 22.09.2025

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Chandra Sekhar Kumar on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he made ultimate sacrifice while on operational duty in Jalalabad, Punjab.

 Veer Balidani Sub Inspector Manohar Singh Negi 8 BN 12-8-1929 To 22-9-1970	 Veer Balidani Head Constable Asha Ram 8 BN 21-8-1929 To 22-9-1970
 Veer Balidani Constable Baktawar Singh 8 BN 1-3-1945 To 22-9-1970	 Veer Balidani Constable Kailash Chand 8 BN 20-4-1948 To 22-9-1970
 Veer Balidani Constable Jeevan Chand 8 BN 29-9-1941 To 22-9-1970	 Veer Balidani Constable Shankar Dutt 8 BN 1-5-1946 To 22-9-1970

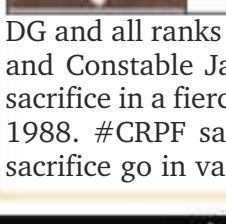
DG and all ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to 6 valiant troopers of 8 BN CRPF, who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining grievous injuries while countering an ambush by insurgents in Manipur, on 22 September 1970. #CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.

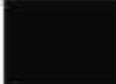

Veer Balidani Constable Ghanshyam Pathak 36 BN
13-11-1965 To 22-9-1987

DG and all ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Ghanshyam Pathak of 36 BN CRPF, who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining grievous injuries during a public disturbance in Jehanabad, Bihar on 22 September 1987. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.


Veer Balidani Constable Nem Singh
38 BN
19-8-1961 To 22-9-1988

DG and all ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Nem Singh and Constable Jagdish Singh of 38 BN CRPF, who made the supreme sacrifice in a fierce encounter with militants in Punjab on 22 September 1988. #CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.


Veer Balidani Constable Jagdish Singh
38 BN
1-4-1949 To 22-9-1988

**बिहार सरकार**

निदेशक (मुख्य अभियन्ता) का कार्यालय
जल एवं भूमि प्रबंधन संस्थान, फुलवारीशरीफ, पटना
निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना
(केवल ई-टेंडर पद्धति के अनुसार वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)

सूचना सं०-01SBD/2026-27 वाल्मी, पटना

1. कार्य का विवरण :-

गुप सं०	कार्य का नाम	प
---------	--------------	---

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I, PRADEEP KUMAR S/o Ramesh Chander, A-2/330, New Kondli, Mayur Vihar-3, Delhi-96, have changed my name to PRADEEP. 0071061609-1

I,AFIY HASSAN,S/O.SHAM S/UL HASSAN,R/O.D-704,7th-Floor Black-D,Platinum Heights Tower-D,Ramprastha Greens Sec-8,Vaishali Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201010,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as HAIDER 0040879567-3

I, hitherto known as YAMINI ALIAS YAMINI WADHWAA W/O SANJAY SHERAWAT R/O E-195 Gamri Colony khera khurd P.O khera khurd Dist. North West Delhi-110082 Have Changed my name and shall hereafter be known as YAMINI SHERAWAT 0040879538-1

I,SHRI.SANTOSH KUMAR TIWARI,R/o A-155,Hari enclave,Part-2,Kirari Suleman Nagar,West Delhi-110086, inform that my minor son's name AKANSH and AKANSH TIWARI,both names are same person. 0040879442-11

I,SATPAL S/O-HARI CHAND R/O-H.NO.-400/4, GARHI KESHRI (242), GANAUR, SONIPAT H:-131101, have change my name to SATPAL SHARMA. 0040879559-8

I, Stephen Joy Parothara S/o Parothara Mathai Joy R/o-SC77, Sophia Apartments, Indirapuram Ghaziabad have changed my name to Stephen Joy. 0071061583-1

I,Mohd Tasleem,S/o-Chhote,R/o-H.No.-20,Ambedkar Chowk,Kardampuri,Delhi-110094,declare that name of mine and my father has been Mentioned as Mohammed Tasleem and Chhuttan Khan in my Passport No.-R475282.The actual name of mine and my father are Mohd Tasleem and Chhote. 0040879561-4

I, RITIK S/o KRISHAN PAL R/o KH NO 320/155 GROUND FLOOR GALI NO 25 FUTA ROAD BLOCK A, JANTA VIHAR, MUKUNDPUR, LIBES PUR, NORTH WEST, DELHI, DELHI- 110042 have changed my name to RITIK SIROHI for all purposes. 0071061592-1

I,MUTOSIE S/O-SIEMATHO R/O-173,FIRST FLOOR,LEFT SIDE,HARI NAGAR ASHRAM,NEW DELHI-110014,have changed my name from MUTOSIE to MIITOSIE,for all purposes. 0040879563-2

I, Chilkula Ramchander S/o CH Pentaiah R/o-1-102, Narapally Village, Ghatkesar, Rangareddy, Telangana - 501301, have changed my minor son's name from Chiluka Indra Neelush Kumar aged 17 years to Chiluka Dinesh Kumar forever 0071061640-1

I,Krishna,s/o-Ramakant Beernally,R/o-Flat-48,Tower-3,NTPC Vinayak Apartment, Plot-C-58/1, Sector-62, Noida, G.B.Nagar, have changed my name to Krishna Beernally. 0040879442-4

I,SHEELA alias TARSHEELA TOPPO,W/O- Sh Bomiya Rajbir,R/O-H.NO.-65,Ber Sarai,New Delhi -110016,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME AND SHALL HEREAFTER BE KNOWN AS TARSHEELA TOPPO. 0040879559-1

I, ZAHIDA SAIF/W/O- SAIFUDDIN R/O-7/17, ANASARI ROAD DARYA GANJ DELHI-110002, have changed my minor son name ABDULLA TO ABDULLAH, Permanently for all future purpose 0040879560-6

I,DEEPAK KUMAR SETHI,S/O-Tulsi Dass Sethi,R/O-H.NO.31, Block-H,Bali Nagar, ramesh Nagar, Delhi-110015, have Changed my name to DEEPAK SETHI 0040879561-6

I,Meenakshi Singh W/o Neeraj Kant R/o A-147, Sector-48, Noida(U.P) have changed my name to Meenakshi Kumari for all future purposes. 0040879501-1

I,DALJEET SINGH S/O CHANNA SINGH R/O S-1/124,FIRST FLOOR OLD-MAHAVIR NAGAR,TILAK NAGAR, DELHI-110018.HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO DALJIT SINGH. 0040879567-5

I Vallepu Guruvaiiah S/o Vallepu Chinna Yellaiiah R/O 21-2-82/4/C, Parvathi Nagar, Markandeya Colony, Near Gouthami Sai Collage, Godavarikhani, Ramagundam, PO-Maidpalli, Dist-Karimnagar, Telangana - 505209, have changed my name to Vallepu Akshay 0071061683-1

I,GEETA,W/o-HARSH KUMAR,ADD:H.No.219,PATTI GILLIAN DI VILLAGE, JAMSHER KHAS, JALANDHAR-II, PUNJAB 144020, have changed my name to GEETA RANI 0040879442-13

I,SHALINI AHLAWAT KOCHAR,W/O-KUMARI MANAV,R/O-AMRAPALI SAPPHIRE,TOWER-B,GROUND FLOOR,FLAT NO-03,SECTOR-45, NOIDA,GAUTAM BUDH NAGAR,UTTAR PRADESH-201301,have changed My Name To SHALINI AHLAWAT permanently. 0040879559-10

I,Sheela Sharma,W/o-Ghanshyam Das Sharma,R/O-House No A-1,3rd-Floor Guro Ram Dass Nagar,Laxmi Nagar,Delhi-110092,have changed my name to Susheela Devi Sharma Permanently. 0040879560-2

I,ASHOK KUMAR,S/o-Ratan Chand Chopra,R/o-9-H/1,Rajpur Road near Tirath Ram Hospital Civil Lines Delhi-110054,have changed my name to ASHOK CHOPRA 0040879560-3

I,ANIL RATTAN S/O Dharam Pal Ratan, 42A, 3rd Floor, Munirka Village, JNU, Delhi-67, have changed my name to ANIL KUMAR RATAN. 0071061605-1

I,Lilawati W/O Mideswari, H.No-2, Near,Gitanjali School, Akbarpur Bahrapur, Ghaziabad up-201009,Lilawati and Basnti Devi both are same person. 0040879567-2

I,Amandeep Singh Bhasin R/o C-2/47, C-2 Block Janakpuri have changed my minor daughter s name from Aashi Kaur to Aashi Kaur Bhasin. 0040879525-1

I,AFASANA,W/O-LATE NADEEM,R/o L-36/A,ABUL FAZAL ENCLAVE,PART-I,JAMIA NAGAR,OKHLA,NEW DELHI-110025,have change my child's name from HUSAN SHEFI to MOHD HUSSAIN in his Aadhaar Card. 0040879442-10

I, kirandeep kaur viridi W/o Amanpreet Singh R/o C-11 Cottage Road,Adarsh Nagar Delhi-110033 have changed my name to kirandeep kaur. 0040879559-7

I,RAJ KUMAR SHARMA S/O BRIJ MOHAN R/O B-355, TARANFARM WALI GALI, NEAR RADHA KRISHAN MANDIR, SWAROOP NAGAR LIBAS PUR NORTH WEST DELHI- 110042 have changed my name RAJ KUMAR for all future purpose 0071061582-1

I,RAHUL KUMAR SINGH S/O-Anil Pratap Singh R/o-H.No-71, 2nd-Floor Avtar Enclave Paschim Vihar New Delhi-110063,have changed my name to RAHUL SINGH, permanently 0040879561-3

I,Aliya Begum,W/o-Mohd Farid,R/O-A-6/24,Gali No.3,Chauhan Bangar Delhi, declare that my correct name is Aliya Begum. My name was as Alia in the 2002 voter-list,(Assembly No.49,Part No,32 Serial No.1484) and Aliya Farid in Current voter-list,all these names refers to same person i.e. myself. It is hereby notified that my correct name is Aliya Begum,for all purposes. 0040879559-2

I,Suheb Saifi, S/o Rajuddin, R/o H-710, 2nd floor, Jaipur Extn Part-2, Badarpur,South Delhi-110044, have Changed my name to Sohaib 0040879560-7

I Deepanshu Ruhil S/o Ramesh Kumar R/o H.No.67-68 1st Floor Pocket-5, Sector-22, Rohini Delhi-110085 changed my name to Deepanshu 0040879561-7

I,Monisha Tripathi W/o Piyush Tripathi R/o H.No.78D Express View Apartment, Sector-93, Noida(U.P) have changed my name to Monisha Mishra for all future purposes. 0040879501-2

I,INDERJEET KAUR W/O DALJIT SINGH R/O,S-1/124,FIRST-FLOOR,OLD MAHAVIR NAGAR,TILAK NAGAR,DELHI-110018.HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO IINDERIT KAUR. 0040879567-6

It is for general information that I, AYEKAPAM JIRAN MEITEI Son of A Tolen Meitei R/O B-83, Manavsthal Apartment, Vasundhara Enclave, Dist: East Delhi, Delhi- 110096, declare that name of mine and my wife has been wrongly written as A Jiran Meitei and A Romita Devi in my minor son KOROUGANBA AYEKPAM aged 14 years in his School Record. The actual name of mine and my wife is AYEKPAM JIRAN MEITEI and AHANTHEM ROMITA DEVI respectively, which may be amended accordingly. 0071061685-1

It is for general information that I,Bhawna,D/O-Charan Singh,R/O-House-No-B-756-A,Sangam Vihar,Deoli,South Delhi,Delhi-110062,declare that name of my mother has been wrongly-written as Pushpa in my All Educational Documents,Birth Certificate.No-151658 and Passport.No-Y2007810.The actual name of my mother is Sangeeta. 0040879442-14

IBIMALA DEVI,W/O-Pushkar Nath Sharma,R/O-Plot No-80,New Vision Colony,Village Haibat Pura,Najafgarh,South West Delhi-110043 Have changed my name to Vimla Sharma. 0040879559-11

I, Jasmine Joseph R/O 825/2, 2nd floor Chitla. Gate Delhi. 110006 have changed my name to Jasmine Khan for all purposes. 0040879422-1

I,hitherto known as KANTA, W/O NARESH KUMAR GUPTA, R/o C-29, G/F, Gali No.13, Shashi Garden,Near Mayur Vihar Ph-1, Delhi-110091,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as KANTA DEVI. 0040879449-1

I,MUHAMMAD JAKI, S/O ISHTYAK HUSAIN, R/O E-109, Fourth Floor, East Side, Block-E, Jaipur Extension Part-2, P.O.-Badarpur, Distt.-South Delhi, Delhi-110044,have changed my name mohammad jaki to Muhammad Jaki for all future purposes 0071061599-1

I,FAZALEELAHI S/O ISTAAQ ALI,R/O 323/22,ZAKIR NAGAR,JAMIA NAGAR,NEW DELHI-110025,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME FROM FAZALEELAHI TO FAZLE ELAHI 0040879563-5

I, Sohil Bhat, R/o 13/13A, Roshan Garden 2, Najafgarh, NewDelhi, declare that my mother's correct legal name is Sneha Lata Bhat(UID-684890483170), but it was incorrectly recorded as Reshma in my documents. Both are one and the same person. 0050298134-1

I Vinod Kumar S/o Harkesh Singh R/o Pandit Wali Gali, Sadarpur, Sector-45, Noida, Gautam Budh Nagar, U.P.-201301 have changed my minor Son's name from Saksham Panwar to Saksham Pawar. Henceforth he Would be known by the name of Saksham Pawar for all future purposes. 0071061602-1

I,B D Sharma,S/o Amba Dutt,R/o H.No-345 Near Family Health Care Hospital Sector-15 Vasundhara Ghaziabad U.P-201012,have changed my name to Bhairav Dutt. 0040879442-7

I,Naresn Chandra Agarwal,S/O-Jagdish Prasad Garg,R/O-402,4th Floor,Oakra Tower,SVP Gulmohar Residency,Ahinsa Khand-2,Indirapuram,Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh,201014 have changed My Name To Naresn Chandra Agarwal permanently. 0040879559-9

I,Maya D/o Sh. Hukum Singh is legally wedded spouse of Sgt. Chaman Singh presently residing at I-208, Govindpuram, Ghaziabad UP 201013 have changed my name from Maya to Maya Devi for all future purpose. 0071061585-1

I,THSURHETSHU W/O-MIITOSIE R/O-173,FIRST FLOOR,LEFT SIDE, HARI NAGAR ASHRAM,NEW DELHI-110014,have changed my name from THSURHETSHU to THSURHETSHU PHOJI,for all purposes. 0040879563-3

I, Sushil Kumar Yadav, S/o Shiv Prasad Yadav, R/o E-110, Uninav Heights, Rajnagar Extension, Ghaziabad -201017, declare that my name wrongly mentioned as "Sushil Kumar Yaadav" in Driving License is actually "Sushil Kumar Yadav." Both names refer to one and the same person, as declared vide affidavit dated 19.09.2026 at Ghaziabad. 0050298138-1

I,Karan Bhardwaj S/o P N Sharam R/o A- 46,1st Floor BPTP District 3 Faridabad-121002, have changed my name to Karan. 0040879442-5

I ANJU BALA W/O PANKAJ NEGI,Address-H.No.50B, POCKET A, DILSHAD GARDEN,DELHI-110095,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO ANJU NEGI FOR ALL PURPOSE. 0040879567-8

I, Durjay Parida, S/o Keshab Chandra Parida R/O F-104,2nd Floor,Sector-27, Noida,have changed my name to Durjay Kumar Parida For All Future Purposes. 0040879567-1

I, R Hariya S/o R Mothilal R/O 18-2/197/97, R.N Colony, Falaknuma, Bandlaguda, Distt-Hyderabad, Telangana - 500553 , have changed my minor son's name from R Pradeep Aged 15 Years to Ramavath Ritesh Raj Rathod forever 0071061651-1

I Jaibhgwani, S/o Lakhiram, R/o Vpo Mundlana, 131306 Sonipat Haryana Have changed my name to Jaibhagwan 0040879442-9

I,Tarun Cumaar Khanna,S/o-Prem Nath Khanna,R/O-H.No-45,Road No-2,East Punjabi Bagh,Delhi-110026,have changed my name to Tarun C Khanna,for all purposes. 0040879559-6

I, Parmila W/o Rajesh R/O 379, VPO: Dichaon Kalan, District: South West Delhi, State: Delhi-110043 have changed my name to Promila Shokeen for all purposes. 0071061574-1

I,Sanjeew Chhatwal S/o-Ram Chhatwal R/O-H.No-47, Road,no-7,Punjabi Bagh East, Delhi-110026,have changed my name to Sanjeev Kumar Chhatwal,permanently 0040879561-2

I, Dipali Goel alias Deepali Goel D/o Anil Chander Goel W/o Amit Mittal R/o TG 2B/2 Flat No. 4, Mehrauli Gurgaon, Haryana, 122002, have changed my name to Dipali Mittal. 0071061634-1

I,Ramakanth,S/o Vidyasagar Beernally,R/o Flat-48,Tower-3,NTPC Vinayak Apartment, Plot-C-58/1,Sector-62, Noida, G.B.Nagar, have changed my name to Ramakant Beernally. 0040879442-2

I, Amit Kumar S/o Amar Nath Bansal, R/o C-1/14, Budh Vihar Phase-1, Sultanpuri C Block, North West Delhi 110086, have changed my name to Amit Kumar Bansal permanently. 0040879533-1

I, Neha Sharma W/o Kunal Sharma, R/o, Flat-No.204, C1 and 2, Block-C, Ramprastha-Colony, Chander Nagar, Ghaziabad, UP-201011, have changed my-name to Neha Giri. 0040879560-4

I Kaushik S/o Kala Chand Mandal R/o H.No. A - 89, Aali Vihar, Sarita Vihar, South Delhi, Delhi-110076 have changed my name to Kaushik Mandal for all purposes. 0040879439-1

I, Shweta Agarwal W/o Aman Goel, R/O E-401 platinum premiere Ramprastha greens Vaishali Ghaziabad-201010. Have changed my Name from shweta agarwal to Shweta Goel for all purposes. 0040879123-6

LOST & FOUND
The original BBA (Builder-Buyer Agreement) for my flat (No. X-0302, Amrapali Verona Heights) has been lost. Ratan Kumar (son of Tarakant Jha) and Ekta Rakhi (wife of Ratan Kumar); residents of Village Budhama, Post Khada, District Madhepura, Bihar; Phone No. 8744969996. 0071061601-1

Lost Share Certificate: Original share certificate for Flat No. D-102,Taj Sartaj CGHS Ltd. (Taj Enclave CGHS), Geeta Colony, Delhi-31 has been lost/misplaced. Any Claim/objection may be intimated to the undersigned within 7 days of publication at Office,Taj Enclave CGHS. 0050298148-1

I, Manoj Kumar, S/o Jog Raj, R/o 13/336, Geeta Colony, Delhi-110031, have lost my 10th Class Marksheet and Certificate Roll No.403233, Year-1988-1989, CBSE, Delhi and ITI Certificate, Tractor Mechanic, Roll No. 24/89, Year-1989-1990, Passing Year- January-1991, Shahdara Delhi. Finder may contact- 9136248276. 0040879452-1

Lost original property paper (All Chain),INDL05032763374075J of H.No.94/3,Gali No.8,East Azad Nagar, Krishna Nagar,Delhi-110051. Founder may inform at above Address,Mithlesh Jain,W/o-Ramesh Chand Jain #9818069832 0040879608-6

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Nand Kishore S/o Shyam Dev Tiwari R/o B-10/18, Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 371/2023 U/s 129/55 Gambling Act, P.S. Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** and it has been shown to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Nand Kishore** cannot be found and whereas it has been absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Nand Kishore** of case **FIR No. 371/2023 U/s 129/55 Gambling Act, P.S. Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **23.10.2026**.
By Order
Ms. Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
North, Court Room No. 114, 1st Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi
DP/12408/ON/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Jaibir S/o Amrit Singh R/o Village Ujwa, South West, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 216/2024 U/s 33/58 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Narela, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Jaibir** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Jaibir** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Jaibir** of case **FIR No. 216/2024 U/s 33/58 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Narela, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.10.2026**.
By Order
Sh. Rishabh Kapoor
Judicial Magistrate First Class -01
North, Room No. 116, 1st Floor
Ronini Courts, Delhi
DP/13251/ON/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./ 84 BNSS)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Khurshid Anwar S/o Abdul Khalil R/o H. No. 224, Basai Darapur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 206/2018 U/s 323/506 IPC & 10 POCSO ACT, PS Moti Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Khurshid Anwar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Khurshid Anwar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Khurshid Anwar in FIR No. 206/2018 U/s 323/506 IPC & 10 POCSO ACT, PS Moti Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **22.10.2026**.
By order
Sh. Sushil Kumar
Additional Sessions Judge
SC-POCSO-01 West Room-139
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi
DP/13356/WD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./ 84 BNSS)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Ram Niwas S/o Om Prakash R/o Jhuggi No. 24, Priya Camp, Sukhdev Vihar, New Friends Colony, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 241/13 U/s 380/457/411/34 IPC, PS Okhla Industrial Area, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Ram Niwas** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Ram Niwas** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Ram Niwas in FIR No. 241/13 U/s 380/457/411/34 IPC, PS Okhla Industrial Area, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **22.10.2026**.
By order
Ms. Akansha Gautam
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02
South-East, Room No. 513
Saket Court, New Delhi
DP/13341/SE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sannhita, 2023
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Akbar @ Lefty, S/o: Ahmad Hussain, R/o: Khasra No. 156, Chandahulla, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 204/2015 U/s 454/380/411/34 IPC, P.S.: Fatehpur Beri, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Akbar @ Lefty** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Akbar @ Lefty** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Akbar @ Lefty** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 204/2015 U/s 454/380/411/34 IPC, P.S.: Fatehpur Beri, New Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.12.2026**.
By Order
Ms. Shilvi Talwar
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01,
(South), Room No. 214,
Saket Court, New Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr.PC/84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sannhita)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Saroj, W/o Prem R/o H.No.18/B, Ground Floor, Dichaon, Enclave, Najafgarh, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.80013555/2025 dated 05.02.2025 u/s 379/411 IPC, P.S. New Friends Colony, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Saroj** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Saroj** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Saroj** of **FIR No.80013555/2025 dated 05.02.2025 u/s 379/411 IPC, P.S. New Friends Colony, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.10.2026**.
By Order,
Vinod Joshi
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate, South-East District
DP/13301/SE/2026
Court No.515, Saket Court, New Delhi

PUBLIC NOTICE
It is to inform to the public at large that Mrs. Reenu Rastogi is owner of Second Floor, Property No. B-1/321, Situated at Yamuna Vihar, Delhi, and has offered to sell the said property to my Client Mrs. Tanuja, who intend to acquire the said property with State Bank of India. The Original Mother Deeds(Poor Title Deeds), alongwith supporting chain of document(s) has been not traceable despite diligent searches, therefore not available for physical verification at present. It is hereby notified that any person / Bank/ financial institution having any claim, any charge, interest or lien or claim and/or objection to thereof, he/she/ they may lodge/notify the same to the undersigned with documentary proof /court judgment within 15 days from the day of publication of this public notice. Failing which any further /future claim /objection(s) shall be rejected and my client/prospective buyer(s) as a bona-fide purchaser conclude the title/Sale Deed proposed to be executed in favour of my client or in the name of his/her/ their nominees shall be deemed to be clear and marketable without any Defect, encumbrance, flaw and impediment.
Amit Kumar (Advocate)
R2-18, Vinoda Enclave Ext. Jharoda Khas, Najafgarh, Delhi-110072
Mobile: +91 8130768933
Email: amitbahuahad01@gmail.com

PUBLIC NOTICE
My client, Mrs. Gurpreet Kaur, who Inderged Singh, R/o 3416-3416-A, Old Plot No-79, Gali no-249, Hansa puri, Ti Nagar, Delhi-110035, hereby declare that She has disowned her son, Mr. Manpreet Singh, who Inderged Singh and her son's wife namely Mrs. Jaspreet Kaur (Do Dajjeet Singh). Due to their hostile behaviour, acts, conduct, and misdeeds towards my client, She has severed all her relations with them and have disinherited them from all her movable and immovable properties, assets and estate. She shall not be responsible for any act, transaction, debt or liability incurred by them hereafter.
Lalit Kumar (Advocate)
Ch. No. 303 Rohini Court Delhi.

PUBLIC NOTICE
Notice is hereby given to the general public at large that my clients, Smt. Sushmita Kumari, W/o Shri Rajesh Kumar, and Shri Rajesh Kumar, are the intending purchasers in respect of the Ground Floor of Property No. 13/4, Subhash Nagar, Tehari-1, New Delhi (hereinafter referred to as the 'said property').
My clients have represented that they had entered into an arrangement/agreement with respect to the purchase of the said property from the concerned owners/seller(s). Any person(s), firm, company, bank, financial institution or other entity having any right, title, interest, claim, demand, objection, lien, charge, mortgage, tenancy, attachment, litigation or otherwise of whatsoever nature in or over the said property, or having any objection to the proposed transaction in favour of my clients, is hereby called upon to intimate the same, in writing, along with supporting documents, to the undersigned within 15 days from the date of publication of this notice. In case no objection/claim is received within the aforesaid period, it shall be presumed that there is no objection or claim whatsoever in respect of the said property, and my clients shall proceed with the matter/transaction at their sole discretion, without any further notice, and all such claims, if any, shall be deemed to have been waived.
Date: 21-09-2026 Place: New Delhi
Advocate Name: Hemant Madan
Enrollment No.: D-219/2010
Address: 207, Second Floor, Transport Authority, Janak puri, New Delhi-58
Mob: 9811474085 & 7503246977

PUBLIC NOTICE
My client Moti Lal Gupta and his wife Smt. Soni Gupta R/o WZ-D-75,Kesho Pur Village Vikas Puri ND-18 have severed all relations with their son Shri Chirag Gupta and have disowned and debarred him from their movable and immovable properties. Any person dealing with the said Chirag Gupta shall do so at his/her own risk. My clients shall not be responsible or liable for any of his acts, deeds, debts transactions or liabilities.
Advocate
Rakesh Kumar Garg (D/1436/07)

PUBLIC NOTICE
Smt. Shri. Purni Singh Mathur, S/o Sh. Urban Singh, and Sen. Surgi Mathi, W/o Sh. Purni Singh Mathur, both R/o House No. 3378, Block-G, Gali No. 49, San Nagar, Bhatti, North Delhi, Delhi-110084, have debarred and disowned their son namely Gopal and their daughter-in-law namely Mala from all their movable and immovable properties and have severed all relations with them, as they have harassed my clients and have been creating trouble, inconvenience and mental harassment to my clients. Accordingly, my clients shall have no transactions or responsibility for any acts, deeds, transactions, liabilities or dealings undertaken by the above-named persons. Any person dealing with or having any transaction with them shall do so entirely at his/her own risk and consequences. My clients shall not be responsible or liable for the same in any manner whatsoever.

"IMPORTANT"
Whilst care is taken prior to acceptance of advertising copy, it is not possible to verify its contents. The Indian Express (P) Limited cannot be held responsible for such contents, nor for any loss or damage incurred as a result of transactions with companies, associations or individuals advertising in its newspapers or Publications. We therefore recommend that readers make necessary inquiries before sending any monies or entering into any agreements with advertisers or otherwise acting on an advertisement in any manner whatsoever.

The Indian EXPRESS
JOURNALISM OF COURAGE
Call or WhatsApp 9717006820
to advertise on classified page

Rowers threaten to go on 'strike' after last-minute crew changes



Balraj Panwar (above) was moved from quadruple to single sculls. FILE

Mihir Vasavda
Nagoya, September 21

LEADING INDIAN men's rowers have threatened to go on strike at the Asian Games and not train on Tuesday after the team management's decision to change crews on Monday.

The changes were made two days before the rowing competitions at the Asian Games are scheduled to begin on September 23. The events were originally scheduled to start on Sep-

tember 20 but were postponed due to the impending typhoon Dujan along the Pacific coast.

According to a source, the team management made several changes to the entries after Monday morning's training session, with rowers moved between events and a reserve player brought into the team.

"Some of the rowers said they would go on a strike. There are efforts going on right now to sort out the situation and ensure the practice session takes

place as scheduled tomorrow," a source said. "It is a risk to change crews so late, but whatever decision the team management has taken, it is to ensure that best teams are entered into the competition."

Navdeep Singh and Kulwinder Singh, who were entered in the men's double sculls, were moved to the quadruple sculls. Salman and Satnam, who were part of the quadruple sculls, were moved to the double sculls.

Balraj Panwar was moved from the quadruple sculls to the single sculls, while Arvind Singh was moved out of the single sculls and into the quadruple sculls. Vipul Ghurde was moved from the men's pair to the coxless four, with reserve Saurav Kumar dropped from the event. Jasmail Singh, who was a reserve, was brought into the coxless four.

Nitin Kumar and Jaswinder Singh, who had been part of the coxless four, were moved into

the men's pair. The changes came after India's performance at the World Championships immediately before the Asian Games.

A senior rowing official said 50 per cent of a crew can be changed in the event of a medical emergency. The rowers have questioned the changes made in the absence of such an emergency. India won five medals at the 2022 Asian Games, with two silver and three bronze.

An accidental marksman, now Asiad silver medallist

Himanshu tried wrestling for a few days, farmed rice in the Haryana heat, then picked up a rifle at his school range



Mihir Vasavda
Toyota City, September 21

WRESTLING WAS supposed to be Himanshu Dhillon's inheritance. Farming was what his father thought might teach him the value of hard work. Shooting, he chose because it looked easy.

None of it turned out quite as expected. On Monday, after a roller-coaster final in which he moved from outside the medal positions to the top of the standings, slipped to bronze and recovered to finish with silver at the Asian Games, Himanshu discovered just how wrong that first impression had been. "When you stand there and your mind starts running, it gets intense," he tells *The Indian Express*. "I realised this the very day I went there for shooting. Only then did I see how it really is."

Himanshu, who celebrated his 21st birthday on Monday, had seen his uncle wrestle at the Rio Olympics in the 98kg Greco-Roman category. Hardeep Singh Dhillon's Olympic journey had inspired his younger brother Shamsher, who hoped his son could take the family's wrestling story one step further. So Himanshu gave wrestling a shot. He, however, lasted a few days. "The sore muscles and, his ear got slightly injured," Shamsher recalls. "Because of that, he felt, 'No, wrestling is not for me.'"

Himanshu laughs about it now. "It was a bit hard, so I left it." His father soon gave him another perspective. During the Covid lockdowns, Shamsher began taking him to their farmland. There was rice farming to be done, *jiri*, as they call it in Haryana, and fields

to clear in the afternoon heat. "We worked in the afternoon heat around 1 or 2pm and then came back. So that's why I chose this today!" Himanshu jokes.

The joke only goes so far. Shooting would demand its own form of endurance. There was no family shooting tradition. The beginning was almost accidental.

Himanshu was studying at a Gurukul in Kundri, near his home. The school had a shooting range, and he went there

with his friends simply for fun. His first shot on target, he remembers, was a forgettable 1. In a sport that demanded precision, and where medals are decided by decimals, a 1 was a brutal introduction.

At that point, shooting was not something he imagined doing for a living. Within five or six months, however, he had covered ground that took other children a year or more. Coach Kuldeep Nehra saw something and called Shamsher. "We need to buy a rifle," he told him.

The price was Rs 3 lakh. Shamsher, a manager with an agriculture company and the family's sole earning member, was stunned. "I said, 'That expensive?' I come from a middle-class family and work a private job, so that wasn't easy."

He borrowed money from a local arthia, or commission agent, bought the rifle and repaid the loan after the harvest. The investment continued. Shamsher shifted from Karnal to Kaithal, where Himanshu

trained, and began living in a rented house. He says he has put his life's savings into his son's career. "I had been continuously investing everything in him for six to seven years," he says.

There were moments when he wondered how long it could continue. Last year, with Himanshu still without a job, Shamsher wanted him to find employment partly to ease the financial burden. The family is joint, with four children, his parents and his brother also living together.

Help eventually came from MP Naveen Jindal, who supported Himanshu with a 14-month scholarship, and later from Olympic Gold Quest. "That was crucial," Shamsher says.

For Himanshu, the pressure, too, increasingly became internal. "I kept thinking about the Asian Games all day long. There were fears, doubts. I wondered if I actually was good enough to compete at this level," he says. In those moments, he turned to his coach Neha Chavan and psychologist Shivam Dwivedi. "They have more confidence in me than I do in myself," he says. "They say, 'You'll nail it, don't worry, we have full confidence in you.' Seeing their confidence makes me feel good, and I feel, 'Yeah, I can do this.'"

At home, Shamsher sent him a motivational video almost every day. On Monday, it was a birthday greeting and a simple wish: win a medal. "Don't be concerned about the colour, get a medal," his father told him. He did. But the medal is only part of what Himanshu is chasing. He wants to leave behind a name that means something to those who come after him.

His inspiration is Virat Kohli, who once spoke about wanting to become the kind of player who made others say, "I want to become a player like him." "I remember those words he said. And I want people to say, I want to be a player like Himanshu," rather than saying, "Some player named Himanshu came and went."

"I kept thinking about the Asian Games all day long. There were fears, doubts. I wondered if I actually was good enough to compete at this level"

HIMANSHU DHILLON,
ASIAN GAMES SILVER MEDALLIST



Thai shuttler tests positive at Asiad for furosemide

PITCHAMON OPATNIPUTH has been provisionally suspended at the Asiad after her out-of-competition sample taken on 17 September returned an Adverse Analytical Finding for furosemide, a diuretic. "Furosemide is prohibited under the WADA prohibited list as a S5 diuretic and masking agent. It is prohibited at all times in and out of competition and classified as a specified substance. It can be used by athletes to excrete water for rapid weight loss," an OCA update said. Opatniputh was provisionally suspended pending resolution. She can request the B-sample to be tested and also challenge the provisional suspension. ENS

PACE ISSUES

Why Indian shooters struggle to convert favourable positions into gold medals

Shashank Nair
New Delhi, September 21

IT'S EASY to look at the 10.1 final shot that Elavenil Valarivan hit on Sunday, and the 9.7 that blurted out of the rifle of Rudrankksh Patil in the men's event today and diagnose both those attempts with the oft-used, but rarely understood word, pressure.

India's wait for a 10m air rifle gold continued as the medals kept flowing but that elusive yellow metal was not found. Both shooters were in gold-medal winning positions but ended up not hitting the calibre of shots that they were producing through qualification and the finals.

What went wrong in those final eight shots for Ela and Rudrankksh?

The answer might be down to how some top Indian shooters pace themselves during a final. Both Elavenil and Rudrankksh started off lightning quick in the finals, registering scores of 106 in their first ten shots. To average 10.6 over the first ten shots in the final of a multi-sport event is an incredibly good base. But keeping that same pace, and the concentration it requires, especially in a high-stakes event, is often unsustainable. The result is that while enough has been accumulated for a medal, fighting for gold becomes a matter of just how much is left in the tank.

After her finals, Ela spoke about some of the things that went sideways in her gold quest. "I mean, I could have been a little more patient in taking my shots and possibly worked a little more



Rudrankksh Patil with his Asian Games medal. PTI

on my breathing." Later when elaborating on what she needs to work on, she added, "I think finding my pace of shooting in the finals is something that I am still working on. And that is some-



Elavenil Valarivan led the women's 10m air rifle final for 22 shots, before the final two attempts of the day turned sour. PTI

thing that I really want to learn and tune it down more."

There is also the quality of the shooters chasing them. Both Elavenil and Rudrankksh lost out on gold to generational

Asian Games performers by Japan's Hinata Taichi and China's Sheng Lihao.

Lihao, at 21, has already established himself as one of the best shooters to ever have

emerged from China. He is an all-weather, freak talent who will win most of the events he finds himself in. His chasedown of Rudrankksh was spectacular. After starting 'slow' with 104.9 in his first ten shots, Lihao went nuclear. His next six series of shots - 21.4; 21.4; 21.1; 21.4; 21.4; 21.4 - displayed absurd, almost robotic ability, to thread the barest of margins. His ability to hit the highest 10s at clutch has given him Olympic championships, as also the last Asiad title.

Lihao averaged near 10.7 in that series of twelve shots and finished the finals with a score of 254.2. His final shot average: 10.59. Essentially, every shot that Lihao landed was close to a 10.6 - which is the kind of consistency that's rare for all shooters to achieve, barring himself. India's best showing in individual air rifle has come

through Gagan Narang before Elavenil and Himanshu Dhillon matched him. But the gold has been elusive.

But it was the position that Lihao was in that helped as well. Shooters who start slow but chase down the leading marksman have the advantage of momentum on their side. The shooter leading has to switch their mindset from trying to keep the lead to suddenly finding themselves attempting to win gold with a shot or two to decide the outcome. Usually in those situations, the result goes in favour of the person wielding the momentum of the final.

Psychology of the chase

There is also the format of the final where the first ten shots are taken in two stages of five shots each. And then the next fourteen shots till the final are two at a

time, followed by a break, until the final. Every two shots, a shooter is eliminated.

Stylistically Indian shooters seem to work better when there are five shots with a set time on the board for them. It mirrors their approach to the qualification format and there seems to be a causality between the intense domestic competition that has shaped the psyche of an Indian shooter to be better at qualification and the last fourteen shots of a final where a few decimal points lost end up being the difference.

If a comparison has to be made, Lihao is as good as making two shots in a row with an interruption following, as the Indians are at making five in a row with an interruption following after. But like a home straight sprint of a 1500m race, Lihao canter past a fading Indian.



2018 World Champion Rudrankksh Patil had to be content with a bronze medal on Monday. PTI

Patil turns tears and near misses into belated bronze

Mihir Vasavda
Nagoya, September 21

"I HAVE cried a lot in the last 12 months."

Rudrankksh Patil says it with a smile, almost as a matter of fact, as two medals - a 10m air rifle team silver, and an individual bronze - hang around his neck. The first time was after the 2025 World Championships, where he failed to make the 10m air rifle final. "I wanted to win it twice, but couldn't," says the 2022 world champion. He cried again after finishing fourth at the World Cup Final in Doha.

Then came the National Sports Awards, where Patil expected his body of work to count for something. His name wasn't there. "One of the reasons Gukesh got the Khel Ratna was because he became the youngest (Chess) world champion. I was the youngest in 2022, too, and I saw my other teammates who won a bronze getting it."

Testing times

At the Asian Championships this year, there was a moment when his own practice left him questioning where he was headed. "I was seeing my pathetic state of practice, and I was like, I can't do shooting like that. I need to do something about it."

So he did.

The disappointments became fuel. The fourth places, the awards omission, the bad practice sessions - he could only keep working, stay patient and wait for the results. On Monday, at the Asian Games, one finally came - a bronze he was delighted to have. "Very happy," he said. "A lot of things could have gone wrong, but all of the things worked well. And I would like to look at the positive side compared to the negative."

For long stretches of the 10m air rifle final, Patil looked capable of doing much more than settling for bronze. Like Elavenil Valarivan, who won the women's silver on Sunday, he started strongly. And like Elavenil, he could not sustain that momentum as the final wore on. Himanshu Dhillon's fortunes were even more volatile, swinging from medal-threatening lows to gold-medal hopes and back again.

Patil seized the early lead and refused to let go. Behind him, the Chinese, Koreans and Mongolians scrambled for position until the fight for the podium narrowed to three: Patil, Dhillon and China's Sheng Lihao, who was about to turn his chase into theatre.

There was barely any room for error, and even less room to breathe. Decimals separated the top three, and the standard was so high that on the 11th shot, four shooters - Sheng, Dhillon and South Korea's Shin Minki and Park Hajun - all produced 10.9s. "I haven't seen anything like that," Dhillon sighed.

For a moment, it looked as if the Indians might take over. Dhillon's 10.9 on the 15th shot lifted him into second and brought the prospect of an Indian gold-silver finish into view. It lasted barely a minute.

Sheng had begun quietly, posting 104.9 in his first 10 shots. Not bad, but Patil had been better. Then the 21-year-old began to catch up. Not frantically or spectacularly, but with the cold consistency that has already made him one of the defining rifle shooters of his generation. He had won silver at the Tokyo Olympics aged 16 years and 233 days, becoming the youngest Olympic shooting medallist in history. Three years later, he was Olympic

champion in Paris. He had also won the individual title at the last Asian Games.

Gold chase

He was not about to surrender this one easily. After 16 shots, Sheng had moved back in front, a position he would not relinquish. What followed was almost mechanical. While the Indians searched for a way back, Sheng kept finding the smallest possible margins inside the 10-ring. His next six series all tallied 21.4, a remarkable show of consistency when the stakes were high. Across those 12 shots, he averaged almost 10.7. Shooting from the left corner, he showed no emotion as high 10s kept appearing beside his name one after another.

The Indians had thrown the challenge at him. Sheng simply kept stretching the gap until the Indians wobbled at different junctures. Dhillon's 9.8 and, soon after, Patil's 9.7 gave Sheng the opening he needed. The gold that had seemed within India's grasp was suddenly moving away. The contest had changed again. Sheng was no longer being chased for gold. The last few shots became a study in different kinds of pressure: Dhillon trying to hold off his teammate, Patil refusing to let him get away, and Sheng calmly closing the door on both.

Eventually, the scoreboard settled after 22 shots. Dhillon cemented the second spot, a silver on his Asian Games debut, with a total of 231. Patil pocketed the bronze with a tally of 230.9. He had spent much of the evening chasing a medal of a different colour. In the end, one-tenth was the margin between silver and bronze. But after everything the last year had thrown at him, Patil wasn't complaining.

